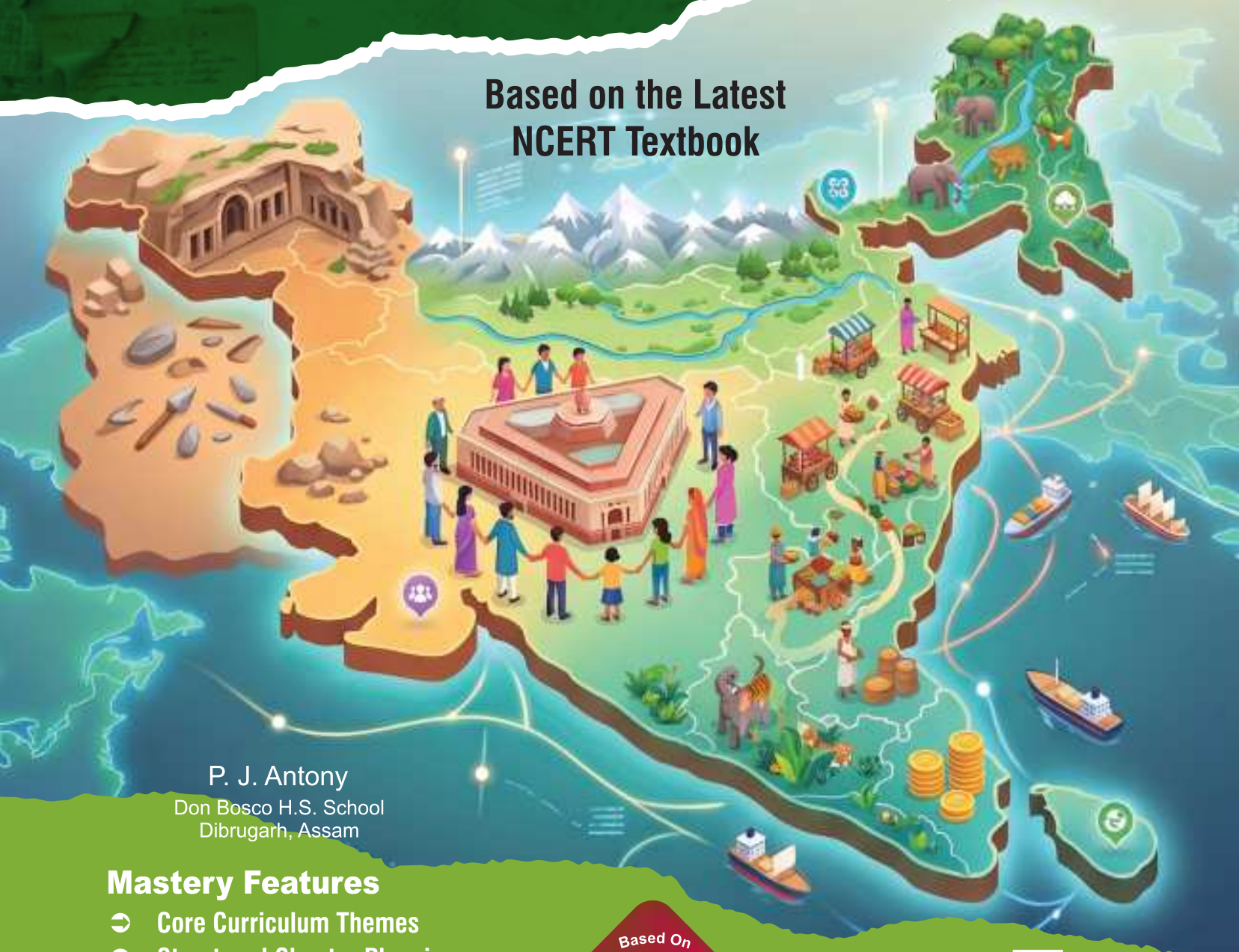
Little Leaf

Our Amazing World
SOCIAL SCIENCE

Based on the Latest
NCERT Textbook



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Mastery Features

- Core Curriculum Themes
- Structured Chapter Planning
- Active Reading Tools
- Vocabulary & Summaries
- Diverse Assessment Exercises
- Experiential & Practical Skills

Based On NEP2020 and NCF 2023

Sparkle EDUCATION

7
Middle Stage
PART-1

Published by:

Sparkle EDUCATION

✦Noida ✦Bangalore ✦Hyderabad ✦J&K
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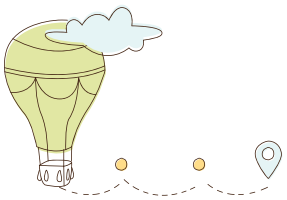

Printed at: The Ultimate Printing Press

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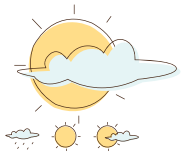
INTERESTING FACTS



PREFACE

It brings us immense joy to present this newly designed **Our Amazing World—Social Science** is a thoughtful endeavour created to make the study of human civilization, culture, geography, and governance both accessible and deeply engaging.

Social Science is far more than an academic discipline; it is a vital lens through which we understand the world, our shared history, and our responsibilities as global citizens. From understanding the dynamics of natural environments to exploring the evolution of societies and civic institutions, this series aims to transform Social Science from passive reading into an exciting journey of inquiry, empathy, and active participation.

Based on **latest books of NCERT**. In complete alignment with the vision of the **National Education Policy (NEP 2020)** and the **National Curriculum Framework (NCF-2023)**, this series moves away from traditional rote learning toward an interactive, competency-driven experience. The curriculum integrates critical 21st-century capabilities—fostering analytical reasoning, spatial literacy, visual interpretation, and responsible citizenship.

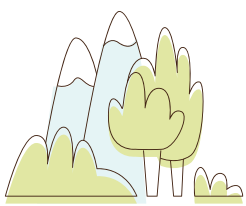
The structured learning approach guides students through a comprehensive educational journey. It begins with ***Let's Learn About***, which outlines clear learning objectives at the start of every chapter to set focused learning goals, while ***Let's Gear Up*** sparks immediate curiosity through relatable contexts, thought-provoking questions, and warm-up activities. Throughout the lesson, ***In-text Questions & Do You Know*** encourages active reading, self-reflection, and interest with fascinating facts and real-world connections, as ***Analyze Thoughts*** prompts critical thinking, deep inquiry, and discussions on historical events, social dynamics, and civic issues. For effective revision, ***New Terms & Quick Take*** defines key vocabulary and offers a crisp summary for rapid concept reinforcement. Finally, ***Comprehensive Exercises*** features multi-level assessments—including objective, MCQs, assertion-reason, short/long answer, picture-based, and paragraph-based tasks—while ***Hands-on Activities & Map Skills*** fosters practical learning, mini-projects, spatial awareness, and geographic literacy.

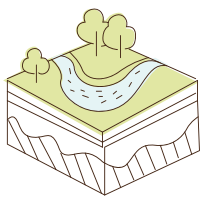
Additionally, historical and cultural highlights showcase India's rich heritage, socio-cultural diversity, and democratic values, instilling national pride alongside global competence.

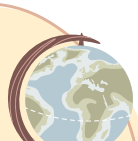
Constructive suggestions, feedback, and insights from educators, parents, and students are warmly welcomed to help us continuously refine and enrich future editions.

We hope this textbook empowers young minds to become informed, empathetic, and active citizens on their educational journey!

— Author







Your Exploration Guide

Welcome to the ultimate crew! Think of this book as your secret adventure toolkit for exploring history, our planet, and how society works. From cool starter activities and fun facts to thought-provoking questions and hands-on projects, every page is packed with awesome tools to help you investigate, think big, and master new skills like a real explorer!

Let's Learn About

This section lists the key topics and main learning goals you will study in the chapter before you start reading.

In-text Questions

Short questions placed inside the chapter to help you check your understanding while you read through the lesson.

Analyze Thoughts

Thinking questions that encourage you to reflect, ask "why," and apply your critical thinking skills to real life.

NEW TERMS

A helpful list of new or difficult vocabulary words used in the chapter along with their simple definitions.

EXERCISES

Various exercise formats, including MCQs, written questions, picture tasks, and reading passages, evaluate distinct learning levels ranging from simple memory recall and visual observation to thorough conceptual understanding.

Let's Gear Up

A fun starter activity or question that tests what you already know and gets you ready for the lesson.

Do you know?

Interesting extra facts related to the topic that make learning fun and give you cool, surprising knowledge.

Go Further

Extension facts that help you to research beyond the textbook, connect past events to modern issues, and explore real-world applications of social science.

QUICK TAKE

A brief summary at the end of the chapter that highlights all the important points for quick revision.

ACTIVITIES & PROJECTS

Hands-on mini-projects and map exercises foster practical learning by enhancing real-world information gathering, spatial awareness, navigation, and geographic skills.

NEP-2020 & NCF-2023 Guidelines

The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and National Curriculum Framework (NCF) 2023 focus on holistic, child-centered, and activity-based learning, fostering critical thinking, creativity, values, and 21st-century skills, preparing students for lifelong learning and responsible global citizenship.

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THEME–A

India and the World, Land and the People

India is a land of great geographical and cultural diversity. It has majestic mountains, fertile plains, vast deserts, plateaus, long coastlines, and beautiful islands. These physical features influence the climate, vegetation, wildlife, occupations, and lifestyles of the people. India is home to people of different languages, religions, traditions, and cultures who live together with mutual respect. Its location in South Asia has connected it with many countries through trade, travel, and cultural exchange since ancient times. Understanding India's land and people helps us appreciate its rich heritage, natural resources, unity in diversity, and important role in building peaceful and friendly relations with the world.

1 Geographical Diversity of India

Let's Learn About

- The main physical regions of India.
- The important landforms such as mountains, plateaus, plains, deserts and coasts.
- The special features of each region and how they influence climate, culture and daily life.
- How people live and adjust to different landforms and climates across India?

Let's Gear Up

Vanya and Kabir's India Journey

"Look at this, Kabir." Vanya said, pointing to a map on the wall. "Mahatma Gandhi once said India's land makes it very special. What do you think he meant?"

Kabir opened his atlas and smiled. "It means India has everything! Snowy mountains in the north, deserts in the west, green plains, forests, long rivers and islands in the seas!"

Vanya's eyes sparkled. "So our country is like one big home with many different rooms for everyone?"

"Exactly!" Kabir replied. "Remember when astronaut Kalpana Chawla looked at India from space? She said it looked so beautiful, like a jewel on Earth."

"Wow, that's amazing!" Vanya exclaimed. "I want to explore everything – the mountains, plains, deserts, plateaus, coasts and islands."

"Let's do it" Kabir said, spreading the map on the table. "Our adventure across India starts now – from the peaks to the shores. Ready?"

"Ready!" Vanya grinned. "Let's go on our journey!"

INTRODUCTION

India is the seventh-largest country in the world and is located in South Asia. Along with its its neighbours—Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Afghanistan, the Maldives and Sri Lanka—it forms a special region known as the Indian Subcontinent. To understand India's large and varied landscape, we divide it into five main physical regions:

- The Himalayan Mountains
- The Indo-Gangetic Plains
- The Thar Desert
- The Peninsular Plateau
- The Coastal Plains and Islands

Each of these regions is different in height, climate, natural plants, and the way people use the land.

The Himalayas form India's northern boundary and stand like a strong natural wall. In the west, the Thar Desert and the Arabian Sea create clear physical borders. The Indian Ocean lies to the south, while the Bay of Bengal is in the east. These natural features have greatly influenced India's weather, history and way of life.

In-Text Questions

1. India is the _____ largest country in the world.
2. The _____ Mountains form the northern boundary of India.

THE HIMALAYAS

The Himalayas are the highest mountain range in the world. They stretch across many countries and stay covered with snow for most of the year.

During summer, the melting snow gives rise to great rivers like the Ganga, Indus, and Brahmaputra. These rivers provide water for farming, drinking and industries and support the lives of millions of people. That is why the Himalayas are known as the 'Water Tower of Asia.'

The Himalayas are also holy for many people. Many temples and monasteries are located in these mountains. Monks and pilgrims from different parts of the world visit these sacred places to pray, think peacefully and meditate.

The Himalayan mountain range spreads across five countries—India, Nepal, Bhutan, China, and Pakistan. It is home to the famous "Eight Thousanders," which are very high peaks rising above 8,000 metres.

How the Himalayas Were Formed – A Fascinating Story

The Himalayas, known as the 'abode of snow,' have a wonderful story that began millions of years ago. Long ago, India was part of a huge landmass called Gondwana, which was located near Africa. Slowly, the Indian landmass started moving northward and finally crashed into the large Eurasian Plate. This powerful collision made the Earth's crust bend and rise, forming the mighty Himalayas.

This movement is still going on today. The Indian Plate continues to move north at about 5 centimetres every year. This means the Himalayas are still growing. In fact, these mountains rise nearly 5 millimetres each year, which becomes about 5 metres in a thousand years.

This constant movement not only shapes the land but also affects the climate and environment of the region. The Himalayas control weather patterns and are home to many plants and animals, making them very important for nature.

Formation of the Himalayas

The word 'Himalaya' comes from two Sanskrit words—'hima' meaning snow and 'alaya' meaning home—so it means 'home of snow.' The Himalayas are divided into three main parallel ranges: Himadri, Himachal, and the Shivalik Hills, and each has its own special features.

The Himadri (Greater Himalayas)

The Himadri, also called the Greater Himalayas, is the highest and roughest mountain range. It has some of the tallest peaks in the world, such as Mount Everest and Kanchenjunga. This range stays covered with snow all year round. Very few people live here because the climate is extremely cold and the height is very great. Just below the Himadri lies the Himachal range.

The Himachal (Middle or Lesser Himalayas)

The Himachal, also called the Middle or Lesser Himalayas, has a pleasant and moderate climate. It is rich in plants and animals. This region is famous for beautiful hill stations like Nainital, Shimla, Darjeeling, and Mussoorie. Because of its cool weather and scenic beauty, it is a popular place for tourists and settlements.

The Shivalik Hills (Outer Himalayas)

The Shivalik Hills, also called the Outer Himalayas, are the lowest range and form the foothills of the Himalayas. They have soft, rolling hills, thick forests and many wild animals. The Shivaliks act as a natural boundary between the high mountains and the northern plains.

Life and Nature in the Himalayas

In the western Himalayas, people have created a unique way of building houses known as kath-kuni or dhajji dewari. These houses are made by using local stone and wood together. This method keeps the homes warm during the cold winters and also helps them stay strong during small earthquakes. It shows how people wisely adjust their houses to live comfortably in the harsh mountain climate.

The Himalayas are also full of rich plant and animal life. The Great Himalayan National Park in Himachal Pradesh protects many rare species of plants and animals. It has been recognized as a World Heritage Site by UNESCO. The park is protected with the help of both the government and nearby village communities, who work together to take care of this valuable natural heritage.

Do you know?

The Himalayan monal, a brightly coloured bird, is the state bird of Himachal Pradesh and among the many lovely species living in the Great Himalayan National Park.

This region is well known for animals like the snow leopard, the bright Himalayan monal bird, and lovely rhododendron flowers. These flowers are often used to prepare tasty sherbet. People in the mountains also make beautiful handicrafts from wool, wood and natural fibres, showing their colourful culture and traditions of Himalayan life.

Great Himalayan National Park, Conservation Area

Himalayan monal (male)

Rhododendron

In-Text Questions

1. Which plate did the Indian landmass collide with to form the Himalayas?
2. Name one traditional building method used in the western Himalayas to make houses earthquake-resistant.
3. Which UNESCO World Heritage Site in Himachal Pradesh is home to many plants and animals?
4. What do the Sanskrit words hima and alaya mean when combined to form 'Himalaya'?

THE COLD DESERT: LADAKH

When we think of a desert, we usually imagine hot and dry land. But there are also cold deserts and Ladakh in India is one of them. Ladakh is very cold, with winter temperatures dropping below -30°C. It receives very little rainfall and the land is rocky and uneven, with deep valleys and lakes such as Pangong Tso (tso means lake in the local language).

Moonland, Ladakh

The land in Ladakh looks like the surface of the moon, so it is sometimes called "moonland." Geologists say this special landscape was formed when the Indian Plate crashed into the Eurasian Plate, pushing the mountains up from what used to be part of an ocean.

Pangong Tso, Ladakh

Most of the land has sand and clay. Over many years, wind and rain have shaped the mountains into unusual and beautiful forms.

Analyze Thoughts

Pick a place with extreme weather, like the Thar Desert. Learn how people survive there—their food, clothes, and homes. Then compare it with the way people live in Ladakh.

People and Culture of Ladakh

Even with the harsh weather, Ladakh is home to animals such as the snow leopard, ibex, and Tibetan antelope. The people live simple lives and enjoy bright festivals like Losar and the Hemis Festival. The region is also famous for its ancient monasteries.

Monastery

Losar Festival

Himalayan Ibex

Yaks used for transport

THE GANGETIC PLAINS

Stretching south from the foothills of the Himalayas, the Gangetic Plains form a wide, low-lying region full of fertile soil. Rivers like the Ganga, Yamuna and Brahmaputra bring mineral-rich silt,

making the land perfect for farming. These rivers are important for producing hydroelectricity, transport and trade. Roads and railways help people and goods travel long distances easily. For thousands of years, rivers such as the Ganga and Brahmaputra have been used for travel and trade. A large part of India's population lives in these plains.

The Indian Gharial

Modern Farming

Multiple Cropping

Do you know?

Most rivers in India are named after goddesses, like Ganga, Yamuna, and Kaveri. But the Brahmaputra is different. Its name means "son of Brahma." In summer, its water level rises because of melting snow.

THE GREAT INDIAN DESERT OR THAR DESERT

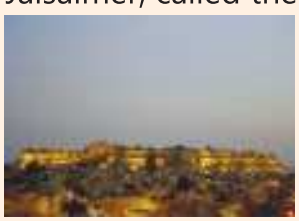
The Thar Desert is a huge area of golden sand dunes, rough land and endless sky.

Sand dunes are made when strong winds move the sand into hill-like shapes, some reaching up to 150 metres high.

Rajasthan Thar Dessert

The Thar is a large dry region. Most of it is in India, covering Rajasthan, Gujarat, Punjab and Haryana. The desert also acts as a natural barrier because its tough conditions make it hard for people and animals to move around.

Jaisalmer, called the "Golden City," is in the heart of the Thar Desert in India. The Jaisalmer Fort here is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.



Jaisalmer Fort

Rajasthan is also known for its traditional water-saving methods. Taanka or Kunds are used to collect and store rainwater for drinking during dry seasons.

Taanka

THE ARAVALLI HILLS

The Aravalli Hills are one of the oldest mountain ranges in the world, around 2.5 billion years old. The range is made up of many low hills and ridges. The highest peak, Guru Shikhar on Mount Abu, is over 1,700 metres high, while most hills are between 300 and 900 metres. Interestingly, in just four and a half hours by car, you can travel from the cool hills of Mount Abu to the hot sands of Jodhpur in the Thar Desert, showing how different the landscapes are.

The Aravalli are very important for north-western India's geography and climate. They act as a natural barrier, helping to stop the Thar Desert from spreading eastward. These hills are also rich in minerals like marble, granite, zinc, and copper. Mining and construction have been carried out here for many years. At Zawar, people learned how to extract zinc from rocks over 800 years ago,

making it one of the earliest zinc production centers in the world. Many famous forts, including Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, and Ranthambore, are also found in the Aravallis.

Kumbhalgarh Fort

Chittorgarh Fort

Ranthambore Fort

THE PENINSULAR PLATEAU

The Peninsular Plateau is one of India's oldest and most important landforms, covering a large part of central and southern India. It is triangular in shape and is called a peninsula because it is surrounded by water on three sides—the Arabian Sea, the Bay of Bengal, and the Indian Ocean.

The plateau is bordered by two main mountain ranges:

The Western Ghats on the west, which are taller and form a continuous wall along the western coast. During the monsoon, many waterfalls appear along their steep slopes. These hills are a UNESCO World Heritage Site, rich in plants and animals, and the source of many rivers. The northern part of this range is called the Sahyadri Hills.

Power House Waterfalls at Periyakanal

The Eastern Ghats on the east, which are lower and broken into smaller hills stretching along the eastern coast. Between these ranges lies the Deccan Plateau, a large flat area. Several rivers flow across it, such as the Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri, which move from west to east. These rivers are very important for farming, drinking water and hydroelectric power. Some rivers, like the Narmada and Tapti, flow westward into the Arabian Sea.

Peninsular Plateau

The Peninsular Plateau is also rich in minerals, forests and fertile soil, making it very important for India's economy. Its forests are home to many tribal communities like the Bhil and Korku, who have their own languages, cultures and live closely connected to nature.

The plateau also has many scenic waterfalls formed where rivers flow over rocky and uneven land. These waterfalls are useful for tourism, irrigation and generating electricity.

INDIA'S AMAZING COASTLINES

India has a long coastline of more than 7,500 kilometres. It is full of natural beauty, with golden sandy beaches, dark rocks, steep cliffs, green forests, coral reefs and dense jungles on some islands.

The West Coast of India

The West Coast of India runs from Gujarat to Kerala, passing through Maharashtra, Goa and Karnataka. Most rivers here flow fast from the Western Ghats, but large rivers like the Narmada and the Tapti flow west into the Arabian Sea, with the Narmada and the Tapti being the biggest. This coast has many important ports and cities that have been centres of trade for thousands of years.

Western Coastal Plains

The East Coast of India

The East Coast lies between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal, stretching from the Ganga Delta to Kanyakumari. It has wide plains and large river deltas formed by rivers like the Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri. These deltas are very fertile and help farmers grow crops. Important water bodies such as Chilika Lake and Pulicat Lake, which are lagoons, are also found along this coast.

Eastern Coastal Plains

Analyze Thoughts

On a blank physical map of India, find and mark the rivers: Godavari, Krishna, and Kaveri.

In-Text Questions

1. Name one tribal community that lives in the forests of the Peninsular Plateau.
2. Which two rivers flow westward into the Arabian Sea from the Western Ghats?
3. Why is Ladakh sometimes called "moonland"?
4. Which famous forts are found in the Aravalli Hills?

INDIAN ISLANDS

India has many islands in the Indian Ocean, Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal. The two main groups are the Lakshadweep Islands in the Arabian Sea and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands in the Bay of Bengal. These islands are famous for their rare animals, stunning beaches, coral reefs and even volcanoes. Some ancient tribes have lived on these islands for thousands of years.

Lakshadweep Islands

The Lakshadweep Islands are a group of 36 coral islands located near the coast of Kerala. Only a few of these islands have people living on them. This region is important for fishing, studying sea resources and protecting nature.

Coral Reef, Lakshadweep

Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Coral Reef, Andaman and Nicobar

The Andaman and Nicobar Islands are made up of over 500 volcanic islands, divided into two groups—The Andaman Islands in the North and Nicobar Islands in the South. India's only active volcano 'Barren Island', is located here. These islands are important for India's security because they help watch over the surrounding seas. They are home to a wide variety of plants and animals. The Cellular Jail in the Andaman Islands is a famous historical site where freedom fighters were kept during British rule. It reminds us of their brave sacrifices.

In-Text Questions

Write True or False.

1. The Lakshadweep Islands are made up of more than 500 volcanic islands.
2. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands help India monitor the surrounding seas for security purposes.
3. Some ancient tribes have lived on India's islands for thousands of years.

THE SUNDARBANS AND THE DELTA IN WEST BENGAL

Royal Bengal Tiger

If we travel from the islands towards the eastern side of the Himalayas through the Bay of Bengal, we reach the Sundarbans. This area is part of the delta formed by the Ganga, Brahmaputra and their smaller rivers. It is a special place where rivers, land and the sea meet. The Sundarbans is named after the Sundari trees, a type of mangrove that grows well in the salty, muddy water of the region.

Shadsuk Mynsiem Festival

The Sundarbans is shared by two countries—half is in India and half in Bangladesh. It is a protected region and a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Many animals live here, including the famous Royal Bengal Tiger.

THE NORTHEAST HILLS

The north-eastern part of India has a series of high lands that are part of the Meghalaya Plateau. On the map, you can see the Garo, Khasi and Jaintia Hills. This region is famous for its thick forests, heavy rainfall and beautiful waterfalls. The Northeast gets some of the highest rainfall in the world, making the land very fertile and full of plants and animals. Its natural beauty draws many visitors every year.

Indian State of Meghalaya

Go Further

On a blank physical map of India, find and mark the Sundarbans delta. Show the rivers that join to form this delta.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Desert:** A dry area with very little rain and few plants.
- **Subcontinent:** A big part of a continent that is clearly separate, like India in Asia.
- **Biodiversity:** The different kinds of plants and animals living in one place.
- **Plateau:** A flat area of land that is higher than the land around it.
- **Delta:** Land formed at the end of a river where it drops sand and soil into the sea.

QUICK TAKE

- India has several major landforms: the Himalayas, the Indo-Gangetic Plains, the Thar Desert, the Peninsular Plateau, the Coastal Plains, and the Islands.
- The Himalayas are the tallest mountains and give rise to many rivers.
- The Indo-Gangetic Plains have fertile soil and support large populations.
- The Thar Desert is dry, with special ways for people and animals to survive and save water.
- The Peninsular Plateau is rich in minerals and home to many tribal communities.
- The coasts and islands are important for trade, wildlife, and cultural connections.

EXERCISES

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which mountain range forms India's northern boundary?
   (a) Western Ghats mountain range ☐ (b) Eastern Ghats hill range ☐
   (c) Himalayan mountain range ☐ (d) Aravalli hill mountain range ☐
2. Why are the Himalayas called the 'Water Tower of Asia'?
   (a) Many rivers originate here ☐ (b) Heavy rainfall every year ☐
   (c) Many lakes are found here ☐ (d) Big glaciers move slowly ☐
3. Which is the highest Himalayan range?
   (a) Shivalik ☐ (b) Himadri ☐
   (c) Himachal ☐ (d) Aravalli hill ☐
4. Which region is known as india's cold desert?
   (a) Thar desert ☐ (b) Ladakh desert ☐
   (c) Rajasthan desert ☐ (d) Kutch desert ☐
5. Which rivers make the Gangetic Plains fertile?
   (a) Narmada and Tapti ☐ (b) Godavari and Krishna ☐
   (c) Ganga and Brahmaputra ☐ (d) Kaveri and Mahanadi ☐

B. Write 'T' True or 'F' for False.

1. India is located in South Asia and is the seventh largest country in the world.
2. The Himalayas form India's northern boundary like a natural wall.
3. The Himalayas are known as the 'Water Tower of Asia'.
4. Ladakh is a hot desert with high rainfall.
5. The Gangetic Plains have fertile soil brought by rivers.
6. The Thar Desert covers parts of Rajasthan and Gujarat.

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A with Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Thar Desert	A. Glaciers and snow
2. Himalayas	B. Deltas and Estuaries
3. Coastal Plains	C. Rich in minerals
4. Peninsular Plateau	D. Sand Dunes

(a) 1-C, 2-B, 3-D, 4-A
(b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C
(c) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D
(d) 1-D, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions have two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Choose the correct answer from the options below:

1. Assertion (A) : The Himalayas are called the Water Tower of Asia.
   Reason (R) : Many major rivers originate from the Himalayas.
2. **Assertion (A)** : The Western Ghats are rich in plants and animals.
   Reason (R) : The Western Ghats are a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
3. **Assertion (A)** : The Aravalli Hills help stop the Thar Desert from spreading eastward.
   Reason (R) : The Aravalli Hills act as a natural barrier.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Ladakh is known as a cold desert.
   Reason (R) : Ladakh receives very little rainfall and has very low temperatures.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are correct, and (R) correctly explains (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) does not explain (A).
(c) (A) is correct, but (R) is wrong.
(d) (A) is wrong, but (R) is correct.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Identify the images and write their names.

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why is the Sundarbans region important for animals, forests and the people living there?
2. How do mountains, plains and plateaus in India work together to support life and farming?
3. Why are the Eastern Coastal Plains suitable for growing crops and farming activities?
4. How do the Himalayas influence India's rivers and the amount of rainfall in many regions?
5. How do people in the Thar Desert manage their daily life in such a hot and dry climate?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Explain how rivers that start in the Himalayas help farming, generate hydroelectric power, and support the lives of millions of people in India.
2. Describe how India's different physical features influence transport routes, communication systems and where people choose to live.
3. Imagine the Himalayas stopped rising and began wearing away quickly. How might this change India's climate, rainfall and landforms in the future?

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

The Peninsular Plateau of India

The Peninsular Plateau is one of India's oldest and most important landforms, covering a large part of central and southern India. It is mostly triangular and is called a peninsula because it is surrounded by water on three sides—the Arabian Sea, the Bay of Bengal, and the Indian Ocean. Two main mountain ranges border the plateau. The Western Ghats in the west are tall, continuous and full of forests. During the monsoon, waterfalls flow down their steep slopes. The northern part of this range is called the Sahyadri Hills. The Eastern Ghats in the east are lower, broken, and scattered. Between them lies the Deccan Plateau, a wide flat area. Rivers like the Godavari, Krishna and Kaveri flow eastward, while the Narmada and the Tapti flow west. The plateau is rich in minerals, fertile soil, and forests, supporting tribal communities like the Bhil and Korku. Its waterfalls are useful for tourism, irrigation, and electricity.

1. Name the two mountain ranges that border the plateau.
2. What makes the Western Ghats important during the monsoon?
3. How are the Eastern Ghats different from the Western Ghats?

VI. PROJECT WORK

Exploring a UNESCO Heritage Site

I. Objective:

- Understand the value of India's natural and cultural treasures.
- Improve skills in research, thinking and sharing ideas clearly.

II. Tasks:

- Pick one UNESCO World Heritage place from the chapter (for example, Sundarbans, Great Himalayan National Park, Kumbhalgarh Fort).
- Find details using books, websites or by talking to elders.
- Write a short paragraph describing what makes this site special and why you like it.
- Make a poster or collage with images or sketches and show 3–4 important facts clearly.

III. Expected Learning Outcome:

Students will be able to describe the uniqueness of a UNESCO Heritage Site and express personal reflections.

2 Understanding the Weather

Let's Learn About

- What weather is and what its main elements are such as temperature, rainfall, air pressure, wind, and humidity.
- The work of meteorologists and why weather forecasts are important.
- How traditional knowledge and modern science both help us understand weather.
- Simple and responsible actions to help reduce climate change.

Let's Gear Up

Rahul and Ankit at the Park

Rahul rubbed his hands as a cool wind blew across the park. "Wow, it's really chilly today! I'm glad I wore my jacket," he said. Ankit smiled, "Yes, but think about last month. It was so hot that we needed caps and cold drinks all the time!" Rahul looked up at the sky. "The weather keeps changing. Sometimes it's bright and sunny, sometimes cloudy, windy or even rainy."

Ankit nodded. "These changes—like temperature, rain, wind and humidity—are called the elements of weather. They decide how the day feels."

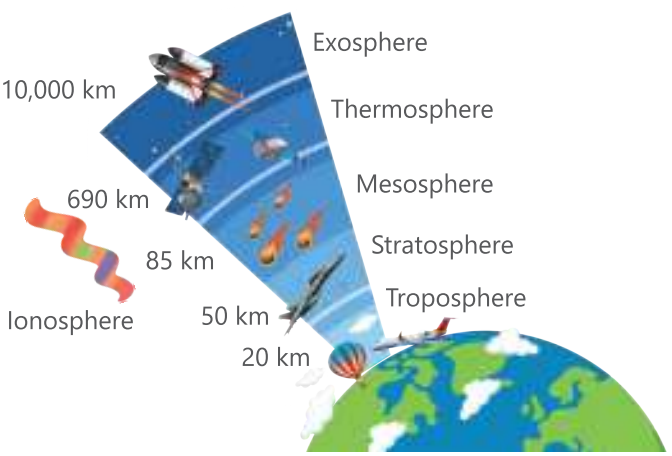
Rahul grinned, "So when we carry umbrellas or wear woollens, we are adjusting to the weather!"

"Exactly," said Ankit. "Let's learn more about how weather works and how it shapes our daily lives."

WEATHER

Weather is how the air around us feels at a particular time and place. But what is the atmosphere? It is the layer of gases that surrounds a planet. On Earth, we call these gases air. You can imagine the atmosphere like a cake with many layers stacked on top of each other.

The layer closest to the Earth's surface is called the troposphere. This is where all land plants, animals and humans live and breathe. It is also where clouds form, rain falls, and winds blow.



Layers of Atmosphere

We describe weather with words like hot, cold, rainy, cloudy, humid, snowy, or windy. Almost all weather events we see—storms, rain and clouds—happen in the troposphere.

This layer stretches about 6 to 18 kilometres above the ground. It is thinner at the poles, where cold air shrinks, and thicker at the equator, where warm air expands.

In-Text Questions

1. The layer of gases closest to the Earth's surface, where clouds form and winds blow, is called the _____.
2. Traditional signs, such as birds flying low or ants carrying eggs, were used by people to predict _____.

ELEMENTS OF WEATHER

Temperature: How hot or cold the air around us is.

Precipitation: Any form of water that falls from the sky, like rain, snow, sleet or hail.

Atmospheric Pressure: The weight of the air above us, pressing down on the Earth's surface.

Wind: The movement of air, including its speed and direction.

Humidity: The amount of water vapour in the air.

Reading the Signals of Nature

Since ancient times, people have been curious about the weather. Long before satellites, radios, or mobile apps existed, they closely watched nature to guess what the weather might bring.

They observed that:

- Birds flying low in the sky often meant rain was coming.
- Ants moving their eggs to higher places warned of heavy rain.
- Frogs croaking loudly in the forests showed that rain might arrive soon.
- Squirrels storing nuts pointed to the arrival of a new season.
- Pine cones opening or closing also gave clues about moisture: they close when it is wet and open when the air is dry.

Over the last few centuries, scientists have developed ways to measure these elements accurately. Using this data, meteorologists predict how the weather will change in a few hours, days or even weeks. Do they just look at the sky and guess? Not at all! They use special instruments to help.

WEATHER INSTRUMENTS

Temperature

Temperature tells us how hot or cold the air, water, or objects are. We measure it using a tool called a thermometer.

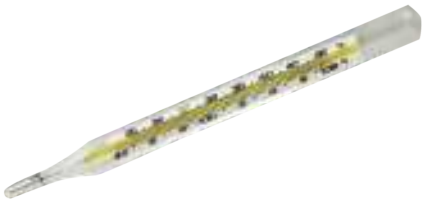
Clinical Thermometer

Types of Thermometers:

Clinical Thermometer: Used to check body temperature.

Laboratory Thermometer: Used to measure the temperature of liquids, chemicals, or other things in experiments.

Temperature can be measured in Celsius (°C) or Fahrenheit (°F). For example, 15°C equals 59°F.



Laboratory Thermometer

Different types of Thermometers

Some thermometers measure the current air temperature, which is called ambient temperature. Others can show the highest (maximum) and lowest (minimum) temperature of the day. For example, in the morning it was 10°C (minimum), and in the afternoon it was 28°C (maximum). These readings can also help calculate important values like:

Range of Temperature: The difference between the maximum and minimum temperatures in 24 hours.

(Range = Maximum – Minimum)

Mean Daily Temperature: The average temperature of the day, calculated by adding the maximum and minimum temperatures and dividing the total by 2.

(Mean = (Maximum + Minimum) ÷ 2)

How do Thermometers Work?

Many thermometers have coloured liquid, usually alcohol or mercury. When it gets hot, the liquid expands and rises. When it cools, the liquid shrinks and drops. Today, we mostly use digital thermometers because they are more accurate, give exact readings and can show highest, lowest and average temperatures.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) was started in 1875. Its important motto is 'Adityat Jayate Vrishti', which means "From the sun comes rain, from rain comes food, and from food, all living things grow." This line comes from the ancient Indian text Manusmriti and highlights how sun, rain and food are linked to life on Earth.

Go Further

Chart of temperatures of Chandigarh city

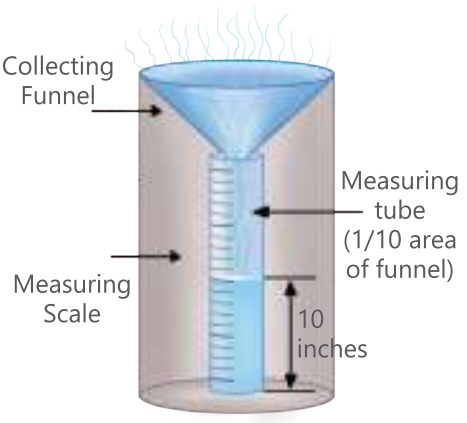
Date	Minimum Temperature (in °C)	Maximum Temperature (in °C)
07.03.2026	15	31
08.03.2026	16	32
09.03.2026	16	32
10.03.2026	16	33
11.03.2026	15	33
12.03.2026	15	32
13.03.2026	15	32

What is the maximum temperature recorded in this week? What is the minimum? Calculate the range for this city?

Precipitation

When the news says that a place received 30 mm of rainfall in one day, it tells us how much rain actually fell there. Imagine keeping a flat plate outside in the open. By the end of the day, the rainwater collected on it would form a layer 30 mm deep.

Rainfall is measured with a tool called a rain gauge. When it rains, water falls into a funnel and collects in a container below. There are markings on the container that show the level of water. If the water level reaches 5 mm, it means the place has received 5 mm of rainfall.



Rain Gauge

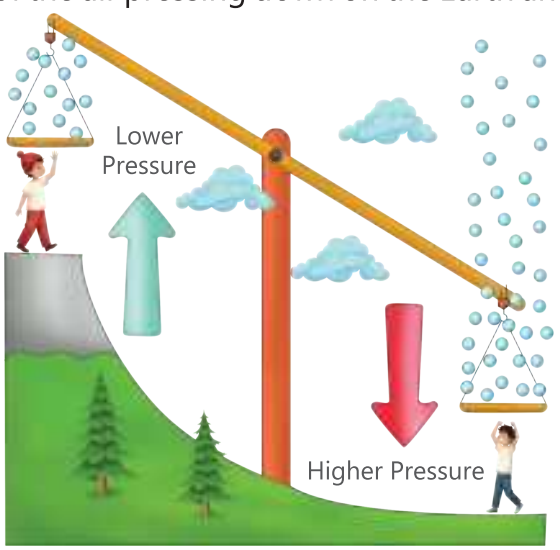
Analyze Thoughts

You can easily make a rain gauge using waste items like plastic bottles, old glass jars, or empty tin cans. Paste a strip of paper or tie a thread outside to mark the scale. Keep it in an open place and check the water level when it rains. Measure and record the rainfall during the next shower.

Atmospheric Pressure

We can easily feel changes in heat and rainfall. But have you noticed that the air feels 'heavy' before a thunderstorm? This happens because of atmospheric pressure. Atmospheric pressure is the weight of the air pressing down on the Earth and everything around us.

Air pressure is higher near sea level and becomes lower as we move up mountains. When you climb higher, the air becomes thin. This means there is less oxygen to breathe. So, people may feel breathless, tired or dizzy at high places because the body must work harder to get enough oxygen.



Atmospheric Pressure

Air pressure is not always high at low levels. Sometimes it drops suddenly. Weather experts call this a depression or a low-pressure system. Such conditions can cause storms or even cyclones. Air pressure is measured with an instrument called a barometer. It is usually measured in millibars (mb). Normal pressure at sea level is about 1013 mb. If it falls below 1000 mb, it shows a depression.

Wind

Wind is moving air. It blows from areas of high air pressure to areas of low air pressure. When we talk about wind, two main things matter:

First, is the direction of the wind (the side it comes from) and second is the speed of the wind (how fast it blows). Wind is very important for our weather in many ways.

- Weather scientists called meteorologists, study wind direction and speed to forecast the weather.

- Pilots and sailors must understand the wind to fly airplanes and sail ships safely.
- Farmers observe the wind to guess where rain clouds might come from.
- Strong winds can also make the soil dry more quickly.

In-Text Questions

1. Why might a mountain climber feel tired and breathless even when the weather is pleasant and sunny?
2. If one city records a maximum temperature of 32°C and a minimum of 20°C, how would you calculate the range of temperature for that day?
3. Why do pilots carefully check wind direction and speed before taking off from an airport?

A wind vane shows the direction of the wind. It has an arrow on one side and a broad tail on the other. When the wind blows, the tail turns, and the arrow points to the direction from which the wind is coming.

Wind Vane

Wind Sock

A windsock is mostly seen at airports. It is a long cloth tube that fills with air and shows wind direction. Pilots look at it to check wind conditions before take-off and landing.

An anemometer measures how fast the wind is blowing. It has small cups attached to arms that rotate when the wind blows. The stronger the wind, the faster the cups turn. The speed is shown on a dial or digital screen in kilometres per hour (km/h).

Anemometer

Humidity

How Do We Measure Humidity?

Humidity is the amount of water vapours present in the air. It is affected by temperature, wind, air pressure and location. For example, places close to the sea usually have more humidity than places far away from it. Humidity tells us how moist or dry the air feels. When humidity is high, we feel warmer and sweat more. When humidity is low, the air feels dry, and water dries up faster. Humidity also influences weather, farming, industries, and even the protection of old objects kept in museums.

Hygrometer

Humidity is measured as relative humidity. Air with no water vapours (which does not happen in nature) is taken as 0%, while air completely filled with water vapours is 100%. Usually, dry weather has relative humidity between 20% and 40%. Humid weather generally ranges from 60% to 80%.

Hygrometer

We measure humidity with an instrument called a hygrometer. It shows the amount of moisture in the air as a percentage. There are different kinds of hygrometers, such as wet and dry bulb hygrometers and digital hygrometers, based on how they measure humidity.

Do you know?

Museums and art galleries use hygrometers to check humidity levels. This helps protect old books, paintings and statues from damage.

WEATHER STATIONS

To understand the weather of a place at any time, we need many instruments. A weather station keeps all these tools together in one area. This helps in measuring and recording weather conditions easily. Weather stations take readings at fixed time gaps. These records help scientists study, map, and forecast the weather.

Automated Weather Station (AWS)

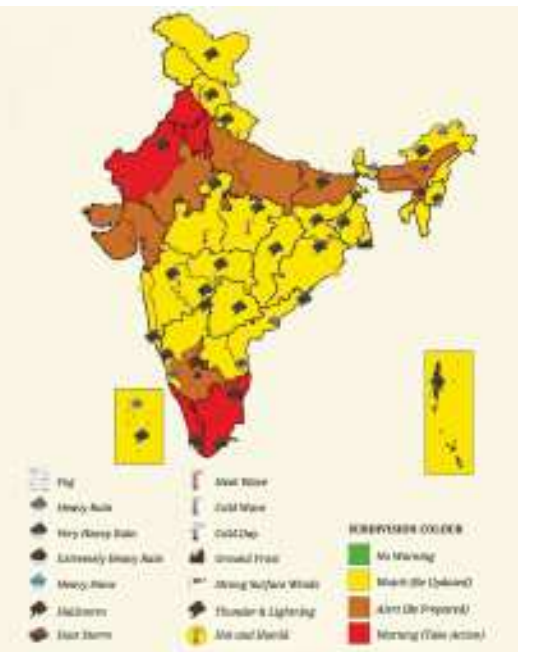
An Automated Weather Station (AWS) works on its own without human control. It uses special sensors to measure and record weather details such as:

- Atmospheric temperature, humidity, wind speed and direction, rainfall and air pressure.
- These stations are useful in farming, air travel, sea travel and checking environmental changes.
- The biggest advantage is that AWS gives correct and quick weather reports automatically.

Automated Weather Station

PREDICTING THE WEATHER

Meteorologists are scientists who study weather. They gather data from different weather instruments over time and carefully examine it. Using scientific methods and computer models, they try to forecast what the weather will be like in the coming days. These predictions are very important today because climate change is causing extreme weather events like droughts, floods, cyclones and storms. Accurate forecasts help people get ready for such conditions and let governments plan ahead. For example, fishermen can be warned not to go to sea during a storm and people in coastal areas can be safely moved before a cyclone hits.



Weather Warning for India: 19 May, 2025

Go Further

In 2023, NDMA installed an AWS at Sikkim's glacial lake. How can it prevent disasters?

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Atmospheric pressure:** The weight of air on Earth's surface.
- **Humidity:** How much water vapour is in the air.
- **Meteorologist:** Scientist who studies and predicts the weather.
- **Precipitation:** Water falling from the sky, like rain.
- **Temperature:** How hot or cold the air is.
- **Rain gauge:** Tool used to measure rainfall amount accurately.
- **Weather:** How the air feels at a certain place.
- **Atmosphere:** The layer of gases around the Earth.
- **Troposphere:** The lowest layer where weather happens.

QUICK TAKE

- Weather shows the air's condition at a specific place.
- Main weather elements: temperature, precipitation, atmospheric pressure, wind, humidity.
- Weather tools: thermometer (temperature), rain gauge (rain), barometer (pressure), anemometer (wind), hygrometer (humidity).
- Meteorologists use data from weather station and AWS for forecasts.
- Combining traditional knowledge with science improves weather understanding.

EXERCISES

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. What is weather?
   (a) Air around us ☐ (b) Sunlight only ☐
   (c) Clouds only ☐ (d) Rain only ☐
2. Rainfall is measured by?
   (a) Thermometer ☐ (b) Rain gauge ☐
   (c) Windsock ☐ (d) Barometer ☐
3. Humidity is measured by?
   (a) Barometer ☐ (b) Thermometer ☐
   (c) Rain gauge ☐ (d) Hygrometer ☐
4. Air pressure is measured by?
   (a) Thermometer ☐ (b) Barometer ☐
   (c) Windsock ☐ (d) Hygrometer ☐
5. Wind speed is measured by?
   (a) Thermometer ☐ (b) Wind vane ☐
   (c) Anemometer ☐ (d) Hygrometer ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. The troposphere is thinner at the equator.
2. Precipitation includes snow and hail.
3. Barometers measure wind speed.
4. Windsocks show wind direction.
5. Digital thermometers cannot show maximum temperature.

C. Fill in the blanks.

1. The layer of gases that surrounds the Earth is called the _____.
2. Almost all weather events happen in the _____ layer of the atmosphere.
3. The tool used to measure rainfall is called a _____.
4. Air moves from areas of high pressure to areas of low pressure, and this movement is called _____.
5. The average temperature of the day can be calculated using the maximum and minimum temperatures and is called the _____.

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : Wind always blows from areas of low pressure to areas of high pressure.
   Reason (R) : Wind is caused by differences in atmospheric pressure.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Meteorologists use instruments and computer models to predict the weather.
   Reason (R) : Observing clouds alone is sufficient to forecast weather accurately.
3. **Assertion (A)** : A rain gauge measures the amount of rainfall.
   Reason (R) : Rainwater collected in a funnel and container can be measured in millimeters.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Atmospheric pressure is the weight of the air pressing down on Earth.
   Reason (R) : Air pressure decreases with altitude, making it harder to breathe at high places.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Look at the images carefully. Can you identify the weather instrument shown in each picture? Write their names.

_____

_____

_____

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. How can old traditional weather signs, like birds and pine cones, help scientists make better forecasts today?
2. How did people in ancient times connect the sun with the timing of rain and monsoon?
3. How does an Automated Weather Station (AWS) help communities prepare for changing climate conditions?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why is learning about weather and meteorology useful in our daily life, from farming to traveling safely?
2. What is atmospheric pressure? How does it affect us in higher altitudes?
3. Explain why different weather instruments, like thermometers, barometers and rain gauges, are all important for forecasting weather.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

Weather Forecasting for Food Security

In a drought-prone village in Maharashtra, farmers often lost crops because they relied only on traditional signs, like birds or animal behaviour, to guess rainfall. Recently, the village started receiving IMD weather updates on mobile phones. Farmers also set up a simple rain gauge and barometer at the community centre. That year, they waited to sow seeds until the IMD confirmed enough rainfall. They also used forecasts to plan irrigation during dry periods. By combining traditional knowledge with scientific forecasts, the farmers harvested more grain than in earlier years.

(a) What did the rain gauge measure at the centre?

(b) Why did farmers lose crops before using weather forecasts?

(c) How can mobile phones help share IMD warnings quickly in remote areas?

VI. PROJECT WORK

"Rainfall in Millimeters" – From Drops to Millimeters

I. Objective:

- Understand rainfall depth (mm) and why it's better than "litres" for comparing places.

II. Tasks:

- Using the DIY rain gauge, collect 3-5 days of data.
- Convert & visualize: Make a simple bar chart (day vs. mm).
- Apply: If 25 mm falls on the school ground (e.g., 2,000 m^2), how deep is the water layer? What would that mean for runoff, puddles, or garden watering?
- Discuss: Why farmers/planners care about mm, intensity, and distribution (drought/flood risk, sowing windows).

III. Expected Learning Outcome:

- Interpret mm rainfall as a depth applicable anywhere.
- Link rainfall data to real decisions (water use, drainage).

3 Climates of India

Let's Learn About

- The difference between weather, seasons and climate.
- The different climate types in India and the factors that shape them.
- How the monsoon winds influence life across India.
- How climate affects the economy, culture and natural hazards.

Let's Gear Up

A Weather Wonder

It was a bright and cheerful Saturday morning when Rhea and Arjun decided to go for a picnic in the park. They carried sandwiches, juices and fruits in their colourful baskets. As they spread out their mat under a big tree, the sun shone warmly on them. But soon, Rhea noticed something unusual.

Rhea said, "The sun is shining here, but look at those dark clouds over the hills!"

Arjun looked around and said, "That's strange! My cousin in Shimla says it's still cool and foggy there, while my uncle in Chennai says it's hot all the time."

Rhea wondered aloud, "How can the weather be so different in the same country?"

Arjun smiled, "Maybe it's not just weather... it's climate. India has many kinds—mountain, desert coastal, and more!"

As the first drops of rain began to fall, everyone ran under the big banyan tree. Rhea and Arjun laughed together. Today's picnic had turned into a small adventure and gave them a new curiosity: why does India have so many climates and how do they affect our daily life?

WEATHER, SEASONS AND CLIMATE

Weather

Weather is what we feel around us each day, like hot, cold, rainy or windy conditions. It can change very fast, sometimes within a few hours.

Climate

Climate is the usual type of weather a place has over a very long time, often many years. It stays more steady and does not change quickly like weather.

Seasons happen because the Earth is tilted on its axis and moves around the Sun. Each season stays for a few months and returns every year. In many parts of the world, there are four main seasons: spring, summer, autumn, and winter. But in India, we follow six traditional seasons known as ritus: Vasanta (spring), Grishma (summer), Varsha (rainy season), Sharad (autumn), Hemant (early winter), and Shishir (winter). These seasons influence our food, clothes, daily life and even the festivals we celebrate.

TYPES OF CLIMATES IN INDIA

India has many types of climates. The weather changes from place to place.

Alpine Climate: (Himalayan Mountains)

In the far north, the Himalayan mountains have an alpine climate, with freezing, snowy winters and pleasant summers. People here wear thick, woollen clothes to feel warm and safe.

(The word 'Alpine' comes from the Alps, a famous mountain range in Europe.)

Himalayan Mountains

Northern Plains

Temperate Climate: (Lower Himalayas and Hill Areas)

In the lower Himalayas and many hilly parts of India, the climate is temperate, with cool winters and comfortably warm summers. Many hill stations are found here, where people visit to get relief from the hot plains.

Subtropical Climate: Northern Plains

The northern plains have a subtropical climate, with extremely hot summers and chilly winters. This area grows most of India's wheat and many other useful crops.

Arid Climate: Thar Desert Western Desert

The Thar Desert has an arid climate with very hot days, cool nights and very little rain. People living here use special ways to collect, store and save water carefully.

Thar Desert

Western Coastal Area

Tropical Wet Climate: (Western Coastal Strip)

The western coastal regions get heavy rain during the monsoon season, creating a tropical wet climate. This weather is perfect for growing rice and many kinds of spices.

Semi-arid Climate: (Deccan Plateau)

The central Deccan Plateau has a semi-arid climate, with very hot summers, cool winters and moderate rainfall during the monsoon season.

Deccan Plateau

Tropical Climate: (Eastern India and Southern Peninsula)

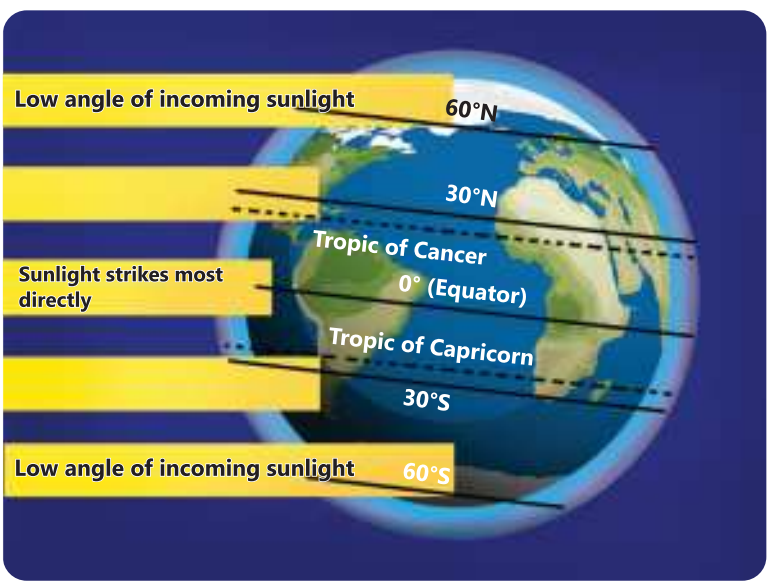
Eastern and southern India have a tropical climate, with warm winters and clearly marked wet and dry seasons caused by the monsoon winds.

FACTORS THAT AFFECT CLIMATE

Climate changes from place to place. Why is it freezing in the mountains but warm near the sea? Many factors cause this–some affect the whole Earth, while others work only in one area. Let's explore the most important ones.

Latitude-Distance from the Equator

The climate of a place depends a lot on how much sunlight it gets. One key factor is latitude. These are imaginary lines around the Earth that tell us how far a place is from the Equator. Places near the Equator get more sunlight and stay hotter. Places far from the Equator, near the poles, get less sunlight and are colder. This happens because the Sun's rays fall almost straight on the Equator but at an angle near the poles. Straight rays give more heat, while angled rays spread out and lose energy passing through the atmosphere. In India, Kanniyakumari and the Nicobar Islands are close to the Equator, so they stay warm most of the year. But Srinagar in Jammu & Kashmir, which is much farther from the Equator, experiences a cooler climate.



Sun's Rays Falling on Earth's Surface

Altitude - Height Above Sea Level

Have you ever noticed why people love going to hill stations in summer? The reason is altitude. Altitude means the height of a place above sea level, and it greatly affects the climate of that place. As we go higher above sea level, the temperature becomes lower. That is why many famous tourist places like Munnar, Theni, Udhagamandalam, Madikeri, Mahabaleshwar, Mount Abu, Shimla, Nainital and Shillong are popular during hot months.

We feel changes in temperature mainly because:

1. Air pressure and air density decrease at higher altitudes. Thin air cannot trap much heat, so

the weather feels cool.

2. The Sun's rays first heat the Earth's surface, not the air around us. So, when we move higher away from the ground, we receive less heat.

This is also why the tall peaks of the Himalayas remain covered with snow. They are very high, so the temperature there stays below the freezing point for most of the year.

In-Text Questions

1. Why do people living in the Thar Desert use special methods to store water, and how is it connected to their climate?
2. How does the tilt of the Earth cause different seasons like Vasanta and Shishir in India?
3. Why do many tourists visit hill stations in the Lower Himalayas during summer?
4. How do monsoon winds affect farming in the Deccan Plateau?

Proximity to the Sea - How Close You Are to the Ocean

Have you ever wondered why coastal cities like Mumbai and Chennai do not face extreme heat in summer or severe cold in winter? The reason is the nearby sea. Large water bodies heat up slowly and also cool down slowly. Because of this, they prevent the land close to them from becoming too hot or too cold.

This is known as the moderating effect of the sea. As a result, coastal regions enjoy a mild and steady climate, which is often called a temperate climate.

Let us understand this with an example:

1. Mumbai, located along the Arabian Sea, usually has summer temperatures of about 32°C and winter temperatures around 18°C. The weather remains pleasant most of the year.
2. Nagpur, which is far away from the sea, can become very hot in summer (around 44°C) and quite cold in winter (about 10°C).

Thus, the sea keeps Mumbai's climate balanced and comfortable, while Nagpur experiences greater changes in temperature throughout the year.

Analyze Thoughts

Design Your Dream Coastal City

Imagine you are a city planner building a new seaside city in India.

Think about:

- What kind of houses will suit a hot and humid coastal climate?
- Which trees will you plant to provide shade and block strong sea winds?
- What safety steps will you take to protect people from floods and cyclones?

In-Text Questions

1. Coastal cities have milder weather because large _____ heat up and cool down slowly.
2. The effect of the sea in keeping temperatures steady is called the _____ effect.
3. Cities far from the sea, like Nagpur, experience greater _____ between summer and winter.
4. Mumbai enjoys a _____ climate because it is close to the Arabian Sea.

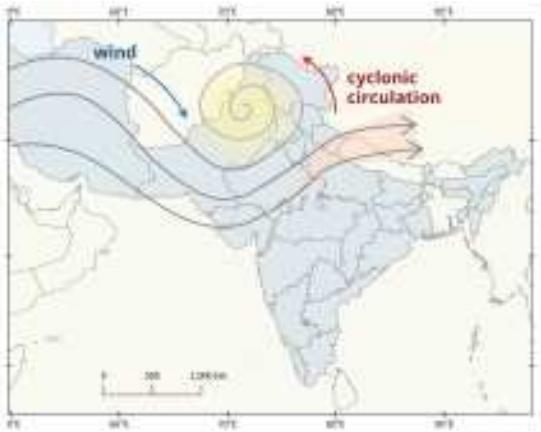
Winds - Movers of Air and Weather

Winds are an important part of the Earth's climate system. They move heat and moisture from one place to another, which is why winds greatly affect a region's temperature and rainfall.

For example:

- In summer, hot and dry winds blow from desert areas in the west (like Arabia and Afghanistan) towards states such as Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Madhya Pradesh. These winds often cause heatwaves.
- In winter, cold winds blow from the Himalayas down to the northern plains and bring cold waves.

  Winds also influence humidity (the amount of water vapour in the air).



Winds

- Winds coming from dry land areas lower humidity and make the air dry.
- Winds blowing from the sea carry moisture and may bring rainfall.

Topography - Shape of the Land Matters

Another important factor that changes climate is the shape of the land, called topography. It includes mountains, hills, valleys, deserts, forests, coasts and plains, and it can influence temperature and rainfall.

For example:

- The Himalayas and Karakoram ranges act like a big wall, blocking cold winds from Central Asia and keeping northern India warmer in winter.
- The Thar Desert is mostly flat and open, so hot and dry winds can move freely across it, making it very hot.

Microclimates-Tiny Weather Worlds

A microclimate is the weather of a very small area that is different from the surrounding region. It can happen because of buildings, trees, hills or nearby water bodies.

For example :

- A valley can stay cool and moist while the nearby plains are hot and dry.
- A city with many concrete buildings and few trees traps heat, creating an urban heat island that is warmer than the nearby countryside.

Local weather can affect plants, animals, the crops we grow and our health too.

Aravalis

Urban heat Islands

Go Further

- Mountains and Rain: Tall mountains can trap clouds, causing heavy rain on one side and dry land on the other, creating unique farming areas.
- Tiny Weather Worlds: Even a small park or pond in a city can make the air cooler, showing how smart planning helps people, plants and animals stay comfortable.

THE MONSOONS - INDIA'S LIFELINE

Monsoon season is one of the most important times in India. It brings water to rivers, moistens the soil, helps crops grow, and supports people, animals and plants. The word monsoon comes from the Arabic word mausim, which means 'season.' Monsoon winds influence large areas of the Indian Ocean, Australia, Africa, and South Asia.

How Do Monsoons Work?

Monsoons follow a yearly pattern. The science may seem tricky, but it is based on one fact: land heats up and cools faster than the ocean. In summer, the land becomes hotter than the ocean, creating low pressure over it. Winds from the cooler, high-pressure ocean blow toward the hot land. These winds carry water, and as the air rises, it cools and brings rain.

Types of Monsoon Wind in India

Summer Monsoon (Southwest Monsoon)

- Starts in early June near India's southern tip.
- Slowly moves north, reaching most of the country by mid-July.
- Winds blow from the south-west, from the sea towards the land.
- Brings heavy rain, especially on the western side of the Western Ghats and some eastern coast areas.

Winter Monsoon (Northeast Monsoon)

- Forms as the land cools in winter, creating high pressure over India.
- Winds blow from land to sea, mostly from the north-east.
- Usually dry, but some pick up moisture from the Bay of Bengal and give rain to Tamil Nadu and eastern India.

Go Further

People in India have watched nature to guess rain, like deep-water fish coming up, golden shower trees flowering, or crows making nests at different heights.

- What signs of rain do you see in your area?

CLIMATE AND OUR LIVES

Losoong

Climate affects people's lives in many ways, shaping culture, jobs and the economy. In India, for example, many festivals follow the seasons and farming cycles, showing how climate and culture are connected.

Chhathpuja

The economy also depends on weather. When the monsoon gives too little rain, crops fail. Women may walk farther to collect water, farm workers may move to cities for work, and food prices often go up, causing inflation. Industries need steady weather and enough water. Around the world, we see that climate and people's livelihoods are linked, and climate disasters make communities even more vulnerable.

Lohri

Pongal

India's climate is not only varied, it can also be risky. Extreme weather like cyclones, floods and landslides happens often and affects people's lives. These disasters can damage homes, ruin crops, block roads and harm both people and animals.

Cyclones

Every year, especially along India's eastern coast, cyclones occur. Some are very strong and cause a lot of damage. They can destroy houses, uproot trees, flood fields and cause big losses. Cyclones also lead to soil erosion and harm the environment. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) watches cyclones carefully and gives warnings so people stay safe. A special team called the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) helps during such events. They are trained to rescue people and provide help in emergencies.

How Are Cyclones Formed?

Cyclones start when the air pressure near the sea drops very low. Air from nearby areas moves in to fill this low-pressure space. As the air comes from the sea, it carries moisture. When the

Eye of the Cyclone

moisture rises, it forms thick clouds and heavy rain. As the storm grows stronger, winds begin to spin in a circle. At the center is a calm, clear area called the eye of the cyclone.

Floods

Floods happen when water spreads over land that is normally dry. They can be caused by heavy rain, rivers or lakes overflowing, or melting glaciers. During the monsoon, floods often occur in states like Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Kerala, and Andhra Pradesh. In mountains, floods can also happen when glacial lakes suddenly burst. If the ice or rocks holding the water break, a huge amount of water rushes down, causing damage. This is called a glacial burst.

In 2013, Uttarakhand faced a terrible disaster when continuous heavy rain caused a glacial lake to burst. Floods and landslides destroyed roads, bridges, and villages near the sacred Kedarnath temple. More than 6,000 people died, including many pilgrims. It was one of the worst natural disasters in India in recent years.

In-Text Questions

1. When too little rain falls during the monsoon, crops may fail and _____ prices often rise.
2. The calm, clear area at the center of a cyclone is called the _____.
3. A sudden rush of water from a glacial lake in the mountains is called a _____.
4. The team trained to rescue people during natural disasters in India is called the _____.

Urban Floods - A Growing Problem

In cities, even a few hours of rain can lead to flooding. This happens because many drains are blocked, buildings are built over waterways, and concrete roads stop water from soaking into the ground.

Landslides - When Hills Collapse

A landslide occurs when rocks, soil, or mud suddenly slides down a slope. This usually happens in hills or mountains, especially after heavy rain or earthquakes. States like Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, and parts of the Western Ghats often face landslides during the monsoon.

Human activities can make landslides more likely. When people cut down forests, build roads or houses without safety rules, or block the natural flow of water, the land becomes weak and can slide more easily.

Landslide

Forest Fires - When Forests Catch Fire

A forest fire is an uncontrolled fire that spreads fast through dry grass, tree and shrubs. It can happen naturally during hot, dry conditions, but often starts because of human carelessness, like throwing a burning matchstick or plastic into dry leaves.

Forest fires are common in states with large forests, such as Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, and the Western Ghats. They destroy plants, harm animals, pollute the air and force people to leave their homes. Forest fires harm both nature and humans.

CLIMATE CHANGE - A CHALLENGE FOR THE FUTURE

Have you noticed that the weather seems more extreme now than before? Across the world and in some regions, climate has always changed naturally, but since the 1800s, human activities have caused most of the rapid changes. People burn fossil fuels like coal, oil, and natural gas, cut down too many trees, pollute rivers and industries, and use resources carelessly. Fossil fuels were formed from plants and animals buried under the Earth millions of years ago.

Climate Change

When we burn these fuels, large amounts of carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases go into the air. Normally, the greenhouse effect keeps the Earth warm enough for life. But with too many gases, extra heat gets trapped, causing fast global warming. This affects climate systems that humans, animals and plants have depended on for thousands of years.

In India, the signs are clear. For example, in early 2025, temperatures were 1°C to 3°C above usual. Winters became shorter and milder, summers hotter, and rainfall patterns unpredictable. These changes affect farmers who rely on regular rains, local industries that need steady water and energy, and daily life in communities.

Governments, including India's, are trying to fight climate change. They cut emissions, plant more trees, promote renewable energy, save electricity, and encourage sustainable habits. Yet, these actions sometimes clash with growing population needs and economic development.

Understanding human-made climate change helps us prepare for disasters like floods, heatwaves and storms. It also reminds everyone—children, adults, and governments—that making eco-friendly choices today protects the Earth for tomorrow. Small actions like saving water, planting trees and using less energy can make a big difference in slowing climate change.

In-Text Questions

1. Why do concrete roads in cities increase the risk of floods?
2. Which human activities can make hills more likely to experience landslides?
3. Name two ways in which forest fires affect both nature and humans.
4. How do human actions like burning fossil fuels and cutting trees lead to faster global warming?

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Climate:** Average weather of a place over many years.
- **Latitude:** Distance from the Equator affecting temperature and climate.
- **Altitude:** Height above sea level; higher places are cooler.
- **Cyclone:** Strong, circular storm formed over low-pressure areas.
- **Topography:** Shape of land, including mountains, valleys, and plains.
- **Arid Climate:** Very dry areas with very little rainfall.
- **Microclimate:** Small-area climate different from the surrounding region.
- **Urban Heat Island:** Cities get hotter due to buildings and pollution.

QUICK TAKE

- Weather shows daily air conditions; climate shows long-term patterns.
- India has six traditional seasons (Ritus): vasanta, grishma, varsha, sharad, hemant, shishir.
- India has different climate zones: alpine, temperate, subtropical, arid, tropical wet, semi-arid, tropical.
- Main factors affecting climate: latitude, altitude, sea distance, winds, topography.
- Monsoons are important for farming, affecting crops and livelihoods.
- Extreme weather events include cyclones, floods, landslides, forest fires.
- Climate change is rising due to human activities worldwide.
- Adaptation and awareness help reduce climate disaster impacts.

EXERCISES

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. What kind of climate does the That Desert have?
   (a) Tropical ☐ (b) Arid ☐
   (c) Temperate ☐ (d) Alpine ☐
2. One visible sign of climate change in India is:
   (a) Longer winters ☐ (b) Decrease in sea level ☐
   (c) Heavy snowfall in deserts ☐ (d) Shorter, milder winters ☐
3. Which monsoon winds blow from the sea towards the land?
   (a) Northeast ☐ (b) Southwest ☐
   (c) Southeast ☐ (d) Northwest ☐
4. The centre of a cyclone, which is cloudless and culm, is called:
   (a) Storm zone ☐ (b) Cyclone circle ☐
   (c) Eye of the cyclone ☐ (d) Depression centre ☐

5. Since the 19th century, climate change has been driven mainly by:

(a) Human activities ☐ (b) Natural forces ☐

(c) Solar eclipse ☐ (d) Earthquakes ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. Weather changes quickly, but climate stays mostly steady. ☐
2. India experiences only four seasons throughout the year. ☐
3. Coastal cities have milder climate due to nearby oceans. ☐
4. The Thar Desert receives heavy rainfall every year. ☐
5. Winds can carry moisture and influence rainfall patterns. ☐
6. Forest fires in India happen only naturally, never by humans. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Mawsynram	A. Retreating Monsoon
2. Loo	B. Hot Dry Wind
3. Western Disturbances	C. Heaviest rainfall
4. Chennai	D. Winter rain in North
5. Tropical Climate	E. Southern India

(a) 1-C, 2-B, 3-D, 4-A, 5-E (b) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D, 5-E

(c) 1-A, 2-D, 3-C, 4-E, 5-B (d) 1-D, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C, 5-E

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : Coastal cities have milder winters and summers than inland cities.

   Reason (R) : Large water bodies heat up and cool down slowly, moderating the temperature of nearby land.

2. **Assertion (A)** : The Thar Desert is extremely hot in summer and very dry.

   Reason (R) : The desert is mostly flat and open, allowing hot and dry winds to blow freely, while surrounding mountains trap moisture.

3. **Assertion (A)** : Cyclones are one of the most destructive weather events along India's eastern coast.

   Reason (R) : Cyclones form when air pressure drops over the sea, and winds carrying moisture spiral to form strong storms.

4. **Assertion (A)** : Weather changes quickly every day.

   Reason (R) : Climate shows long-term weather patterns.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the two images and answer the questions that follow.

Figure 1

Figure 2

1. In Figure 1, the arrows show the movement of the southwest monsoon. What causes these winds to blow towards India?
   (a) High pressure over northern India in summer. ☐
   (b) Low pressure over northern India in summer. ☐
   (c) High pressure over the Indian Ocean in summer. ☐
   (d) Rotation of the Earth only. ☐
2. In Figure 2, the northeast monsoon winds blow from India towards the ocean. Why does this happen?
   (a) The land is warmer than the sea in winter. ☐
   (b) The Himalayas block all the winds in winter. ☐
   (c) The Indian Ocean develops low pressure in summer. ☐
   (d) The land is cooler than the sea in winter. ☐
3. Which Indian state receives most of its rainfall from the northeast monsoon, as shown in Figure 2?
   (a) Kerala ☐ (b) Punjab ☐ (c) Tamil Nadu ☐ (d) Gujarat ☐
4. Which of the following best explains the seasonal reversal of winds between Figure 1 and Figure 2?
   (a) Change in Earth's rotation. ☐
   (b) Change in pressure differences between land and sea. ☐
   (c) Blocking of winds by the Himalayas only. ☐
   (d) Melting of glaciers in the Himalayas. ☐

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. How do the summer and winter winds change the weather and rainfall in different parts of India?
2. In what ways can planting trees and reducing pollution help keep our climate healthy? How does this show being a responsible citizen?
3. Explain with examples how being near the sea keeps Mumbai's weather mild, while Nagpur experiences extreme heat and cold.
4. How do height above sea level and distance from the Equator together decide how hot or cold a place is?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Compare how cyclones, floods, and forest fires affect people, nature, and the economy.
2. "India's festivals, songs, and buildings show its different climates." Explain with examples from at least three regions.
3. Explain how southwest and northeast monsoons work, showing the role of land heating, sea cooling, and air pressure.
4. How do the Himalayas influence India's climate? Imagine how India's weather might be if the Himalayas were not there.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

Tourism and Climate

Anita's family planned their holidays around India's different climates. In May, they travelled to Manali to enjoy the cool weather of the Himalayas, while in December they visited Goa for its warm beaches. Her cousin, who lives in Rajasthan, explained that tourists flock to Jaisalmer in winter because the desert is pleasant then, but very hot in summer. Anita noticed that tourism in India is closely tied to the climate of each region. For example, hill stations attract people in summer, while coastal and desert regions attract visitors in winter. She realised that seasonal tourism also supports local economies, as shopkeepers, hotels and guides earn most of their income during these peak seasons.

(a) Why did Anita's family choose Manali for their summer vacation?

(b) Why do tourists prefer to visit deserts like Jaisalmer in winter instead of summer?

(c) How does tourism linked with climate support the economy of local people?

VI. PROJECT WORK

Design a poster titled 'I Am the Climate Keeper' showing how you can protect your climate (e.g., planting trees, saving water).

THEME–B

Tapestry of the Past

The history of India is like a colourful tapestry woven with the stories of people, kingdoms, cultures, and traditions across different periods. By studying the past, we learn how societies changed, how rulers governed, how people lived, and how art, architecture, science, literature, and trade developed over time. Historical sources such as inscriptions, coins, monuments, manuscripts, and archaeological discoveries help us understand these changes. Learning about the past encourages respect for our rich heritage and cultural diversity. It also develops critical thinking and helps us connect the achievements of earlier generations with the values, challenges, and progress of present-day India.

4 New Beginnings: Cities and States

Let's Learn About

- What does the term "Second Urbanisation" mean in the history of India?
- How did the janapadas and mahajanapadas influence early Indian history?
- What types of government systems developed in these early kingdoms?

Let's Gear Up

The Damaged Garden Wall

It was gardening day, and the students gathered near the school's vegetable garden. Aarav saw that the fence was broken, and cows had eaten many plants.

Meera said, "Oh no! All our effort is wasted."

Aarav replied, "This happened because no one protected the garden. Without care and safety, it cannot grow."

Meera said, "We need a stronger fence, a watering plan, and someone to check it daily."

Aarav smiled, "That's how ancient kingdoms survived. They built strong walls, managed resources, and made rules to protect people."

As they repaired the fence together, they understood that like their garden, towns and kingdoms become strong when people plan carefully, protect resources, and cooperate.

INDIA'S SECOND URBANISATION

A few centuries after 2000 BCE, in the mid-second millennium BCE, the Indus Valley Civilization, also called the Harappan or Sindhu-Sarasvati civilisation and known as India's First Urbanisation, began to decline and slowly disappeared. Many of its carefully planned cities were left empty. In some places, people continued to live there for some time, but their lifestyle became simpler and more village-based than urban.

This happened because the strong foundations of Harappan city life broke down. Large public buildings and strong private houses were no longer repaired or used properly. Streets and markets that were once busy became quiet. Skilled jobs like metalwork, pottery, building, weaving and other crafts reduced greatly. Writing, planned drainage, sanitation systems and

organised administration also disappeared, showing that central authority had become weak.

In the first millennium BCE, a fresh and important phase of urban growth began in the Indian subcontinent. The earliest towns of this period developed mainly in the Ganga plains and parts of the Indus basin. Later, cities appeared in many other regions too.

We know about this period from archaeological excavations and from ancient texts, especially Late Vedic, Buddhist, and Jain literature. Historians call this phase India's Second Urbanisation, marking the return of organised city life after a long gap.

JANAPADAS AND MAHAJANAPADAS

By the end of the second millennium BCE, people in north India started forming small groups or clans. These groups shared a common language, culture and traditions. Each group settled in a specific area and was ruled by a leader called a raja. The land where a clan settled was known as a janapada. The word janapada comes from Sanskrit and means "the land where people settle."

As trade increased and different regions became connected, these janapadas grew richer and stronger. Over time, especially by the 6th century BCE, many small janapadas joined together or were taken over by bigger and more powerful states. These large kingdoms were called mahajanapadas, which means "great janapadas."

The 16 Mahajanapadas

Analyze Thoughts

Many capitals of the mahajanapadas still exist as towns or cities today. With the help of an atlas and a reliable online source, complete the table given below.

Ancient Capital	Modern City Name	Present-day State / Region
1. Rajagriha	_____	_____
2. Kaushambi	_____	_____
3. Ujjayini	_____	_____
4. Shravasti	_____	_____
5. Taxila	_____	_____

Different ancient books mention different numbers of mahajanapadas, but many speak of sixteen important ones. These kingdoms spread over a wide area — from Gandhara in the north-west to

Anga in the east, and up to Ashmaka near the Godavari River in the south. Some other big states may have existed, and a few smaller janapadas continued independently. This time saw the growth of early territorial kingdoms in India. Mahajanapadas like Magadha, Kosala, Vatsa, and Avanti became very strong and powerful. Many of their towns turned into well-protected cities, surrounded by strong walls and sometimes deep moats for extra safety.

The Cyclopean Walls of Rajgriha: built between 600-400 BCE as outer city fortifications for the capital of the Magadha Empire.

The gates of these cities were built to be narrow on purpose, so guards could easily watch and control the entry and exit of people and goods. Interestingly, many of these ancient capitals are still lively cities even today. Several modern Indian cities have been in existence for nearly 2,500 years, showing their long and continuous history.

In-Text Questions

1. Historians call the return of organised city life in ancient India the _____ Urbanisation.
2. Small territories ruled by a leader called a raja in ancient north India were known as _____.
3. When several smaller states joined together to form larger and stronger kingdoms, they were called _____.
4. Ancient cities were often protected by strong walls and sometimes deep _____ to keep enemies out.

EARLY DEMOCRATIC TRADITIONS

In every janapada, there was a council called the sabha and samiti, where important issues of the clan were discussed. These words appear for the first time in the Vedas, India's oldest texts. Most members of these councils were likely elders of the clan. The raja was not expected to rule alone; a good king was supposed to take advice from these assemblies, ministers, and administrators. Some texts even suggest that an incapable ruler could be removed, though this was not a fixed law, as our information is limited.

As janapadas grew into mahajanapadas, their governments became more organised. Most larger states were monarchies, where the raja held supreme power with support from ministers and councils. The position of raja was usually hereditary, passed from father to son. Kings collected taxes, maintained law and order, built fortifications and kept armies to defend or expand the kingdom. Powerful monarchies included Magadha (present-day Bihar), Kosala (present-day Uttar Pradesh), and Avanti (present-day Madhya Pradesh).

Go Further

In some ancient gana or sangha republics, leaders were chosen through discussion and sometimes voting in large assemblies. Members gathered to debate important matters like war, alliances, and laws. This shows that ideas of shared decision-making and early democracy existed in parts of India more than 2,500 years ago.

Some states, like Vajji (Vrijji) and Malla, had a different system. Here, the sabha or samiti had more power, making key decisions through discussion and voting. Even the choice of the raja involved the assembly. These states, called ganas or sanghas, were not monarchies but early forms of democratic republics. Historians consider them among the earliest republics in the world.

CIVILISATIONAL INNOVATIONS

The period of the janapadas and mahajanapadas brought major changes that shaped Indian civilisation for many centuries. During this time, important schools of thought grew, especially the late Vedic, Buddhist, and Jain traditions, along with their rich writings. These ideas spread across the subcontinent through travelling scholars, monks, nuns and pilgrims. Indian art also saw a revival during this period, reaching its full bloom later in the Age of Empires.

Urban growth was closely linked to new technology. While the Harappan civilisation excelled in copper and bronze work, the Second Urbanisation saw the rise of iron technology. Iron tools gradually became common, helping large-scale farming and changing settlements. Iron also changed warfare, creating stronger, sharper swords, spears, arrows, and shields.

Archaeological and literary evidence shows that occasional battles happened between neighbouring mahajanapadas. Conflicts and alliances together helped new kingdoms and empires to emerge.

Trade grew rapidly, leading to the introduction of coins. The earliest coins were silver punch-marked coins with stamped symbols. Later, coins were made of copper, gold, and other metals. Each mahajanapada issued its own coins, but they were accepted widely in trade across regions.

Punch-marked coins belonging to the different Mahajanapadas

THE VARNA AND JATI SYSTEM

As societies grew more organised and complex, especially after the rise of civilisation, people began forming different groups. These groups were often based on work, social status, or other differences. Each group had a role in society, such as ruling, worship, learning, trading, building towns, farming, making goods, or creating art. Ideally, all groups would rely on each other and work together to keep life balanced. In reality, these divisions often caused inequality, with some groups gaining more wealth, power, or status than others.

Indian society was organised mainly in two ways: jati and varna. A jati was a community connected by a specific occupation, like farming, trade, or crafts. Skills were usually passed from parents to children. Over time, many jatis split into smaller sub-jatis, each with its own marriage rules, rituals, and food habits.

Analyze Thoughts

The jati system connected people to jobs and skills inherited from parents. How did this help early society?

Alongside jati, the varna system, mentioned in the Vedic texts, divided society into four groups.

Brahmins were linked to knowledge, teaching, and rituals. Kshatriyas were warriors and protectors. Vaishyas focused on farming, trade, and business. Shudras were artisans, labourers, and service providers.

Early sources show that people could sometimes change occupations. For instance, droughts or disasters could force farmers to move to towns and take up new work. Some Brahmins became traders or soldiers. Initially, the varna-jati system helped organise society by dividing work and responsibilities, but over time it became rigid. This rigidity led to inequality and discrimination, especially against lower jatis and communities outside the system.

The varna-jati system has shaped Indian civilisation for centuries. Historians note that it was more flexible in early times but became stricter later, especially under British rule. It was only one way to organise society; other social and cultural practices also shaped India's heritage.

Do you know?

You might know the English word 'caste'. It comes from the Portuguese word casta, used by Portuguese travellers who visited India in the 1500s CE and tried to understand how Indian society was organised.Some scholars say caste refers to the varna system, while others think it means the jatis. A few scholars use the term for both varna and jati together.

Developments in Other Parts of India

During the first millennium BCE, several important routes developed in India, connecting different regions. These roads helped trade, religious pilgrimages, military campaigns and movement of people. Two main routes often mentioned in ancient texts were the 'Uttarapatha' and 'Dakshinapatha'. The Uttarapatha ran from the north-west, through the Ganga plains, and reached eastern India, supporting trade and cultural exchange across the subcontinent.

Ruins of a complex at Kaushambi, capital of the Vatsa mahajanapada

The Dakshinapatha started from Kaushambi (near present-day Prayagraj), crossed the Vindhya hills, and went south. This road connected north and south India and was used for trade and armies. Many smaller side routes also linked other regions.

These roads connected to major coastal ports on both coasts, which became busy trade centres for goods from India and abroad. An important city from this time is 'Shishupalgarh', near present-day Bhubaneswar in eastern India, the capital of 'Kalinga'. It had a square layout, strong walls, and wide streets, showing advanced urban planning and construction.

In southern India, towns and cities began growing around 400 BCE. Archaeological evidence suggests trade may have started earlier. Around this time, three strong kingdoms – Cholas, Cheras, and Pandyas – became prominent. They encouraged trade, supported culture and built political power. Early Tamil literature mentions these kingdoms and their rulers. The south was rich in gold, spices, and precious stones, which helped trade with other parts of India and

overseas, strengthening the economy and cultural contacts.

Shishupalgarh (now a suburb of Bhubaneswar, excavated in 1948) featured a gateway with a water-filled moat. The narrow gateway controlled the movement of people and goods.

By 300–200 BCE, almost the entire subcontinent, including the Northeast, was lively and well-connected. Goods, ideas, and culture moved freely across regions and beyond India to Central and Southeast Asia. During this period, the mahajanapadas declined, making way for new political, social, and cultural changes that shaped India in later centuries.

Another important development was the introduction of coinage in India. As trade grew across regions, people needed a more reliable and portable form of exchange. The earliest Indian coins were made of silver and had symbols punched into them. These are known as punch-marked coins. Later, coins were also made of copper, gold and other metals.

Most *mahajanapadas* issued their own coins, but coins also circulated between regions. This helped promote long-distance trade-both within India and with the other parts of the ancient world.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Alliance:** Two kingdoms promise to help each other.
- **Evidence:** Clues or objects that tell us about history.
- **Discrimination:** Treating people unfairly because of their identity.
- **Sabha:** Assembly or council of elders/ leaders in ancient India.
- **Monarchy:** A country ruled by a king or queen.
- **Moat:** A water ditch protecting a castle or fort.

QUICK TAKE

- By the end of 2000 BCE, small states called janapadas appeared in northern and central India. Each had a raja who listened to a council of wise elders.
- Around 1000 BCE, sixteen large mahajanapadas formed, becoming the first big organised states. They helped the Second Urbanisation in the Ganga plains and beyond.
- By 300 BCE, the mahajanapadas became weak and slowly disappeared.
- At that time, a network of roads connected northern, southern, eastern and western India.
- These roads allowed people, goods, and ideas to travel, boosting trade and cultural sharing across the land.

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Mahajanapadas were formed by joining small _____?
   (a) Towns ☐ (b) Janapadas ☐
   (c) Forests ☐ (d) Rivers ☐
2. What was the purpose of Uttarapatha and Dakshinapatha roads?
   (a) Connected north-south india for trade and armies. ☐
   (b) Separated janapadas from mahajanapadas strictly. ☐
   (c) Built fortifications along rivers and hills. ☐
   (d) Transported religious books only to temples. ☐
3. Why was Shishupalgarh important in the second urbanisation period?
   (a) Advanced city with walls, streets and planning. ☐
   (b) Religious center attracting monks and pilgrims. ☐
   (c) Capital of magadha, defended by armies. ☐
   (d) Major port for overseas trade with China. ☐
4. Important trade route connecting north and East India?
   (a) Dakshinapatha ☐ (b) Uttarapatha ☐
   (c) Ganges path ☐ (d) Shishupalgarh road ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. The Indus Valley Civilisation is also called the Harappan Civilisation. ☐
2. Janapadas were ruled only by elected assemblies. ☐
3. Mahajanapadas were larger kingdoms formed by small janapadas. ☐
4. Iron technology had no impact on farming or weapons. ☐
5. Vajji and Malla followed early democratic traditions. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Sabha and Samiti	A. Early community assemblies for decision-making
2. Vajji and Malla	B. Known for Ganas or Sanghas (early republics)
3. Iron metallurgy	C. Earliest coins used in trade, usually silver
4. Magadha, Kosala, Avanti	D. Helped in large-scale agriculture and stronger weapons
5. Punch-marked coins	E. Powerful Mahajanapadas ruled by monarchs

(a) 1-A, 2-B, 3-D, 4-E, 5-C (b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-E, 5-C
(c) 1-A, 2-D, 3-B, 4-C, 5-E (d) 1-C, 2-B, 3-A, 4-D, 5-E

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : Mahajanapadas were formed by joining smaller janapadas.
   Reason (R) : Trade and connections among regions helped growth.
2. **Assertion (A)** : The Varna-jati system remained flexible throughout history.
   Reason (R) : People could change occupations sometimes in early times.
3. **Assertion (A)** : Shishupalgarh city had strong walls and wide streets.
   Reason (R) : It was the capital of Kalinga with planned layout.
4. **Assertion (A)** : The Harappan cities were abandoned after 2000 BCE.
   Reason (R) : Large public buildings and streets were no longer used.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Look at the given image and answer the following questions:

1. Name the archaeological site shown in the picture.
2. Why would a city make its gateway narrow instead of wide?

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why do we call this period the Second Urbanisation in India ?
2. If the Varna-jati system was more flexible, how might Indian society have developed differently?
3. What is a monarchy? How did most Mahajanapadas use it to rule their kingdoms?
4. How did the Chola, Chera, and Pandya kingdoms help southern India grow around 400 BCE?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Analyse the importance of trade routes like Uttarapatha and Dakshinapatha in ancient India.
2. Discuss the features of gana-sanghas like Vajji and Malla.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

Arjun's Choice: Bound by Birth or Freed by Circumstance

Arjun, a young boy from the mahājanapada of Kosala, belonged to a family of farmers. Society expected him to follow the same path as his ancestors, tied to the varṇa-jāti order. But one year, a harsh drought destroyed crops, forcing many families to abandon their fields. Some turned to trading, while others became craftsmen in nearby towns. Arjun's cousin even joined a merchant caravan along the Dakşinapatha. Arjun wondered if he, too, could break tradition. Although the

system aimed to keep order, situations like famine proved that professions could change, showing both the resilience and contradictions of early society.

(a) Why did some families in Kosala shift to other professions during the drought?

(b) How does Arjun's story show that the varna-jati system was not always completely rigid in early times?

(c) If you were Arjun, would you continue farming or join your cousin's trading caravan? Give two reasons to justify your choice.

VI. PROJECT WORK

"Map Makers of Mahājanapadas" - Exploring Ancient States

I. Objective:

- To understand the geographical spread of the sixteen Mahajanapadas, their capitals and reasons for their growth. Students will practise map reading, group collaboration and critical observation.

II. Tasks:

- Divide the class into groups, each assigned 3-4 Mahājanapadas.
- Provide students with a blank outline map of India.
- Each group marks its Mahājanapadas with colour, symbols and names of capitals.
- Add two key features (like fertile soil, iron ore deposits, trade route location, rivers) for each Mahājanapadas on the map.
- Groups display their maps and explain why their states became important.
- Compare and Discuss:
  - (i) Which Mahājanapadas were clustered in the Ganga plains? Why?
  - (ii) Which were on trade routes?
  - (iii) Which had natural resources like iron?

III. Expected Learning Outcome:

By the end of this activity, you will:

- Recognise the geography of ancient states.
- Link natural resources and location with the growth of kingdoms.
- Develop map skills, analysis and teamwork.

5 The Rise of Empires

Let's Learn About

- What do we mean by the term empire?
- The reasons that led to the rise and expansion of empires in ancient India.
- How trade, craft guilds and geography helped in running and supporting empires.
- The main features of the Mauryan government, army and economic system.
- The changes in towns, villages and occupations during Mauryan rule.

Let's Gear Up

A Journey to Ancient Pāṭaliputra

Niya was flipping through her history book when she said excitedly, "Arin, wouldn't it be amazing if we could actually see the ancient cities instead of just reading about them?"

Arin smiled and showed a shiny device. "Guess what, Niya? Our friends Bhavisha and Dhruv have created a real time machine called Itihasa! We can travel to the past with it."

Niya's eyes sparkled. "Wow! Where do we go first?"

Arin tapped on the screen. "Let's start with our lesson—Pāṭaliputra! It was one of the greatest cities of ancient India. You know, it's where modern-day Patna is now."

With a soft buzz and a flash, they appeared at the city's outskirts. Everywhere they looked, there were tall walls, watchtowers and grand palaces. The busy streets had colourful markets where traders sold silk from China, spices from the south and precious gems. Street performers sang, danced and amazed crowds with human pyramids. Niya and Arin couldn't believe their eyes—it was like stepping into history itself.

WHAT IS AN EMPIRE?

The word 'empire' comes from the Latin word imperium, which means 'highest power'. In simple words, an empire is a very large kingdom made up of many smaller kingdoms or regions ruled by one powerful king or a group of rulers. Most empires were formed after winning wars and taking control of other lands. Even after joining the empire, local kings often continued to rule their areas, but they were not fully free. They had to obey the emperor and pay taxes or gifts called tribute. The emperor ruled the whole empire from a capital city. The capital was usually an important centre for trade, money and government work.

In ancient Sanskrit texts, emperors were given special titles to show their great power. Some of these titles were samrat (supreme ruler), adhiraja (overlord), and rajadhiraja (king of kings).
India has had many great empires in its history. They rose to power, expanded their lands, stayed strong for some time, and later declined. The last empire that ruled the Indian subcontinent ended less than a hundred years ago. In this chapter, we will learn how the first empires began, how they were governed, and why they were important in shaping India's history.

Key Features of an Empire

An empire usually spreads across a very large area. It has many regions and many kinds of people. These people may follow different cultures, speak different languages, follow different customs, and have different ways of running their governments and earning money. The emperor has the highest power and keeps all these groups united. An empire usually shares some common features:

1. Military Control
Empires kept big armies with soldiers, horses, war elephants and spies. Strong armies helped them expand and stay in control.

2. Administrative Machinery
A well-organized system helped run taxes, laws, money collection and messages. Officials chosen by the emperor worked in levels.

3. Resource Management
Empires used land, forests, rivers and mines. Controlling these resources helped rulers collect taxes and support their armies.

Emperor
CENTRAL AUTHORITY

4. Law And Regulation
Empires needed strong laws to manage society, trade and business. Rules controlled behaviour, trade, and money, and measures were made standard.

5. Cultural Integration
Rulers promoted religion, art and books. Ashoka backed Buddhism, while the Guptas encouraged learning, art and culture.

6. Communication And Infrastructure
Roads, canals and rest houses helped trade and administration. The Mauryan Empire built strong networks for smooth governance.

Governance and Growth of Empires

The rise and growth of empires depended on good administration and careful expansion. The main ways empires were ruled and expanded were:

- Emperors allowed local kings or chiefs to govern their areas if they stayed loyal and paid tribute.
- Strong, trained armies captured nearby kingdoms, kept control and protected borders.
- Forts and guarded towns were built at important places, especially near borders for safety.

- A kingdom slowly became an empire by fighting wars and bringing neighbouring lands under its rule.
- Rulers tried to control big rivers and trade routes to gain resources and collect taxes from trade.
- When many small kingdoms fought for power, the strongest one with more resources became the overlord.

In-Text Questions

1. An empire is a very large kingdom ruled by one powerful _____.
2. Local rulers had to pay taxes or gifts called _____ to the emperor.
3. Strong and well-trained _____ helped empires expand and protect their borders.

How Trade Sustained Empires

Fighting wars, especially in distant places, was hard and very expensive. A large standing army needed regular support. Soldiers required food, clothes, weapons, and proper salaries. War animals like horses and elephants also needed daily care and feeding. Roads and ships had to be built and repaired so that armies and goods could travel easily. This was possible only when an empire had a strong economy, enough natural and human resources and good planning.

Key trade routes, including Uttarapatha and Dakshinapatha with major cities marked along them

Trade and production of goods formed the backbone of every empire. Wise rulers focused not only on wars but also on improving people's lives. Good rule meant protecting and encouraging trade. Trade routes within and outside the empire were kept safe. As trade grew, farmers and craftsmen earned more, traders became wealthier and the state collected more taxes. This wealth helped build roads, ports, storehouses, and support defence and administration. In ancient India, books and archaeological evidence show active trade in cloth, spices, grains, precious stones, jewellery, metals, fine crafts and animals, both within the subcontinent and with Central Asia and West Asia.

Traders often worked together instead of alone. They formed groups called guilds, known as srenis in Sanskrit. A guild was a group of people doing the same work, such as merchants, craftsmen, moneylenders, or farmers. Each guild had a leader and some helpers. Guilds were important for two main reasons. First, they promoted teamwork by sharing tools, skills, and market information. Second, they had a good level of independence. Ancient texts say that farmers, traders, herders and artisans could make their own rules with very little interference from the king. This helped them handle their work smoothly and brought economic stability. Guilds stayed important for many centuries. Even when they became weaker, their ideas of cooperation, fair trade and working together continued to shape Indian trade. Villages also had similar freedom. They were managed by councils and committees. Wise rulers allowed these local groups to work freely as long as they maintained peace and prosperity in the empire.

THE RISE OF MAGADHA

Between the 6th and 4th centuries BCE, northern India saw big changes. Many strong kingdoms called mahajanapadas grew in north and central India. There were sixteen such large states with proper systems of rule, and some even used assemblies to make decisions. Among them, Magadha became the most powerful in wealth, army and influence. It was located in present-day southern Bihar and nearby areas. The rise of Magadha helped unite many small kingdoms and later led to the first great empire in India. Strong and determined rulers supported this growth. King Ajatashatru played an important role by using smart military plans and political alliances to expand Magadha's power. During his time, Siddhartha Gautama (the Buddha) and Vardhamana (Mahavira) also lived.

Many reasons helped Magadha grow:

- **Rich resources and farming surplus:** Magadha lay in the fertile Ganga plains. It had rich soil, forests, timber, elephants and plenty of crops.
- **Use of iron and minerals:** Iron ore from nearby hills helped make better tools and weapons. Iron ploughs improved farming and strong weapons strengthened the army.
- **Different occupations:** Extra food allowed some people to take up crafts, trade, and other jobs, which improved economic and cultural life.
- **Growth of markets and trade links:** Local goods were in demand and attracted traders from faraway places, connecting Magadha to bigger trade networks.
- **Good river location:** The rivers Ganga and Son helped in moving goods, people and messages easily.

- **Easy and cheaper transport:** River travel was cheaper and safer than land routes, which helped trade and administration.
- **Economic progress:** More trade brought more revenue to the state, helping in public works and better governance.

Around the 5th century BCE, 'Mahapadma Nanda' founded the 'Nanda dynasty'. He was a strong military leader and clever ruler who brought many kingdoms under his control. Magadha expanded across eastern and northern India and became a major power. As trade increased, he introduced coins, which made buying and selling easier and strengthened the economy. Greek sources say the Nandas had a huge and well-organised army.

Mahapadma Nanda;s coins

However, the later Nanda rulers became unpopular. The last king, Dhana Nanda, was very rich but harsh and unfair. His rule caused anger among the people. This unhappiness led to the fall of the Nanda dynasty. Soon after, a new and stronger empire, the Mauryan Empire, took its place.

ARRIVAL OF GREEKS IN INDIA

While big changes were happening in Magadha in eastern India, the northwestern region was also seeing important events. This area had many small kingdoms and was located on an old trade route that linked India with the Mediterranean world. Greek writers mention the kingdom of the Pauravas, ruled by King Porus.

At that time, Alexander, a young and brave Greek king from Macedonia, was expanding his empire. He first attacked the Persian Empire to take revenge for earlier Persian attacks on Greece. During those earlier wars, some Indian soldiers from the northwest, then under Persian control, had fought against the Greeks. Alexander defeated the Persian Empire, and Greek culture spread widely. His empire stretched across three continents and became one of the largest in history. To manage faraway regions, he appointed governors called satraps. Though they served the Greek Empire, they had great authority in their provinces.

Alexander then advanced towards India. He defeated King Porus in Punjab but faced tough resistance from local tribes

The empire of Alexander the Great

and rulers. Greek sources say many people were killed in battles, and in some places women also fought bravely. In one battle, Alexander was badly injured. Soon, his soldiers grew tired and wished to return home. They refused to move further towards the Ganga River. Alexander finally turned back with part of his army. They travelled along the southern coast and crossed the deserts of Iran, where many soldiers died due to heat, hunger, and disease. After returning to Persia, Alexander faced revolts. He soon fell ill and died in Babylon at the age of thirty-two. After his death, his huge empire was divided among his generals and satraps, who formed their own kingdoms.

Alexander and the Gymnosophists

One famous story from Alexander's visit to India tells about his meeting with the Gymnosophists—Indian wise men known for their simple living and deep thinking. The Greek word Gymnosophists means 'naked philosophers.' Alexander had heard about their wisdom and wanted to test them. He asked them tricky questions and even warned that they could be punished if they answered wrongly.

The sages stayed calm and gave clear and thoughtful answers. Their confidence and wisdom impressed Alexander, and he decided not to harm them. One well-known conversation is shared below:

Alexander: "Which is stronger, life or death?"

Sage: "Life is stronger, because it goes on, while death ends."

Alexander: "How can a person be most loved?"

Sage: "When he is powerful but does not make others afraid."

Historians believe this meeting showed the coming together of two great traditions—Greek logical thinking and Indian spiritual wisdom. Over the years, many stories about this meeting have been told, keeping its memory alive.

THE MIGHTY MAURYAS

Around 321 BCE, a few years after Alexander left India, a strong new dynasty rose in Magadha. This was the Maurya Empire, started by Chandragupta Maurya. The Mauryas defeated the Nandas and began to expand their rule. Many records say that Chandragupta succeeded with the help of his teacher and guide, Kautilya, also called Chanakya or Vishnugupta. Kautilya was wise in politics, administration and economic planning. Under Chandragupta, the base of a large and well-managed empire was built. The Mauryan Empire later became one of the greatest empires in Indian history.

The Rise of Chandragupta Maurya

Chandragupta Maurya defeated the Nandas and made Pataliputra his capital. Magadha was already strong because of its good location, rich resources, and active trade. With Kautilya's clever plans, Chandragupta slowly built a vast empire that spread from the northern plains to the Deccan Plateau.

He also defeated the Greek governors left by Alexander in the northwest and added their lands to

his empire. Later, he kept friendly relations with the Greeks. A Greek ambassador named Megasthenes visited his court and wrote a book called Indika about India. Though the original book is lost, parts of it are known from later writings.

Kautilya: The Mind Behind the Empire

According to Buddhist texts, Kautilya was a teacher at the famous university of Takshashila (Taxila). His story is linked with the court of Dhana Nanda, a ruler who had become unpopular. Kautilya advised him to change his behaviour, warning that his empire might fall. But Dhana Nanda insulted and removed him from the court. Hurt and angry, Kautilya promised to end the unjust Nanda rule.

Empire of Chandragupta Maurya, 322-298 BCE

Kautilya's Idea of a Kingdom

Kautilya clearly explained how a kingdom should be formed and ruled. In his book Arthashastra (meaning 'science of governance and economics'), he wrote about defence, economy, law, farming, town planning and public welfare. He spoke about the saptanga theory—the seven important parts of a kingdom.

He believed these seven parts must work together to make the state strong and prosperous. A kingdom could be protected through war or peaceful agreements. Kautilya also stressed strict law and order. He made rules to prevent corruption and fixed punishments for actions that harmed the people or the state.

Saptanga (Seven Parts of a State):

- Swami (King): The highest ruler who should govern wisely, kindly and fairly.
- Amatya (Ministers): Honest and trusted advisors who guide the king and keep secrets safe.
- Janapada (Land and People): The land, people, farms, forests, minerals, rivers and roads that support the kingdom's growth and safety.
- Durga (Fort): Strong forts in hills, deserts or forests that protect cities, people and crops.
- Kosha (Treasury): The kingdom's wealth, collected fairly and managed carefully.
- Danda (Army): A trained and loyal army with soldiers, horses, elephants, chariots and ships.
- Mitra (Ally): Friendly ties with other rulers to gain support and avoid danger.

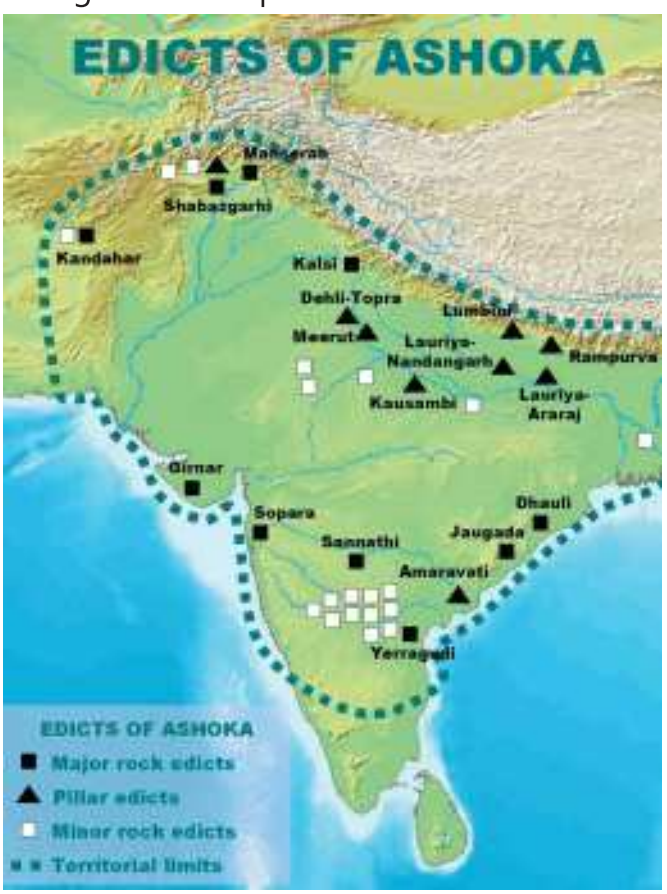
He also said that a ruler becomes stronger by caring for his people, because true power comes from the villages, which are the heart of all work and trade. So, the king should help and reward those in rural areas who make life better for everyone, like building dams and bridges, improving villages, and keeping them safe. Kautilya's main idea of ruling fits well with old Indian values. He wrote: "In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare lies his welfare. What pleases the people should be considered beneficial to the king, not merely what pleases him personally."

ASHOKA THE GREAT

Ashoka (268–232 BCE) was one of the most famous kings of ancient India and a great emperor of the Mauryan dynasty. He is remembered for his important achievements in ruling and spreading good values. Ashoka was the son of Bindusara, the second Mauryan king, and the grandson of Chandragupta Maurya. At the start of his reign, Ashoka was brave, strong, and full of ambition. Even though he inherited a large empire from his father, he worked hard to expand it further. Under his rule, the Mauryan Empire grew to cover almost the whole Indian subcontinent—from present-day Afghanistan in the northwest to Bangladesh in the east, and most of India except the far south.

The rock edict of Dhauli, Odisha describing the Kalinga war

The Kalinga War was a turning point in Ashoka's life. He led a fierce battle against Kalinga (today's Odisha), which caused huge loss of life and suffering. Seeing so much pain and death deeply affected him. Ashoka decided to give up violence and follow the path of dharma, meaning victory through righteousness. He embraced Buddhism and started following the teachings of peace, kindness, tolerance and non-violence. After this, Ashoka ruled with a focus on moral and fair governance. He spread messages of goodness, compassion, and harmony throughout his empire.



Some of Ashoka's edicts, spread across the Subscontinent

Ashoka promoted peace, the welfare of his people, and respect for all religions through messages carved on rocks and pillars called edicts. After following Buddhism, he encouraged kindness, compassion, and moral living. He sent special messengers to faraway lands like Sri Lanka, Thailand, Central Asia, and other regions to share the teachings of the Buddha.

Ashoka is often called a "great communicator" because he used these inscriptions to spread his ideas everywhere. The edicts shared messages of dharma, asking people to live honestly, respect all life, and treat others with tolerance. To make sure everyone could understand them, he wrote them in Prakrit, the language of ordinary people, using the Brahmi script, which later became the base for many modern Indian scripts. His simple words, clear messages, and guidance on living well helped bring together his diverse empire and left a long-lasting mark on Indian history.

In his edicts, Ashoka called himself

'Devanampiya Piyadasi,' which means 'Beloved of the Gods' and 'one who treats others kindly.' This showed that he wanted to be seen as a kind and caring ruler. His messages reveal that he cared for the well-being of his people and all living beings. Even though some southern kingdoms were not part of the Mauryan Empire, he still wished for their welfare. Ashoka protected animals, banned hunting and cruelty and ordered medical care for sick animals. He claimed that he built rest houses and wells along major roads and planted trees that gave shade and fruits for travelers. He also promoted religious tolerance, asking different groups to respect each other and learn from one another. While not all of Ashoka's claims may be literally true, they show that he focused on public welfare, following ideas similar to Kautilya's principles of good governance.

Ashoka ruled for about 35 years and passed away in 232 BCE. The Mauryan Empire lasted for another 50 years after him. The kings who came after Ashoka were weak and could not manage the empire well, which caused it to break into smaller, independent kingdoms. In 185 BCE, Pushyamitra Shunga killed the last Mauryan king, Brihadratha, and brought the Mauryan Empire to an end.

Go Further

Discuss the teachings of the Buddha, Ashoka sent emissaries to carry the message of Dhamma beyond his empire.

- What could have been Ashoka's purpose in sending emissaries beyond India?
- How might these journeys have helped strengthen cultural ties between different regions?

LIFE DURING THE MAURYAN PERIOD

At the height of the Mauryan Empire, cities like Pataliputra thrived as important centres of administration, trade, and culture. They had grand palaces, public buildings, and well-planned, organized streets. A strong system of taxes and active trade kept the empire's treasury full, which helped the empire grow and prosper. Daily life depended on people from many professions, including government officials, merchants and skilled artisans, whose work supported both the economy and the smooth running of the cities.

Do you know?

The Sohgaura copper-plate inscription (3rd century BCE) is one of the oldest copper records from the Mauryan period. It was discovered at Sohgaura in present-day Uttar Pradesh.

The inscription is written in Prakrit using the Brahmi script. It gives instructions to build granaries to provide food during famines, showing that the state cared for the people's welfare.

The plate is decorated with designs like the 'tree-in-railing' and mountain motifs, which are also seen on coins from that time.

The Sohgaura Copper Plate Inscription

This inscription helps us understand how the Mauryan rulers managed administration, kept records, and planned for the welfare of their people in ancient India.

The Greek ambassador Megasthenes, who visited the Mauryan court, gives us valuable information about life in this period. He observed that most people worked in agriculture, which was the main source of income for the empire. Farmers usually grew two crops every year because rain came in both summer and winter. This made famines rare and food supplies enough for everyone. Granaries were kept full to handle emergencies. Even when wars happened nearby, farmers were usually protected so that farming could continue without disruption.

Cities were home to skilled artisans like blacksmiths, potters, carpenters, and jewellers. Urban centres were carefully planned and had signboards on streets to help people find their way. Messages between regions were carried by couriers. Houses were often made of wood and could be two storeys high. To prevent fire damage, vessels of water were kept along streets at regular points for emergencies.

Later records tell us about people's clothing. Men usually wore a cotton lower garment reaching below the knees or ankles, and an upper garment draped over the shoulders. Some wore leather shoes with thick soles and decorative designs, perhaps for style and height. Women wore draped garments with decorative jewellery.

The Lion Capital

The Lion Capital is a great example of Mauryan art. A 'capital' is the top part of a pillar. This one was originally placed on a stone pillar at Sarnath, near Varanasi, where Buddha gave his first sermon. It shows four lions standing back-to-back, symbolizing royal power. On the circular base below are four animals—elephant, bull, horse, and lion—separated by panels with the dharmachakra (Wheel of Dharma), representing the Buddha's teachings of righteous conduct.

After Independence, this Lion Capital became India's national emblem, along with the Sanskrit motto Satyameva Jayate (Truth Alone Triumphs) from the Mundaka Upanishad. The dharmachakra is also at the centre of India's national flag, showing the nation's commitment to justice, truth and moral values.

Mauryan Contributions to Art and Architecture

The Mauryan period saw great growth in art and architecture, both for religion and everyday life. Under Ashoka, Buddhist art was encouraged through building stupas and pillars that carried messages of peace. At the same time, secular sculptures and terracotta figurines showed the amazing skill of Mauryan craftsmen. These works together shaped India's artistic heritage and reflected the empire's cultural and spiritual values.

Dhamek Stupa, Sarnath, Uttar Pradesh

Single Lion capital at Vaishali

Female deity - Yakshi holding a fly whisk

THE FRAGILE NATURE OF EMPIRES

Many great empires in history, such as the Roman, Persian, Ottoman, Spanish, Russian, and British empires, were once very powerful, but none of them exist today. Historians study and debate why they fell.

One common reason was rebellions in some regions that wanted independence. This often happened when emperors demanded more money or resources for wars or to deal with problems like droughts. Local rulers, pressured to pay high taxes, would become unhappy and resist the central government. A change in leadership could also weaken an empire. If a strong ruler was replaced by a weak or careless one, local kings or chiefs might take the chance to break away and stop obeying the empire.

Running a very large empire was also difficult. As Alexander the Great found, the farther a region was from the capital, the harder it was to control. Distant areas often left first. Natural disasters or economic problems, like long droughts or floods, could also weaken the empire.

Empires are complex. They can create political unity, like the Mauryan Empire, but they expand through war and rely on military power to stay in control. This dependence on force instead of agreement makes empires fragile. Even if an empire seems strong, it can be threatened from inside by disloyal local rulers or from outside by aggressive enemies.

In-Text Questions

1. How might the use of well-planned streets and signboards in Mauryan cities be useful for someone traveling today in a busy city?
2. If an empire relied too much on military power like the Mauryas, what modern organization or system could face similar challenges?
3. Imagine you were a farmer in the Mauryan Empire. How would granaries and protection from wars make your life easier?
4. How can symbols like the Lion Capital or the dharmachakra inspire people today, even outside India?

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Edict:** An important order or message given by a king.
- **Prakrit:** The everyday language spoken by common people long ago.
- **Brahmi:** An old script from which many Indian writing systems originated.
- **Expansion:** When a kingdom or empire grows bigger in land or power.
- **Stability:** A state of being steady and not changing quickly.
- **Artisan:** A skilled person who makes useful things by hand.

QUICK TAKE

- An empire is a large land ruled by one king, often gained through war or alliances.
- Magadha grew strong because of fertile land, iron and rivers, which helped farming, trade and travel.
- Chandragupta Maurya, guided by Kautilya, defeated the Nandas, started the Mauryan Empire, expanded it across north and central India and overcame Greek governors left after Alexander.
- Ashoka expanded the empire further; after the deadly Kalinga War, he became a Buddhist, promoted peace, tolerance, welfare and dharma through his edicts, caring for people and animals.
- Well-planned cities like Pataliputra boosted trade and prosperity; farming was the main economic activity, supported by artisans and traders, both locally and across long distances.

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which feature of Mauryan houses showed urban planning?
   (a) Multi-storey wooden structures. ☐ (b) Dome-shaped ceilings. ☐
   (c) Brick towers like Mesopotamia. ☐ (d) Underground air-cooling systems. ☐
2. What was the turning point in Ashoka's life?
   (a) His coronation as the Mauryan emperor. ☐
   (b) The terrible destruction and suffering of Kalinga War. ☐
   (c) His meeting with Greek ambassador Megasthenes. ☐
   (d) His decision to build many palaces. ☐
3. Why did local kings obey the emperor?
   (a) They were completely free to rule themselves. ☐
   (b) They had to pay tribute and follow emperor's orders. ☐
   (c) They wanted to become farmers in villages. ☐
   (d) They ruled only for a short time. ☐
4. What helped empires expand and maintain control?
   (a) Small groups of traders and farmers. ☐
   (b) Religious leaders guiding the kingdom. ☐
   (c) Large armies with soldiers, horses, elephants, and spies. ☐
   (d) Only peaceful discussions with neighboring kingdoms. ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. After Ashoka's death, the Mauryan Empire continued to remain very strong. ☐
2. Magadha became powerful partly because of fertile land and rivers. ☐
3. Alexander's soldiers refused to move further toward the Ganga River. ☐
4. Ashoka spread his messages through inscriptions on rocks and pillars. ☐
5. Janapada includes the land, people, farms, forests, rivers and roads of the kingdom. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Ganga and Son rivers	A. Increased agricultural surplus
2. Iron resources	B. Helped Magadha in trade and transport
3. Fertile plains	C. Strengthened weapons and farming tools

(a) 1(B), 2(C), 3(A)
(b) 1(C), 2(A), 3(B)
(c) 1 (B), 2 (A), 3 (C)
(d) 1 (A), 2 (C), 3 (B)

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : The Mauryan Empire became very strong during the time of Chandragupta
   Reason (R) : Chandragupta Maurya received guidance from Kautilya in politics and administration.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Ashoka stopped fighting wars after the Kalinga War.
   Reason (R) : The suffering caused by the war made Ashoka follow the path of peace and dharma.
3. **Assertion (A)** : The Mauryan rulers built roads and rest houses.
   Reason (R) : These helped travellers, traders and officials move easily across the empire.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Ashoka wrote his messages in the language of ordinary people.
   Reason (R) : He wanted common people to understand his ideas about dharma.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the image and answer the questions that follow.

(a) Label: Mark the anda (dome) and pradaksina path.
(b) Explain why the stūpa's circular plan supports Buddhist practice.

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. What is the Lion Capital of Ashoka, and why is it important for modern India?
2. What does the title 'Devanampiya Piyadasi' mean, and why did Ashoka use it?
3. What were guilds (shrenis), and why were they useful?
4. Who was Kautilya, and how did he help build the Maurya Empire?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. What is Saptanga Theory by Kautilya? Explain its seven parts and how they help a kingdom stay strong.
2. What were the main reasons for the fall of big empires, such as the Maurya Empire? Explain.
3. After the Kalinga War, Ashoka chose peace and followed Dhamma. Do you think a ruler can be both strong and kind? Give examples from his rule.
4. Kautilya said, "The king's happiness lies in the happiness of his people." What leadership values does this idea show? Are these values important for leaders today? Explain.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

After the Kalinga War, Emperor Ashoka stood on the battlefield, surrounded by silence. The cries of the wounded echoed in his mind and for the first time, victory felt hollow. Determined to rule differently, he renounced violence and adopted the path of dhamma–a rule based on compassion, tolerance and justice. He ordered his edicts to be carved on rocks and pillars across his empire, instructing officers to treat all communities fairly, to protect animals and to provide medical care for people and creatures alike. Instead of expanding through war, he expanded through empathy. His governance sought not to conquer lands, but to win hearts.

(a) What change did Ashoka bring in his way of governance after the Kalinga War?

(b) How did Ashoka's new policies reflect his concern for the welfare of people?

(c) How can Ashoka's approach to leadership inspire modern governments to build peace and fairness in society?

VI. PROJECT WORK

Imagine you are an emperor. Design some rules for your empire, focussing on rights and duties of citizens, fairness and justice, welfare and tolerance.

6 The Age of Reorganisation

Let's Learn About

- Why is the time after the Mauryan Empire called the 'Age of Reorganisation'?
- The major kingdoms and important rulers that appeared after the Mauryas.
- The growth of art, literature and trade during this period.
- How foreign ideas mixed with Indian culture and influenced it.

Let's Gear Up

A Puzzle at the Museum

It was a holiday afternoon, and Sakshi and Aman were walking through the history section of a museum. They paused in front of a giant map covered with bright colours.

Sakshi: "This looks so different from the Mauryan Empire we learned about."

Aman: "You're right. Instead of one huge empire, I see many small kingdoms."

Sakshi: "Why did India divide into so many parts? And how did these rulers govern their regions?"

Aman: "Maybe after the Mauryas, new dynasties took charge in different areas. See these names—Shunga, Satavahanas, Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas."

Sakshi: "And look here—Indo-Greeks and Kushanas. They sound like they came from outside of India."

As they observed coins, sculptures and cave paintings around them, they understood something important: when one great empire ends, new powers rise. Each kingdom brought fresh ideas, art, trade, and new ways of life. The colourful map was not confusing anymore—it showed a new chapter in India's history, a time of change and reorganisation.

FROM EMPIRE TO KINGDOMS: INDIA AFTER THE MAURYAS

After the Mauryan Empire declined around 185 BCE, big changes took place across the Indian subcontinent. The vast empire slowly broke apart, and many smaller regions that were once ruled by the Mauryas became independent. Because of this, several new kingdoms and ruling families emerged in different parts of India. Some of these kingdoms lasted only for a short time, while others grew powerful and important.

The north-western region faced the most trouble. It became weak and was often invaded by foreign groups coming from Central Asia. Since many kingdoms quickly rose and fell during this time, historians call it the "Age of Reorganisation."

The last Mauryan king, Brihadratha, was killed by his army chief, Pushyamitra Shunga, who then started the Shunga dynasty. Other important dynasties of this period were the Bactrians (Indo-Greeks), the Shakas, and the Kushanas in the north-west, along with the Shungas in central India. Meanwhile, in the south, new dynasties such as the Cheras, Pandyas, Cholas, Chedis and Satavahanas also became powerful.

To grow and strengthen their kingdoms, rulers used different methods. These included:

- Marriage alliances between royal families.
- Paying tribute to stronger rulers.
- Attacking and capturing nearby areas.
- Forming alliances or fighting wars with neighbouring kingdoms.

Major dynasties of India in the "age of reorganisation"

RISE OF THE SHUNGAS

Around 185 BCE, after the Mauryan Empire weakened, Pushyamitra Shunga established the 'Shunga dynasty' and gained control over parts of northern and central India. To show that he was a strong and independent ruler, he performed the 'ashvamedha yajna', an important Vedic sacrifice. Even though the Shunga kingdom was smaller than the Mauryan Empire, Pushyamitra defended it bravely from possible foreign attacks. He fought a few early battles against the Greeks but later kept peaceful and friendly relations with them. After his rule, the empire continued but gradually lost its strength, ended nearly a hundred years later.

The Shunga period saw a fresh interest in Vedic rituals and traditions, though other ideas and beliefs also continued to grow. Sanskrit became a popular language for learning, discussions, and writing. During this time, several important works were written in Sanskrit. One of them was the Yoga Sutras by Patanjali, which explained yoga as a way to build physical fitness along with mental and spiritual balance.

The Shungas also encouraged art, literature, and building activities. The Bharhut Stupa in present-day Madhya Pradesh is a fine example of Shunga art. Although it may have first been built during Ashoka's rule, the Shungas added finely carved stone railings and panels. These carvings show scenes from the life of the

East gateway and railings at the Bharhut Stupa

Buddha and are among the earliest remaining examples of Buddhist art in India.

A sample of Shunga art, showing a royal Family

Pillar with elephants supporting the wheel of dharma

The Shungas made an important contribution to Indian art, particularly in sculpture and building design. They are famous for their fine stone carvings and detailed relief work.

THE SATAVAHANAS

The Shungas were often in conflict with nearby kingdoms. One of their main rivals were the Satavahanas, who ruled to the south of the Shunga Empire and controlled large areas of the Deccan from the 2nd century BCE onwards. In some ancient writings, the Satavahanas were known as the "Andhras."

Their kingdom included much of present-day Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Maharashtra. At different times, they had different capitals. Two important capitals were 'Amravati' and 'Pratishthana' (modern Paithan). The Satavahana period is famous for strong trade and business activities. They used sea routes to carry out trade within India and with faraway lands. Their growing trade made the economy strong and encouraged the development of art, culture, and architecture.

Coins of the Satavahanas

Coins issued by Satavahana rulers have been discovered from Gujarat in the west to Andhra Pradesh in the east. This wide distribution shows the large reach of their trade networks. Many of these coins show ships, proving that sea trade played a major role in their economy.

Farming also prospered in the Krishna-Godavari river valley, giving stability to the kingdom. Along with agriculture, the Satavahanas traded with distant regions, including the Roman Empire. They exported spices, fine cloth, sandalwood and luxury goods like gold-covered pearls and ivory. In return, they imported items such as glassware and scented oils.

The Satavahanas encouraged education, arts and building activities, and made lasting contributions to India's rich cultural heritage.

Life under the Satavahanas

In the Satavahana tradition, princes were often named after their mothers. A famous example is 'Gautamiputra Satakarni', whose name was taken from his mother, 'Gautami Balashri'. She was a powerful and respected queen who donated land to Buddhist monks. She also got an important inscription written at Nashik, which shows the active role she played in the kingdom's affairs.

Another important source from this time is the inscriptions found in the Naneghat caves near Pune. These writings talk about a Satavahana queen who, after becoming a widow, performed many Vedic rituals, including the ashvamedha yajna. The inscriptions mention Vedic Gods like

Indra, Chandra and Surya. They also describe the queen's dana (charity), which included gifts of land, cows, horses, elephants, silver coins, and other items given to priests, visitors, workers, scholars, and monks.

Naneghat caves, near Pune

Naneghat caves, inscriptions

The 'Naneghat inscriptions' were written in the 'Brahmi script' and include some early numerals. A few of these number symbols look similar to modern digits. This is one reason why scholars believe that today's numerals first developed in India.

The Satavahanas were devoted to Vasudeva (another name for Krishna), but they also respected other beliefs and traditions. They gave tax-free land to Vedic scholars as well as to Jain and Buddhist monks, helping them continue their learning and religious practices.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
𑁒	𑁓	𑁔	𑁕	𑁖	𑁗	𑁘	𑁙	𑁚

The Karla Caves (near Lonavala) house tall pillars and a stupa in the centre

By the 3rd century CE, the Satavahana Empire broke into smaller kingdoms. The main reasons for its decline were weak central rule and a slow economic slowdown. As their power reduced, local rulers became strong and started new kingdoms in different parts of the subcontinent.

THE RISE OF THE CHEDIS

After the Mauryan Empire declined, Kalinga (present-day Odisha) became powerful under the Chedi dynasty. One of their greatest rulers was Kharavela, who was known as a devoted follower of Jainism. He was sometimes called bhikshu-raja, meaning "monk-king," yet he respected all religions and ideas.

Near Bhubaneswar, the Chedi rulers built the Udayagiri–Khandagiri caves, which were likely made for Jain monks. These caves have beautifully carved panels, statues and large halls cut out of solid rock. They are fine examples of rock-cut architecture, a style that later became an important part of Indian art and building design.

A special feature of these caves is the Hathigumpha inscription, written in the Brahmi script. This inscription gives a detailed year-by-year account of King Kharavela's achievements. It tells us about his successful military campaigns and the generous steps he took for the welfare of his people.

The Udayagiri - Khandagiri caves, Bhubaneshwar, Odisha

In the inscription, Kharavela proudly mentions that he formed a council of sages and ascetics from a

hundred regions. He describes himself as a ruler "rich in noble qualities, respectful of every sect, and a restorer of every temple." This shows not only his strength as a king but also his support for religious harmony and cultural care.

Kharavela's words reflect his pride in protecting different beliefs and traditions. This spirit of respect for diversity, open discussion and care for cultural and religious heritage is an important part of the Indian ethos.

In-Text Questions

1. The last Mauryan ruler, _____, was killed by his army chief Pushyamitra Shunga.
2. The Satavahana ruler Gautamiputra Satakarni was named after his mother, _____.
3. The Hathigumpha inscription, which describes the achievements of King Kharavela, is written in the _____ script.
4. The Udayagiri–Khandagiri caves near _____ were developed under the Chedi rulers.

GLORY OF THE SOUTHERN KINGDOMS

Between the 2nd or 3rd century BCE and the 3rd century CE, three great kingdoms rose in southern India—the Cheras, Cholas, and Pandyas. These strong dynasties often competed with one another for land and control of trade routes. Even though they sometimes fought, each of them helped in the growth of culture and trade in the region. During the peak of the Mauryan Empire, these southern kingdoms stayed independent. Emperor Ashoka mentioned them in his edicts as separate powers, which shows that Mauryan rule did not spread into their territories. Later, King Kharavela of the Chedi dynasty claimed that he defeated a group of southern rulers who had formed an alliance against him. However, the exact place of this battle is not known, and there is no clear proof that he entered the deep South.

The Kingdoms of the South

This period is known as the Sangam Age. The name comes from the gatherings, or sangams, of poets and scholars. The word 'Sangam' is taken from the Sanskrit term sangha, which means 'association' or 'coming together.' These meetings led to the creation of some of the earliest and most important works of Tamil literature, known together as Sangam literature. The poems of this age are admired for their beauty and for the valuable information they give about the daily life, economy and culture of ancient South India. They express many human feelings and values, such as love, friendship, bravery, kindness and loyalty. Today, historians depend greatly on Sangam poetry to understand the life of people during this time.

Go Further

Sangam poems show that women were also respected poets in ancient South India. Some poems were written by women who described daily life, love, bravery and nature. Their voices help historians learn that education, creativity and cultural life during the Sangam Age included both men and women.

THE CHOLAS

The Sangam texts speak about three great 'crowned kings' of ancient South India—the Cholas, the Cheras, and the Pandyas. Among them, the Cholas were one of the strongest and longest-ruling dynasties. They governed parts of South India from about the 3rd century BCE to the 13th century CE. One of their most famous rulers was 'Karikala Chola'. He is believed to have defeated the combined forces of the Cheras and Pandyas, which helped him establish Chola power in the region.

Karikala Chola is also remembered for important public works that improved the lives of his people. His greatest achievement was building the Kallanai, also called the Grand Anicut. It was a smart water-management system constructed at an important point below Srirangam island. The Kallanai directed water from the Kaveri River to the central and southern areas of the Kaveri delta. This improved irrigation and brought large areas of land under farming. Because of its rich harvests, the delta became known as the 'Rice Bowl of the South.' The Kallanai has been repaired and maintained many times over the centuries and is still in use today, supplying water to millions of farmers in Tamil Nadu.

The Grand Anicut built by Karikala Chola

THE CHERAS

The Chera dynasty, also called the Keralaputras, meaning 'sons of Kerala,' ruled the western parts of present-day Tamil Nadu and Kerala. Their capital was Vanji, which is thought to be modern-day Karur in Tamil Nadu. The Cheras are remembered not only for their strong army and control of trade routes but also for supporting art and literature.

By encouraging Sangam poets and helping Tamil literature grow, the Cheras created a rich cultural heritage that still influences South India today. Their kingdom also had active trade with faraway lands, including the Roman Empire and West Asia. They exported valuable goods like spices, ivory, timber, and pearls.

Chera Coins

The Chera kings issued many types of coins during their rule. These coins usually had the royal emblem, which showed the king's authority. Coins were not only used for trade but also helped display the king's power and prestige.

THE PANDYAS

The Pandya dynasty, with its capital at present-day Madurai, is one of the oldest known kingdoms of Tamil Nadu, with history going back several centuries BCE. Over time, successive Pandya rulers expanded their kingdom. The Greek ambassador Megasthenes, in his famous book Indika, described the Pandyas as a rich and prosperous kingdom involved is active trade. They had strong trade links with distant lands like Greece and Rome, as well as busy internal trade. King Kharavela also mentioned their wealth, saying that hundreds of pearls came from the Pandya kingdom.

The Pandyas were also a powerful naval force, controlling important sea trade routes across the Indian Ocean. In later years, they became famous for their contributions to art, architecture and the growth of their region. They built temples and created cultural traditions that still influence Tamil Nadu today.

The Pandyas also left behind many inscriptions. These records show that their kings cared deeply for the welfare of their people and supported different beliefs, religions and schools of thought.

An Inscription dating back to Kulasekara Pandyan era, found at Vellanchar village in Pudukottai district

Silappadikaram is an epic written shortly after the Sangam Age. It tells the story of Kannagi and her fight for justice. Kannagi lived with her husband, Kovalan, in the important Chola port city of Puhar (also called Kaveripattinam). Kovalan fell in love with a dancer and spent all his money on her. Realizing his mistake, he returned to Kannagi, who forgave him. They then moved to Madurai, the capital of the Pandya kingdom, to start a new life.

Kannagi in the Pandyan court, a scene from the epic Silappadikaram

To begin again, Kannagi gave Kovalan one of her anklets to sell. But Kovalan was wrongly accused of stealing the queen's anklet and was executed by the Pandya king. Kannagi proved his innocence by showing the matching anklet she still had. Shocked at his mistake, the king collapsed and died. In grief and anger, Kannagi cursed Madurai, and the city was said to have been destroyed by fire.

After this, Kannagi went west to the Chera kingdom, where she was honoured like a goddess. Even today, she is worshipped in Tamil Nadu and Kerala as a symbol of purity and justice.

The epic teaches the importance of justice, dharma (moral duty), and responsible leadership. It also gives lively descriptions of city life, trade, and the cultural diversity of ancient South India.

In-Text Questions

1. Why were irrigation projects like the Kallanai dam important for farming and the growth of kingdoms in ancient South India?
2. How did sea trade help southern kingdoms like the Pandyas and Cheras become wealthy and powerful?

THE INDO-GREEKS IN ANCIENT INDIA

While southern India grew strong under native kingdoms, the north saw a very different political scene. After the Mauryan Empire ended, north-western India (covering parts of present-day Pakistan and Afghanistan) became weak and faced many foreign invasions. This started with Alexander the Great's short campaign in the Indus region. When Alexander left, he appointed satraps (provincial governors) to manage the lands. Over time, these satraps became independent rulers, and their successors are called the Indo-Greeks. They controlled large parts of north-western, northern and central India. Even though they came as conquerors, they were greatly influenced by Indian culture. This led to a mix of Greek and Indian traditions in government, art, language and daily life.

A famous example of Indo-Greek and Indian cultural blending is the Heliodorus Pillar near Vidisha in Madhya Pradesh. Built by the Greek ambassador Heliodorus, it shows close links between the two cultures. The inscription praises Vasudeva (Krishna) as the 'God of Gods' and also mentions three moral rules—self-restraint, charity, and awareness—saying that following them leads to heaven.

The Heliodorus Pillar

Archaeologists have found many Indo-Greek coins in north India. These coins, made of gold, silver, copper and nickel, usually had the king's image on one side and Greek gods on the other. Later, some coins started showing Indian gods like Vasudeva-Krishna and Lakshmi, showing how Greek and Indian cultures blended during this period.

SHAKAS

The centuries following the decline of the Mauryan empire witnessed the rise of powerful foreign dynasties who entered India through the northwestern fron-tiers. Among the most influential were the Shakas and the Kushāṇas.The Shakas, also known as Indo-Scythians, originated from the eastern regions of Iran and gradually moved into northwestern India around the 1st century BCE. They established strongholds in regions, such as Taxila, Mathura, Gujarat, and Malwa. Among their most notable rulers was Rudradāman I, whose reign is remembered for both military achievements and public welfare efforts. He successfully checked the advance of the Sātavāhana dynasty and extended his control over vast territories including Sindh, Kathiawar, and the Western Deccan.

Rudradāman is also credited with the repair of the Sudarsana lake in Kathiawar, an early example of state-led irrigation reform. The Śhakas introduced the 'Satrap' system of

governance, inspired by Persian models. Under this system, the kingdom was divided into provinces, each headed by a governor known as a Mahāksatrapa.

Do you know?

The Shakas, also called the Indo-Scythians, invaded the north-western part of the Indian subcontinent and set up their rule there. They stayed in power from the late 2nd century BCE to around the 5th century CE. The Shakas came after the Indo-Greeks and ruled until the Kushanas became dominant. During their rule, the Shaka Samvat calendar was introduced. This calendar is 78 years behind the Gregorian calendar, except between January and March, when it is 79 years behind. In 1957, the Shaka Samvat was officially adopted as the Indian National Calendar.

THE ARRIVAL OF THE KUSHANAS

The Kushanas, who came from Central Asia, entered India around the 2nd century CE. At the peak of their power, their empire stretched from Central Asia to many parts of northern India. Their rule encouraged cultural exchange and left a lasting mark on Indian history. The most famous Kushana ruler was Kanishka. He was a strong warrior who expanded the empire through military campaigns. He was also a supporter of art, religion and learning.

A well-known 'headless' statue of Kanishka has a Brahmi inscription calling him 'maharaja rajadhiraja devaputra Kanishka'. This means 'great king, king of kings, son of God, Kanishka.' It shows his supreme power and suggests that kings were considered divine at that time.

Kanishka's headless statue

Coins from Kanishka's reign give more information about the period. One coin shows Kanishka holding a spear with the title 'King of Kings,' while the other side shows the Buddha with the Greek letters BOΔΔO (Buddha). Another coin shows Kanishka on one side and the Hindu god Shiva with his bull Nandi on the other. Images of other gods, like the Sun God (Surya), also appeared during this time. The use of Buddhist and Hindu figures together, along with Greek writing, shows the mix of beliefs under Kushana rule.

Gold coins from the Kushana Dynasty

Go Further

During the Kushana period, new artistic styles developed in places like Gandhara. Artists mixed Indian ideas with Greek and Central Asian styles to create statues of the Buddha that looked very realistic. These sculptures often showed curly hair, flowing robes and calm expressions, showing how different cultures influenced Indian art.

The Kushanas controlled important parts of the Silk Route, a key trade path linking India with Central Asia and the western world. As trade along this route grew, people and cultures came into close contact. This led to the sharing of new ideas, art styles and religious traditions across regions. Art and architecture developed quickly under royal support. Sculptures showed many

different Gods, reflecting the peaceful coexistence of diverse beliefs. Deities like Surya were shown in more human-like forms, and religious art grew fast. These changes later influenced temple architecture in many parts of India. The Kushana period is especially known for the Gandhara and Mathura schools of art, both showing a mix of styles and influences.

Silk Route connecting India with other parts of the world

The Gandhara school developed in western Punjab. It combined Greco-Roman artistic features with Indian ideas. Sculptures were usually made of grey-black schist stone and carved in great detail. Gandhara artists made many Buddha images showing realistic body features and robes falling in natural, flowing folds.

The Gandhara school, inspired by Roman art, showed the Buddha with a youthful, Apollo-like face and Roman-style robes.

The Mathura school grew in Mathura, in present-day Uttar Pradesh. It followed a more Indian style of art. Unlike Gandhara, Mathura sculptors mainly used red sandstone and had less Greco-Roman influence. They created images of Indian Gods like Kubera, Lakshmi, Shiva, Buddha, Yakshas and Yakshinis. Figures in this style are generally fuller and smoothly shaped.

Mathura-style sculpture of the Buddha

Even though this period saw wars and rivalry among kingdoms, it was also a time of active cultural exchange. Many new kingdoms and dynasties arose, and foreign groups from Central Asia entered and ruled parts of India. After settling, these groups mixed with local society and adopted Indian

cultural traditions. Their artistic and architectural ideas blended with Indian styles, creating new forms of expression. This cultural mixing is seen clearly in art and architecture, where different styles merged while Indian themes—especially Hindu and Buddhist ones—remained central. At the same time, Sanskrit literature grew, and major works such as the Mahabharata and the Ramayana were compiled. Overall, this period became an important phase of cultural interaction and assimilation.

In-Text Questions

1. How did foreign rulers like the Indo-Greeks and Kushanas influence the culture and traditions of ancient India?
2. What is one major difference between the Gandhara school of art and the Mathura school of art?
3. Why do historians say that the period of Indo-Greeks and Kushanas was a time of cultural mixing and assimilation in India?
4. How did trade along the Silk Route help different cultures exchange ideas, art styles and religions?

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Inscription:** Words carved on stone, metal or other hard surfaces.
- **Assimilation:** When newcomers adopt local culture and way of life.
- **Ethos:** Core values, spirit or beliefs of a society.
- **Matrimonial Alliance:** Marriage between kingdoms to form political friendship.
- **Stupa:** Dome-shaped Buddhist structure holding sacred religious relics.
- **Silk Route:** Trade paths connecting India, Central Asia and West.

QUICK TAKE

- After the Mauryan Empire ended, India broke into many smaller kingdoms. Because dynasties rose and fell quickly, this time is called the 'Age of Reorganisation.'
- New dynasties like the Shungas, Satavahanas, Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas, and Chedis (Kalinga) became important in different regions.
- Trade and farming grew, especially under the Satavahanas and southern kingdoms, bringing wealth and helping towns develop.
- Art, buildings, and literature also flourished, including Bharhut Stupa, rock-cut caves, and the Sangam poems of the south.
- Foreign groups such as the Indo-Greeks, Shakas, and Kushanas came to the north-west and ruled parts of India.
- These rulers mixed with Indian culture, creating new art, coins, pillars and styles like Gandhara and Mathura.

EXERCISES

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Who started the Shunga dynasty?
   (a) Ashoka ☐ (b) Pushyamitra ☐
   (c) Kanishka ☐ (d) Kharavela ☐
2. Which dynasty ruled the Deccan region?
   (a) Satavahana dynasty ☐ (b) Shunga dynasty ☐
   (c) Chera dynasty ☐ (d) Kushan dynasty ☐
3. Which river valley supported Satavahana farming?
   (a) Ganga River Valley ☐ (b) Krishna-Godavari River Valley ☐
   (c) Indus River Valley ☐ (d) Narmada River Valley ☐
4. Which caves were built by the Chedis?
   (a) Udayagiri–Khandagiri Caves ☐ (b) Ajanta Caves ☐
   (c) Ellora Caves ☐ (d) Barabar Caves ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. The decline of the Mauryan Empire led to the rise of many smaller kingdoms in different parts of India. ☐
2. The Shakas ruled the northwest of India from the 5th century BCE to the 2nd century CE. ☐
3. The Gandhara School of Art used mainly red sandstone for making statues. ☐
4. The Silk Route helped connect India with Central Asia and other regions for trade and cultural exchange. ☐
5. The Satavahana dynasty encouraged sea trade with distant regions. ☐

C. Fill in the blanks.

1. Historians call the period after the fall of the Mauryan Empire the _____ of Reorganisation.
2. The Satavahana dynasty kingdom had important capitals such as _____ and Pratishthana.
3. The famous _____ inscription gives a year-by-year account of the achievements of Kharavela.
4. The Chera dynasty capital was _____, believed to be present-day Karur.
5. The great irrigation work built by Karikala Chola is called the _____.

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : The Kushan Empire helped cultural exchange between different regions.
   Reason (R) : They controlled important sections of the Silk Route.

2. **Assertion (A)** : The Gandhara School of Art shows a mixture of Indian and foreign artistic styles.
   Reason (R) : Artists in this school used red sandstone and followed only traditional Indian styles.
3. **Assertion (A)** : The Satavahana dynasty became prosperous during their rule.
   Reason (R) : They encouraged sea trade with distant regions, including the Roman Empire.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the images and answer the questions that follow.

Figure 1

Figure 2

1. In Figure 1, the Heliodorus Pillar near Vidisha was built by a Greek ambassador who called himself a devotee of Vasudeva (Krishna). What does this symbolise?
   (a) It shows that foreigners rejected Indian deities.
   (b) It symbolises mutual respect and cultural exchange.
   (c) It is an early example of how faiths influenced each other through contact.
   (d) Some Greeks adopted Indian religious beliefs like devotion to Vasudeva.
2. In Figure 2, the Naneghat Caves near Pune were located on a major trade route and used to collect tolls and taxes. What does this reveal about the Satavahana Empire?
   (a) They focused only on religious rituals.
   (b) They encouraged trade and maintained infrastructure for merchants.
   (c) They discouraged contact with foreign traders.
   (d) They relied only on agriculture for wealth.

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. What led to the fall of the Mauryan empire?
2. How did the Kushan Empire gain advantages by controlling parts of the Silk Route?
3. Why do historians describe the time after the fall of the Mauryan Empire as the "Age of Reorganisation"?
4. How did the Satavahana dynasty grow stronger? Explain the role of farming, sea trade and Ship coins writings (inscriptions).

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. "Art in this period shows cultural blending but Indian themes remained dominant," Explain this statement with examples from Gandhara and Mathura art.
2. Evaluate the impact of river systems and port towns on the growth of South Indian kingdoms like

the Satavahanas, Cheras and Cholas.

3. Discuss the impact of Indo-Greek rule on Indian art, religion and coinage.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

In the ancient city of Madurai, poets gathered in a magnificent hall known as the Sangam. The air was filled with the rhythm of Tamil verses praising the beauty of nature and the bravery of kings. The Chera, Chola and Pandya rulers honoured these poets with gifts, making their courts centres of art and learning. Their poems spoke of love, courage, friendship and justice, reflecting both royal life and the emotions of ordinary people. Through the Sangam collections, we learn about trade, war, festivals and the everyday life of Tamil society. The poets expressed their thoughts in graceful language, giving India one of its earliest treasures of literature. Even today, their verses remind us that poetry can connect people through feelings and values that never fade.

(a) What themes were commonly found in Sangam poetry?

(b) How did Sangam literature help in preserving the cultural identity of South India?

(c) If you were a Sangam poet living today, what modern topic would inspire your poem and why?

VI. PROJECT WORK

"Storytellers of the South" - Voices from the Sangam Age

I. Objective:

- To explore Tamil culture through the Silappadikaram and Sangam poems and recognise values of justice, courage and equality.

II. Tasks:

- Read the story of Kannagi
- In groups, dramatise one scene of the false accusation, her proof of innocence, or her journey to Madurai.
- Another group acts as poets composing a Sangam verse describing her courage.
- Compare and Discuss:

  What ideals of justice and truth are shown in the story?

  How did Sangam poets reflect society and women's roles?

  What connects Kannagi's story to ideas of dharma?

III. Expected Learning Outcome:

By the end of this activity, you will:

- Interpret literature as a reflection of society.
- Appreciate early Tamil culture and moral values.
- Develop empathy through performance and storytelling.

7 The Gupta Era: An Age Of Tireless Creativity

Let's Learn About

- What qualities do you think make a king or ruler truly 'great'?
- Which qualities do you admire the most?
- Rulers who support art, learning and science.

Let's Gear Up

Anya and Kabir's Museum Trip

After finishing their project on the Pandya kingdom, Anya and Kabir were excited to learn about the next empires. Anya sighed, "Kabir, how will we ever remember all these kingdoms and kings?" Kabir smiled and said, "Don't worry! If we see what makes each empire special, it will be easier to remember."

A week later, they went to the National Museum in Delhi with their parents. The museum was huge, with many galleries full of treasures from India's past. As they walked along the long corridors, a tall, shining exhibit caught their eyes—the famous Iron Pillar of Delhi.

Kabir pointed at it and explained, "This pillar is more than 1,600 years old, and it hasn't rusted even a little! It was built during Chandragupta II's rule in the Gupta dynasty. Scholars believe it was first placed at Udayagiri/Vidhiśā and later moved to Delhi. Look closely at the inscriptions—they praise the king and are dedicated to Lord Vishnu."

Anya whispered in awe, "If one pillar tells us so much, imagine what the whole empire was like!" Kabir nodded, "Exactly! From this one pillar, we can start understanding the Gupta Empire—its kings, their achievements, and how people lived long ago." The museum visit turned into an exciting journey through history, making learning feel like an adventure.

A NEW POWER RISES

By the 3rd century CE, the powerful Kushana Empire, which had ruled much of northern and north-western India, started to grow weak. As their control reduced, many small regional kingdoms began to appear. During this time of change, the Gupta dynasty slowly became strong and built a large and powerful empire.

There are different ideas about where the Guptas came from. Most historians believe that they first ruled a region near present-day Uttar Pradesh. The Gupta Empire is said to have been started by Sri Gupta. However, it was during the rule of Chandragupta I and his successors that the empire became very powerful and famous.

The Iron Pillar inscription in Delhi tells about a king named 'Chandra'. Most historians think this refers to Chandragupta II of the Gupta dynasty, not Chandragupta Maurya of the earlier Maurya Empire. Chandragupta II, who was also known as 'Vikramaditya', was one of the greatest Gupta rulers. He worshipped Lord Vishnu, and the image of Garuda, Vishnu's mount, is often seen on Gupta coins and inscriptions.

The Warrior King – Samudragupta

An Inscription by Harisena

The Prayaga Prashasti is a famous pillar inscription found in Prayagraj. It gives us valuable information about the Gupta ruler Samudragupta, who was the father of Chandragupta II. The inscription was written by Harisena, a poet in the king's court. It describes Samudragupta as a brave and ambitious ruler who wanted to become dharani-bandha, meaning a king who aimed to unite the whole Earth under one strong rule.

To achieve this dream, Samudragupta carried out many military campaigns. He defeated several kings and added their lands to his growing empire. Some defeated rulers were allowed to rule again, but only after they accepted his authority and agreed to pay tribute. Others, seeing his growing power, surrendered without a fight. The inscription shows not only his strength in battle but also his smart planning in building a vast empire.

Gold coin of Samdragupta showing him playing a veena

Harisena also praises Samudragupta for encouraging art, education and trade, which made the empire rich and successful. Interestingly, one of his coins shows him playing the veena, a musical instrument. This tells us that Samudragupta loved music and supported culture along with warfare.

Coins of Samudragupta showing the Ashwamedha horse and the queen holding a fly-whisk, symbolising the royal sacrifice.

Ancient books give us more information about the Gupta kingdom. The Vishnu Purana, for example, names important regions that were at the centre of the Gupta Empire. These included Anuganga (the middle Gangetic valley), Prayagraj, Saketa (now Ayodhya), and Magadha (around present-day Bihar).Later, the empire expanded far beyond these core areas. At its height, the Gupta Empire stretched across most of northern and western India, and also included large parts of central and eastern India. This wide spread of land shows how powerful the Gupta rulers were and how strongly they influenced much of the Indian subcontinent.

A TRAVELLER'S ACCOUNT OF INDIAN SOCIETY IN THE GUPTA AGE

An important source for learning about the Gupta Age is the travel account of the Chinese pilgrim Faxian (pronounced Fa-Shi-Anne). He visited India in the early 5th century CE. His main purpose was to see famous Buddhist places, study with Indian teachers and collect Buddhist manuscripts to carry back to China. Faxian travelled to many parts of the subcontinent and carefully wrote down what he saw.

In his notes, Faxian described the daily life of the people, the religious practices he noticed and how the Gupta government worked. Later, his observations were put together in a book. Even today, historians use this book to understand society and everyday life during the Gupta period.

However, Faxian's account shows only what he personally experienced and what interested him most. He praised many features of Indian society but also mentioned the harsh treatment of the chandalas, who were forced to live outside city boundaries.

In-Text Questions

1. The famous pillar inscription called the _____ gives important information about Samudragupta's achievements.
2. The Chinese traveller _____ visited India during the Gupta Age to collect Buddhist manuscripts.
3. Chandragupta II was also known by the title _____.

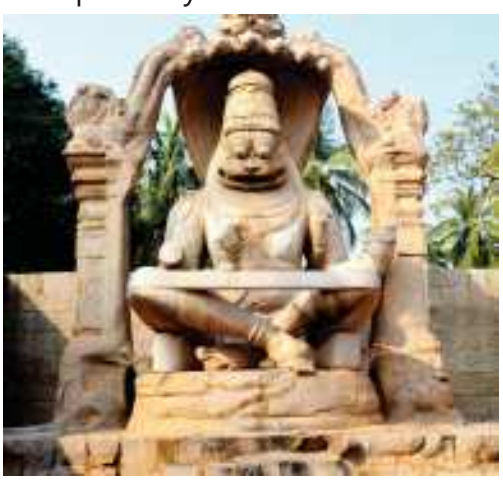
Faxian's writings give us useful information about the past, but they share only one traveller's point of view. To gain a fuller understanding of the Gupta Age, historians depend on many other sources. They examine inscriptions, ancient texts, archaeological remains, coins and other records. By studying and comparing all these sources, historians can create a clearer and more reliable picture of the Gupta period.

GLIMPSES OF THE GUPTA AGE

Governance and Administration

During the Gupta Age, many kingdoms ruled at the same time. They often fought wars to increase their lands and power. Along with battles, rulers also used smart diplomacy to make friends and allies. This idea was similar to the teachings of Kautilya, who said that forming alliances, or mitra, was an important part of the Saptanga theory—the seven parts of good governance. Marriage alliances were also used to build strong political ties between kingdoms.

A famous example is Prabhavati Gupta, the daughter of Chandragupta II. She married a prince of the neighbouring Vakataka dynasty. When her husband died at a young age, she became the regent queen and helped keep friendly relations between the Guptas and the Vakatakas. One of her inscriptions calls her the 'mother of two kings,' meaning her two sons who later became rulers of the Vakataka kingdom.



The Narsimha statue, an incarnation of Lord Vishnu

Like her father, Prabhavati Gupta was a devotee of Lord Vishnu. She is believed to have built several temples dedicated to Vishnu and his different forms. Some of these temples can still be seen at Ramagiri, now known as Ramtek hill in Maharashtra.

Gupta rulers showed their power by using impressive royal titles. They called themselves maharajadhiraja (great king of kings), samrat (emperor) and chakravartin (universal ruler). These titles highlighted their high position and the glory of the Gupta dynasty. By choosing such strong titles, they made it clear that they were mighty rulers whose authority spread across wide areas.

The Gupta Empire followed a well-planned system of administration. Instead of controlling every region directly from the capital, the empire was divided into provinces. The king granted land to local rulers, priests and chiefs so they could help in governing these areas. Information about these land grants was written on copper plates, many of which have been found by archaeologists. This arrangement made tax collection easier and allowed local leaders to manage their regions while staying loyal to the Gupta kings. As a result, the empire functioned smoothly and kept control over its large territory.

Wealth and Trade

During the Gupta period, land tax was the main source of income for the empire. The rulers also earned money from fines, mines, irrigation works, trade and crafts. This income was used to run the government, maintain the army, build temples and roads and support scholars and artists.

Trade played a very important role in the Gupta economy and kept the empire rich. India traded with the Mediterranean lands, Southeast Asia, and China. Traders exported goods such as cloth, spices, ivory and precious stones. Indian ports were busy centres of the Indian Ocean trade routes.

In-Text Questions

- How does trade help people from different regions share their ideas, customs, food, clothes, and art with one another?
- Can you name one thing from another country or culture that you use, eat, wear, or see in your everyday life?

An important halt on the sea route to the Mediterranean region was Socotra Island in the Arabian Sea. Archaeologists have found pottery, Brahmi inscriptions, and even designs of a Buddhist stupa there. These show that Indian traders visited the island for many centuries. Merchants from Egypt, Arabia, Rome and Greece also stopped at Socotra. All this proves that trade not only linked markets but also helped different cultures meet and share ideas across the Indian Ocean.

NEW IDEAS AND WONDERS

Gupta rulers were devoted followers of Lord Vishnu, and this devotion can be seen on their coins and inscriptions. At the same time, they welcomed other religions and ideas. They supported Buddhist monasteries and learning centres, including the famous Nalanda University, which later

became a world-renowned seat of learning. By encouraging different traditions and schools of thought, the Guptas helped make this period India's 'Classical Age,' known for great progress in art, architecture, and knowledge.

Many historians call the Gupta period India's Classical Age because long periods of peace and stability allowed achievements in many fields. It was a time of learning new things and preserving older knowledge in organised books. Sanskrit literature flourished, with famous works like the plays and poems of Kalidasa and the compilation of important Puranas. Science and mathematics grew through scholars such as Aryabhata and Varahamihira, who studied astronomy, planets and numbers. Medicine advanced as doctors wrote texts mixing old knowledge with new observations. In metallurgy, Gupta craftsmen were very skilled; the rust-resistant Iron Pillar of Delhi still stands as proof of their expertise.

Do you know?

The Iron Pillar of Delhi

The Iron Pillar at Mehrauli is a famous monument from the Gupta period. It is more than 1,600 years old and has not rusted, even though it has stood outside for hundreds of years. This shows the advanced skill in metalwork that ancient Indians had. The pillar weighs about six tonnes and was put up during the rule of Chandragupta II of the Gupta dynasty. It was probably first placed near the Udayagiri caves in present-day Madhya Pradesh and moved to Delhi a few centuries later.

The Iron Pillar at Mehrauli, Delhi

The pillar was dedicated to Lord Vishnu, and its inscriptions praise the king's deeds and victories. Scientists think the pillar has stayed rust-free because a very thin protective layer formed on the iron, which stops it from corroding. This incredible monument shows the high level of science and craftsmanship during the Gupta Age.

Chandragupta II, a famous Gupta emperor, brought together scholars, writers and artists at his court. With his encouragement, the court became a busy hub of learning and creativity, filled with the many talents he supported and inspired.

Let's meet some remarkable people who made this period a golden age of learning and culture.

Aryabhata

Aryabhata was a famous mathematician and astronomer who lived around 500 CE in Kusumapura, near present-day Patna. He wrote an important short book called the Aryabhatiya. In it, he explained how the Sun, Moon, and planets move and suggested that the Earth spins on its axis, which causes day and night.

Aryabhata also calculated the length of a year as 365 days, 6 hours, 12 minutes, and 30 seconds—a value very close to what we use today. He estimated the size of the Earth and correctly explained how solar and lunar eclipses happen.

In mathematics, Aryabhata described several ways to solve calculations and equations. Many of

these methods are still taught in schools today, even though they were developed more than 1,500 years ago. His work laid the foundation for further scientific discoveries in India and other countries, showing the advanced learning of the Gupta Age.

Varahamihira

Varahamihira was another important scholar of the Gupta period. He was a mathematician, astronomer and astrologer who lived in Ujjain, a city famous for learning. His encyclopedic book, the Brihat Samhita, covered many subjects, including astronomy, astrology, weather, architecture, town planning, water management and farming.

Analyze Thoughts

Which contribution – Aryabhata's scientific ideas, Varahamihira's observations, or Kalidasa's writings-do you think continues to influence modern India the most? Why?

Varahamihira combined careful observation with logical thinking and traditional knowledge to create ideas that were both practical and scientific. For example, his weather predictions were based on signs in nature, and his advice on building towns and houses influenced city planning for many years.

Kalidasa

Kalidasa was one of the greatest poets in Indian history and made a lasting mark on Sanskrit literature. Meghadutam (The Cloud Messenger) is one of his most famous poems, telling the story of a yaksha (a minor deity) who has been sent away from his home. The yaksha asks a passing cloud to carry his message to his beloved.

Kalidasa is also known for his famous play, Abhijnanasakuntalam, which is considered his best work. The play has been translated into many languages, including English. His writings are admired for their beautiful imagery, strong characters and elegant poetic style.

Ayurveda

Ayurveda, India's traditional system of medicine, was organised and written down during the Gupta period. Although it existed long before, the Gupta Age saw the final shaping of important books like the Charaka Samhita and the Sushruta Samhita. These texts became the foundation of Ayurvedic practices still used today. The books explain many diseases, how to identify and treat them and the importance of diet for good health. They also describe how medicines were made and explain surgical methods that were advanced for that time. Ayurveda focuses on a complete approach to healing, showing the close connection between the mind, body, and nature.

In-Text Questions

1. How do modern trade routes help connect countries just like the Gupta trade routes connected India to other regions?
2. How can traditional knowledge like Ayurveda help people maintain health in the modern world?

THE PURSUIT OF BEAUTY

Some of India's most famous works of art were made during the Gupta period. Centres of artistic skill developed at places like Sarnath (near present-day Varanasi), which became known for its calm and elegant Buddha statues and the Ajanta Caves, famous for colourful murals and rock-cut buildings. Another example of Gupta art is found in the Udayagiri caves, which have finely carved images of Hindu gods and goddesses.

Together, these works are called 'Gupta art' and are admired for their beauty, balance and sophistication. Their style and grace influenced artists for many centuries after.

The famous Ajanta Caves were carved out during the Guptas and Vakatakas periods

The exteriors of the Ajanta Caves

Lord Vishnu as Varaha in Udayagiri caves (401 CE)

THE DECLINE OF THE GUPTAS

By the 6th century CE, the Gupta Empire started to weaken. The Hunas, a tribe from Central Asia, attacked the northern borders many times and damaged the empire. Strong local rulers also gained power, leading to internal conflicts. Because of these problems, the empire split into smaller kingdoms, and the Hunas took control of regions like Gandhara, Punjab, Gujarat, and Malwa.

The Guptas also faced internal troubles such as weak rulers, poor administration, family quarrels and economic difficulties. Trade decreased and India's connections with the Mediterranean world grew weaker.

Even though the empire fell, the Gupta period is still called a Golden Age. The Guptas made great achievements in art, literature and science. Their ideas continued to inspire later kingdoms and their cultural legacy lasted for many generations.

Go Further

Gupta artists used natural materials like stone, clay, and minerals to make their paintings and sculptures. They paid attention to small details, showing animals, plants, and people's daily life, making their art realistic and full of life.

THE RISE OF REGIONAL POWERS: THE PALLAVAS AND KAMARUPA KINGDOM

At the same time the Guptas ruled northern India, the Pallavas became a strong dynasty in the south. They gradually expanded over areas that are now part of Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. Although their exact origins are not clear, historical evidence suggests they were once under the Satavahanas and rose to power as Satavahana influence declined.

The Pallavas were famous for their art, architecture and learning. Many rulers were devotees of Lord Shiva and built grand temples and rock-cut caves, which became early examples of Indian architecture. Their capital, Kanchipuram, grew into a major centre of education and earned the title "city of a thousand temples." Centres of learning called ghatikas promoted scholarship and intellectual activity.

In the northeast, the Kamarupa kingdom, ruled by the Varman dynasty, controlled the Brahmaputra valley (present-day Assam) and parts of Bengal and Bangladesh. Ancient texts like the Ramayana and Mahabharata call this region Pragjyotisha. The Mahabharata mentions King Bhagadatta of Pragjyotisha, who fought for the Kauravas. Some rulers of Kamarupa later claimed to be his descendants. Kamarupa grew into an important cultural and political centre, with temples and monasteries serving as hubs of learning.

Both the Pallavas and Kamarupa are mentioned in the Prayaga Prashasti. During his southern campaigns, Samudragupta defeated a Pallava ruler but did not annex the region. He allowed local kings, including the Pallavas, to continue ruling if they accepted his authority and paid tribute. A similar policy was followed in the northeast, where he defeated Kamarupa's ruler without taking direct control. This helped maintain peaceful relations with neighbouring kingdoms.

The Gupta period saw major achievements in many fields. Its influence spread far beyond the empire, shaping art, science, literature, and governance for centuries. Advances in mathematics, astronomy, medicine and metallurgy laid the groundwork for future progress. Temples, sculptures, and Sanskrit literature from this era continue to inspire generations. The Guptas created a prosperous and stable society, leaving a cultural and historical legacy that lasts to this day.

In-Text Questions

1. The Ajanta Caves are famous for their colourful _____ and rock-cut buildings.
2. The Pallavas made their capital, _____, a major centre of education and temples.
3. The Hunas, a tribe from _____, attacked the northern borders of the Gupta Empire.
4. The Kamarupa kingdom controlled the _____ valley, present-day Assam.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Manuscript:** A handwritten book or document, often an old and important text.
- **Travelogue:** A written account of someone's journey, describing places, people and experiences, like Faxian's notes.
- **Brahmi Script:** One of the earliest writing systems in ancient India, seen on old inscriptions.
- **Chakravartin:** A title meaning 'universal ruler,' used by some Gupta kings to show they were supreme.
- **Copper Plate:** A metal sheet used to record land grants, rules or important orders.
- **Tribute:** Money, gifts or goods given by a weaker ruler to a stronger one to show respect or submission.

QUICK TAKE

- After the decline of the Kushanas, the Guptas rose in northern India and built an empire that marked India's 'Classical Age' because of great progress in art, science and culture.
- Samudragupta expanded the empire through battles and alliances. The Prayaga Prashasti praises both his strength in war and his support for music, art and learning.
- The Guptas managed their empire with strong administration, land grants to officials and priests, and political ties like Prabhavati Gupta's marriage into the Vakataka family.
- Trade grew inside India and with distant regions like the Mediterranean, Southeast Asia and China.
- The traveller Faxian described a well-organised and rich society, but he also mentioned the harsh treatment of the outcastes.
- Great scholars lived in this period: Aryabhata made discoveries in astronomy and mathematics, Varahamihira wrote on science and weather and Kalidasa became famous for poetry and plays.
- Art and architecture flourished at centres like Sarnath, Ajanta and Udayagiri, known today for their beautiful Gupta-style sculptures and murals.
- Strong kingdoms like the Pallavas in the south and Kamarupa in the northeast also grew, each with their own culture and traditions.

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which scholar wrote Aryabhatiya?

   (a) Aryabhata ☐ (b) Kalidasa ☐ (c) Varahamihira ☐ (d) Harisena ☐

2. Which Gupta ruler was also called Vikramaditya and is shown on coins with Garuda?

   (a) Samudragupta, the conqueror ☐ (b) Chandragupta II, Gupta emperor ☐

   (c) Chandragupta I, early ruler ☐ (d) Aryabhata, mathematician ☐

3. Which famous learning centre was supported by the Guptas and became world-renowned?

   (a) Kanchipuram, city of temples ☐ (b) Ujjain, city of scholars ☐

   (c) Nalanda University, Buddhist learning ☐ (d) Kusumapura, Aryabhata's town ☐

4. Which tribe attacked the Gupta Empire from Central Asia, causing its decline?

   (a) Vakatakas, allies of Guptas ☐ (b) Hunas, invaders from north ☐

   (c) Kushanas, weakened northern empire ☐ (d) Mauryas, earlier Indian dynasty ☐

5. Who wrote the Prayaga Prashasti inscription praising Samudragupta?

   (a) Harisena, poet in king's court ☐ (b) Kalidasa, famous Sanskrit poet ☐

   (c) Varahamihira, astronomer and scholar ☐ (d) Faxian, Chinese traveller ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. The Gupta Empire first started near present-day Uttar Pradesh. ☐
2. Samudragupta was only a warrior and did not support art or music. ☐
3. The Chinese pilgrim Faxian visited India to collect Buddhist manuscripts. ☐
4. Gupta rulers forced all provinces to be directly controlled from the capital. ☐
5. Trade with the Mediterranean, Southeast Asia and China helped the Gupta Empire grow rich. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Varahamihira	A. Proposed Earth rotates on its axis.
2. Kalidasa	B. Wrote Brihat Samhita on astronomy and town-planning.
3. Aryabhata	C. Known for lyrical poems like Meghadutam.
4. Harisena	D. Is an important Ayurvedic text on medicine.
5. Charaka Samhita	E. Composed the Prayaga Prasasti inscription.

(a) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-E, 5-D
(b) 1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-B, 5-E
(c) 1-D, 2-E, 3-B, 4-C, 5-A
(d) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-E, 5-D

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : The Guptas used copper plates to record land grants.
   Reason (R) : Copper plates helped in tax collection and local governance.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Faxian's travel account gives a complete picture of Indian society in the Gupta period.
   Reason (R) : He visited India to see Buddhist places and learn from teachers.
3. **Assertion (A)** : The Pallavas became a major power in southern India during the Gupta period.
   Reason (R) : They built temples, rock-cut caves and promoted learning in Kanchipuram.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Gupta rulers promoted trade across the Indian Ocean.
   Reason (R) : Indian ports were busy centres connecting to China, Southeast Asia and the Mediterranean.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

(a) Name the king and queen.
(b) Explain the queen's depiction with a chauri.
(c) Identify the ruler and the unusual feature.

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. What do the temples and caves built by the Pallavas tell us about their skills in art and architecture?
2. Write a short note on Prabhavati Gupta. How did she increase Gupta influence in the south and what do her inscriptions tell us?
3. Why is the Iron Pillar in Delhi important for learning about the Gupta rulers?
4. How did marriages in royal families help the Gupta Empire grow stronger?
5. How did the Pallavas and Vakatakas work with the Guptas but still stay independent? What might have influenced their choices?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Explain how attacks from outside and problems inside together led to the fall of the Gupta Empire. Give one example of each.
2. Why is the Pallava period important in early South Indian history? Give examples from temples, sculptures, and culture.
3. Why must historians be careful when using traveller stories like Faxian's? Give one reason.
4. Describe how the Gupta Empire was governed. How were provinces managed and what part did land grants play?

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

The Classical Age: Knowledge, Medicine and Art

The Gupta era's stability fostered a Classical Age in which knowledge was compiled and systematised. Aryabhaţa (Kusumapura) proposed the Earth's rotation, calculated a year length close to modern values and explained eclipses rationally, alongside mathematical innovations. Varahamihira (Ujjayini) composed the Brihat Samhita, an encyclopaedia spanning astronomy/astrology, weather, architecture/town planning and farming, applying knowledge to practical life. Kalidasa's Meghadutam-a poem of a cloud-messenger-interlaces emotion with vivid landscapes and weather. In medicine, Ayurveda (Charaka, Susruta) was codified/refined, cataloguing diseases, therapies and surgical techniques (e.g.. cataract), while emphasising diet, lifestyle and prevention. In art, Ajanta

murals (natural pigments) and Sarnath sculpture exemplify spiritual poise; Udayagiri reliefs and Deogarh's Dasavatara Temple show narrative power and early stone temple mastery.

(a) What makes Brihat Samhita distinctive among ancient works?

(b) How does Meghadutam embody Classical Age aesthetics?

(c) Explain how state stability can amplify advances in science, medicine and art.

VI. PROJECT WORK

'Time-Travel Artists' - Exploring Gupta Art and Architecture

I. Objective:

- To understand the artistic excellence and cultural symbolism of Gupta sculpture, painting and temple architecture by observing, sketching and interpreting visual sources.

II. Tasks:

- Group Formation: Divide the class into 4-5 groups. Each group studies and represents one aspect of Gupta art:
  - Ajanta Cave Paintings
  - Udayagiri Rock-Cut Sculptures
  - Dasavatara Temple, Deogarh
  - Terracotta Figures of Ganga and Yamuna
  - The Iron Pillar of Delhi
- Research & Prepare (Teacher Provides Visuals): Each group examines images, videos or teacher-supplied printouts to identify:
  - Key features of style (grace, balance, naturalism)
  - Materials and techniques used
  - Religious or cultural themes depicted
  - Artistic message or symbolism
- Create & Present: Each group presents a 'Mini-Museum Exhibit' (2-3 minutes) by:
  - Displaying a labelled sketch, clay model or digital slide of their assigned artwork
  - Explaining its artistic details, purpose and meaning
  - Describing how it reflects Gupta society and beliefs
- Compare & Reflect: After the presentations, discuss as a class:
  - What common values or themes run through Gupta art?
  - How did art express devotion, science, or nature?
  - Why is this period called the Golden Age of Art?

III. Expected Learning Outcome:

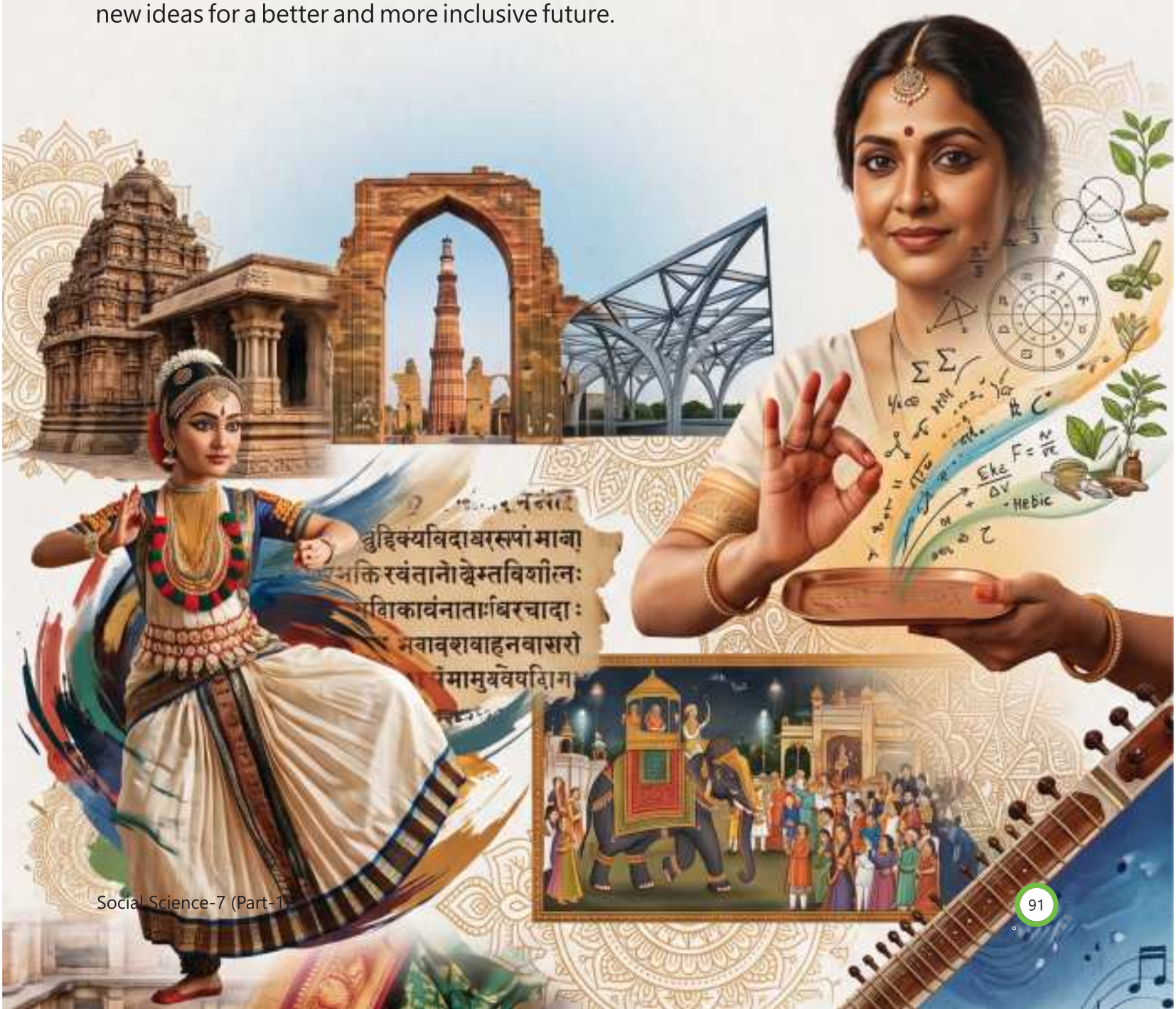
By the end of this activity, you will:

- Recognise the distinctive features of Gupta art and architecture.
- Link art with religion, technology and culture.
- Develop skills in visual observation, creativity and historical interpretation.

THEME–C

Our Cultural Heritage and Knowledge Traditions

India has a rich cultural heritage and a long tradition of knowledge that has developed over thousands of years. Our heritage includes languages, literature, art, music, dance, architecture, festivals, crafts, and monuments. Ancient centres of learning, scientific discoveries, mathematical ideas, and systems of medicine reflect India's valuable knowledge traditions. These traditions have been passed from one generation to another through stories, books, practices, and customs. They teach us the values of respect, harmony, creativity, and care for nature. Learning about our cultural heritage helps us understand our identity, appreciate diversity, and preserve our traditions while adopting new ideas for a better and more inclusive future.



8 How The Land Becomes Sacred

Let's Learn About

- What does the word 'sacredness' mean?
- How do certain places become known as sacred or holy?
- How do sacred places and pilgrimage routes influence people's culture and social life?
- How does sacred geography help create a sense of cultural unity in India?

Let's Gear Up

Sanchit and Ankita's Morning Walk

One bright morning, Sanchit and Ankita were strolling with their grandparents through the park near their village. The lake sparkled in the soft sunlight and people were placing flowers, lighting incense sticks and folding their hands in prayer by the water.

Ankita asked with wonder, "Dadu, why do people respect lakes and rivers so much?"

Grandfather smiled gently. "Because in our culture, water bodies are not just water. They give us life, food and happiness. When we care for them, we care for ourselves."

Sanchit said thoughtfully, "So, nature and God are not different. They are connected."

Grandmother agreed, "Yes! Our ancestors believed that the land, hills, trees, rivers and sky are all parts of the divine. That is why we call the Earth Bhudevi, our loving Mother Earth." And with that idea, their new lesson began.

WHAT IS 'SACREDNESS'?

'Sacredness' means that something has deep religious or spiritual importance and must be treated with respect. When something is sacred, people believe it is holy because it is connected to the divine. Sacredness is not limited to one place. It can be seen in a temple, a river, a hill or even a tree. It is also present in a special journey of faith called a pilgrimage. Any place where people feel calm, faith and safety can become sacred. Sacredness is not only about prayer. It creates a strong bond between people and their land, nature, customs and daily life. In India, it forms an important part of cultural identity. Many children grow up listening to sacred stories, celebrating

festivals and visiting holy places linked to their beliefs. In this way, ideas of sacredness influence how communities live, celebrate and protect their surroundings.

India is home to sacred places of many religions and traditions. Islam, Christianity, Judaism and Zoroastrianism, though they began outside India, are also followed here. Sacredness can be seen in temples, mosques, churches, gurudwaras, rivers, mountains, caves and forests. People travel to these places to pray and feel united with others.

Interestingly, some sacred places welcome people from different faiths. For example, the Ajmer Sharif Dargah and the Basilica of Our Lady of Good Health are visited by people of many religions who come seeking blessings. These places are important centres of pilgrimage, especially during special festivals.

Religions that began in India also have many sacred sites. Buddhism has several holy places connected with the life of Gautama Buddha—where he lived, taught or where his sacred relics are kept. The Great Stupa at Sanchi is believed to hold relics of the Buddha. The Mahabodhi Temple stands at the place where he attained enlightenment. Both are major pilgrimage centres and Bodh Gaya alone welcomes millions of visitors every year.

We worship in different ways, but the sacredness is same.

In Sikhism, the Takhts are seats of spiritual authority and are deeply respected. Important ones include Takht Sri Patna Sahib, the Akal Takht, and Takht Sri Keshgarh Sahib. Many Sikhs wish to visit these sacred places at least once in their lives because they are closely linked to the Sikh Gurus. Sikh history also tells us that Guru Nanak travelled widely to important religious places such as Haridwar, Prayagraj, Mathura, Varanasi, Ayodhya, and Puri and even visited important Muslim shrines.

In 1961, Jawaharlal Nehru wrote, "For many centuries, India has been a land of pilgrimages. Across the country, there are ancient holy places — from Badrinath Temple, Kedarnath Temple and Amarnath Temple, set high in the snowy Himalayas, to Kanyakumari in the far south. What has inspired people to travel from one end of India to the other on these sacred journeys? It is the strong feeling that we belong to one nation and share a common culture."

PILGRIMAGES

For more than 3,000 years, people in India have been going on tirthayatras, or pilgrimages, to holy places called tirthas across the subcontinent. Because of this long tradition, almost every region of the subcontinent is seen as sacred today. Devotees often travel on foot for many days, crossing rivers, fields, forests and even high mountains.

A pilgrimage is not just a simple visit to a place. It is a special journey taken to purify the mind and

heart. During these journeys, pilgrims follow strict rules and self-discipline. They may fast, chant prayers, avoid comforts or walk barefoot as a sign of devotion and faith.

Followers of Jainism go on pilgrimages to places connected with their Tirthankaras — the twenty-four great teachers of their faith. These are the spots where the Tirthankaras prayed, gave sermons or spent time. Even trees, ponds, hills and mountains that these holy teachers once visited are treated as sacred. Important Jain pilgrimage centres include Mount Abu, Girnar, and Shatrunjaya Hill in Saurashtra, Gujarat.

Sabarimala Temple in Kerala

Another well-known example is the Sabarimala Temple pilgrimage, dedicated to Ayyappa. Every year, millions of devotees visit this hill temple. They walk through thick forests and climb steep paths to reach the shrine. This difficult journey teaches self-control and patience. The rivers, hills and forests along the way are also respected as sacred parts of the pilgrimage.

Analyze Thoughts

Form groups of 4–5 students and use the internet to learn about a sacred place in India (for example, Varanasi, Bodh Gaya, the Golden Temple, Ajmer Sharif, Velankanni, etc.). Find out where it is located, what important rituals or practices take place there and why people consider it sacred. Prepare a short report and share your findings with the class.

In-Text Questions

1. Sacredness creates a strong bond between people and their _____, nature and traditions.
2. The _____ Temple at Bodh Gaya stands at the place where Gautama Buddha attained enlightenment.
3. During a pilgrimage, devotees may chant prayers or walk _____ as a sign of faith and self-discipline.

More Sacred Sites

In Hinduism, as well as in many folk and tribal traditions, people worship Nature. They believe that mountains, rivers, forests, trees, animals, plants and even certain stones are sacred. Many rivers are honoured as goddesses or devis. Some trees, such as the peepal and the banyan, are deeply respected. Animals like the cow are also worshipped.

This belief teaches that the whole of Nature is divine and filled with life. Everything around us is connected and deserves care and respect. That is why the Earth itself is considered sacred and lovingly called Bhudevi, meaning Mother Earth

Lord Vishnu in the form of his boar avatar crushes a demon and saves Bhudevi (Mother Earth)

BECOMING AWARE OF SACRED GEOGRAPHY

When we look at India as a whole, we see that sacred places are spread across distant parts of the country. Yet, these holy sites are meaningfully connected. For example, when Hindus go on the Char Dham Yatra, they visit four sacred places in the north, south, east and west, symbolically covering the entire nation. In the same way, the 12 Jyotirlingas of Lord Shiva — which means 'pillar of light' — are located in different regions but are equally respected. The 51 Shakti Pithas, dedicated to Goddess Shakti, are also spread across India, with a few in present-day Bangladesh and Pakistan.

There are also smaller pilgrimage routes within different regions. Because of this wide network of sacred places, the whole land of India is seen as holy.

There is an interesting legend about the 51 Shakti Pithas. It is said that Sati, the divine mother and wife of Lord Shiva, was deeply insulted by her father. Filled with sorrow and anger, she gave up her life. Lord Shiva was heartbroken and did not perform her last rites. Fearing that his grief and anger could destroy the universe, Lord Vishnu used his divine discus or chakra, to cut Sati's body into pieces. Wherever her body parts fell, those places became sacred Shakti Pithas. This story shows the entire land as the body of the Divine Mother, and therefore, every part of it is equally sacred.

Religious places in India

When pilgrims travel to different holy places of their faith, they journey across the length and breadth of India. Along the way, they see different languages, clothes, foods and customs. At the same time, they also discover common values and traditions that unite people beyond regional differences.

Why did people travel such long distances? There were several reasons:

- People travelled for religious devotion and spiritual peace.
- Traders and merchants used these routes to buy and sell

Go Further

Some Shakti Pithas are not in India today? A few are in present-day Bangladesh and Pakistan. This shows that sacred places don't just follow modern borders. Long ago, pilgrims traveled far and wide, crossing rivers and mountains, to visit these holy sites. Their journeys helped people share ideas, stories and culture, making the whole land feel connected and special.

goods.

- Scholars and thinkers travelled to share ideas, hold discussions, and spread their teachings. Even though their reasons were different, their routes often crossed. They exchanged goods, stories and experiences. They discussed religion, philosophy, and culture. Over time, new ideas were formed and old ideas changed. This steady movement of people and thoughts helped create a strong feeling of cultural unity across the Indian subcontinent.

SACRED ECOLOGY

Many tirthas are located near rivers, lakes, forests or mountains. This shows that nature itself is seen as sacred or a holy place. This belief has encouraged people to love, respect and protect the environment. In Indian tradition, land, culture and faith come together in these special places.

Rivers and Sangams (Confluences of Rivers)

Rivers in India have been respected and worshipped since Vedic times. In the Rigveda, the Nadistuti Sukta hymn praises nineteen sacred rivers of north-west India.

These rivers are not just streams of water. They have been the lifelines of Indian civilisation, giving people water to drink, land to farm and routes to travel. Their sources, smaller rivers that join them and the towns along their banks are all seen as holy. During Hindu prayers, a few drops of water are sprinkled and the names of important rivers are spoken with respect:

"gange cha yamune chaiva godavari sarasvati narmade sindhu kaveri jale'smin sannidhim kuru"

This means: "O Ganga, Yamuna, Godavari, Sarasvati, Narmada, Sindhu, and Kaveri, please be present in this water."

Large numbers of pilgrims visit famous riverbanks. People lovingly call the Ganga "Ganga ji" and the Yamuna "Yamuna ji" to show their deep respect.

The latest Kumbh Mela was held in January–February 2025 at Prayagraj. Taking a holy dip here is believed to be very special because Prayagraj stands at the meeting point (sangam) of three sacred rivers — Ganga, Yamuna, and Sarasvati (which is now invisible).This year, the snana (holy bath) was considered extra auspicious due to a rare alignment of the Sun, Moon, Jupiter, and Saturn — an event that happens only once in 144 years. It is estimated that more than 660 million people from India and many other countries attended the 2025 Kumbh Mela. The arrangements covered nearly 40 kilometres and included about 1,50,000 tents. It is not surprising that UNESCO has recognised the Kumbh Mela as an 'Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity'.

MOUNTAINS AND FORESTS

Mount Kailash

Mountains around the world are connected with gods, stories and brave heroes. Because they rise high into the sky, people often see them as steps leading to heaven. That is why many Indian temples and shrines are built on hilltops. Climbing up to these places can take time and effort, and it challenges both the body and the mind. This hard climb stands for the long and difficult path a soul takes to reach the divine. Today, many of these holy places are easier to visit because of improved roads and better transport facilities.

TREES, FORESTS AND SACRED GROVES

Trees are worshipped in many parts of India. During rituals, people apply turmeric and kumkum to them as a mark of respect. Sacred groves — small patches of forest protected for religious reasons — can still be seen in different regions. One important sacred tree is the peepal or pipal, also known as the 'bo' or 'bodhi' tree ('asvattha' in Sanskrit). Its scientific name is Ficus religiosa, which means 'the religious fig tree.' It is regarded as holy in Hinduism, Buddhism, Sikhism, and Jainism.

The Mahabharata and the Ramayana describe many sacred journeys, rivers, forests and mountains. These great epics speak about long travels across the land and visits to holy natural places. In almost every part of India, local stories say that the main characters of these epics once visited their region. To remember these events, people built temples and shrines there, turning simple places into sacred sites. Whether true or symbolic, these stories helped communities feel connected to the epics.

Many rural and tribal communities protect their forests from hunting, tree cutting and mining. They call these areas 'sacred groves' because they believe local deities live there. In Meghalaya, for example, the Mawphlang sacred grove near Shillong is linked to the guardian spirit Ryngkew or Basa. Such sacred forest areas have different local names across India. They are rich in plants and animals and help protect water sources. In the past, thousands of sacred groves existed in India. Today, due to population growth and land use, their numbers have reduced. Even so, many sacred groves are still carefully protected across the country.

Across India, sacred groves are known by different local names that show the variety of languages and traditions. In Malayalam, they are called kavu; in Tamil, kovilkadu; in Kannada, devare kadu; and in Marathi, devrai. Among the Khasi people of Meghalaya, they are known as khlaw kyntang. In Hindi-speaking Himachal Pradesh, they are called dev van. In Jharkhand, the name is sarna; in

Kavu in Kerala

Oran in Rajasthan

India's sacred groves

Chhattisgarh, devgudi; and in Rajasthan, they are called oran. An old record from Thanjavur district in Tamil Nadu explains how the deity of a sacred grove, nature and people live in harmony. It says that the gods of the grove protect fruit bats because they are seen as lucky. When bats fly freely, they help in pollination and spreading seeds. In this way, a healthy and peaceful balance is maintained in the grove.

In-Text Questions

1. Why do you think rivers like the Ganga and Yamuna are called 'ji' by people? What does this tell us about how humans connect with nature?
2. If you were asked to protect a small forest near your village like a sacred grove, what rules would you make to keep it safe?
3. How do climbing mountains to visit hilltop temples teach people lessons about patience and effort in life?

From pilgrimage to trade

Pilgrimages were not only about religion; they were also linked to social and economic life. During their journeys, pilgrims often met traders and merchants. This helped both groups. Pilgrims needed food, clothes and other daily items, which traders supplied. In return, traders found many buyers for their goods. As a result, many pilgrimage paths were the same as trade routes. This made travel easier, better organised and safer. Some trader-pilgrims sold their goods at holy places and also offered prayers at temples and shrines.

In ancient India, two major trade routes were the Uttarapatha, which linked the north-west to the eastern parts of the subcontinent, and the Daksinapatha, which passed from Kaushambi through Ujjain and ended at Pratisthana (Paithan).

Many valuable goods such as shells, pearls, coins, gold, diamonds, cotton, spices and sandalwood were traded along these routes. In this way, India's spiritual journeys and economic activities were closely connected.

SACRED GEOGRAPHY BEYOND INDIA

The idea of sacred geography is not limited to India. In ancient Greece, people worshipped mountains, rivers and forest groves. Many Native American communities also treat nature as holy and worthy of deep respect.

The Maori, the indigenous people of New Zealand, believe that Mount Taranaki is a sacred ancestor. They fought a long legal case to have the mountain recognised as a living legal being with its own rights and duties. This step introduced the world to the Maori way of thinking. In their tradition, community elders speak on behalf of a mountain or river to protect it from harm. By treating parts of nature as sacred, many communities around the world have helped to protect and preserve their environment.

Restoring and Conserving the Sacred

For thousands of years in India, people lived in harmony with their sacred geography. This close bond helped great civilisations grow and shaped shared values across the land. Mountains, rivers, forests and sacred groves were carefully protected, keeping the environment clean and healthy.

Today, this balance is under stress. Rivers are overused and polluted, mountains are harmed by too much mining and construction, and forests are shrinking or suffering because of heavy tourism. Yet, many people are raising their voices to protect their sacred landscapes, traditions and deities.

At a time when sustainability and environmental care are major global concerns, the idea of sacred geography gives us hope. If we treat the Earth as sacred, we can create a future that respects nature while also meeting human needs.

In-Text Questions

1. Why are fruit bats considered important in some sacred groves of India?
2. How did the legal recognition of Mount Taranaki in New Zealand help protect the environment?

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Pilgrimage:** A religious journey to a sacred place.
- **Shrine:** A holy place linked to the divine, a relic or a spiritual figure.
- **Relic:** A saint's body parts or belongings, kept and revered as sacred.
- **Sustainability:** The practice of meeting present needs without compromising future requirements.

QUICK TAKE

- Sacred places are found all over India in every religion. In Buddhism, Jainism and Sikhism, important sites honour teachers like the Buddha, the Tirthankaras, and the Sikh Gurus.
- Hinduism has a large network of pilgrimage that connect people across the country, such as the Char Dhams, the 12 Jyotirlingas and the 51 Shakti Peethas, bringing together faith, culture and trade.
- In Hindu, tribal and folk traditions, rivers, hills, forests, certain stones and animals are seen as part of a sacred landscape.
- Pilgrimage routes and festivals help people meet, share and work together, promoting charity, service and cultural exchange.
- The idea of sacred geography is found worldwide, seen in the cultures of Ancient Greece, Native Americans and New Zealand's Maori.
- Caring for sacred places can help protect the environment and promote sustainability for future generations.

EXERCISES

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which place is not a pilgrimage site?
   (a) Ajmer Sharif Dargah ☐ (b) Mahabodhi Temple ☐
   (c) Sanchi Stupa ☐ (d) Mumbai Stock Exchange ☐
2. What does pilgrimage teach people?
   (a) Cooking skills ☐ (b) Self-control and patience ☐
   (c) Farming techniques ☐ (d) Singing songs ☐
3. What does 'sacredness' mean?
   (a) Ordinary daily activity ☐ (b) Only prayer ☐
   (c) Connected to the divine ☐ (d) Something expensive ☐
4. Which is an Indian sacred site?
   (a) Ajmer Sharif Dargah ☐ (b) Eiffel Tower ☐
   (c) Sydney Opera House ☐ (d) London Bridge ☐
5. Which route connected north-west India?
   (a) Uttarapatha ☐ (b) Daksinapatha ☐
   (c) Silk Road ☐ (d) Grand Trunk Road ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. Jainism has pilgrimage sites connected with Tirthankaras. ☐
2. Pilgrimages are only short trips to nearby holy places. ☐
3. Mountains, rivers and trees are sometimes treated as sacred. ☐
4. Pilgrims always travel using vehicles and never on foot. ☐
5. Sacred groves are small forests protected for religious reasons. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Velankanni	A. sacred site where Buddha attained enlightenment
2. Mahabodhi Temple	B. church visited by people of many faiths
3. Akal Takht	C. devoted to God Ayyappa,
4. Sabarimala	D. centre of Sikh spiritual authority
5. Uttarapatha	E. northern trade route connecting the northwest to the east

(a) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C, 4-D, 5-E (b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C, 5-E
(c) 1-C, 2-E, 3-A, 4-B, 5-D (d) 1-D, 2-B, 3-E, 4-A, 5-C

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : People walk long distances on pilgrimages to purify their mind and heart.
   Reason (R) : Pilgrimages involve strict rules, fasting and devotion as part of the journey.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Sacred groves are protected by local communities in India.
   Reason (R) : People believe local deities live in these forests, so they prevent hunting and tree cutting.
3. **Assertion (A)** : Sacred geography in India connects people beyond regional differences.
   Reason (R) : Pilgrims traveling across India experience different languages, foods and customs.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Ancient pilgrimage routes also promoted trade and cultural exchange.
   Reason (R) : Traders and pilgrims used the same routes, exchanging goods and ideas along the way.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

1. Identify the sacred feature in this photo and name the rivers.
2. State one reason this place attracts pilgrims.

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. How can a place or thing be sacred even if it is not about religion?
2. Tell the story of how the Shakti Pithas became holy places.
3. Why do people of different faiths visit the same holy sites?
4. How do rivers make places in India sacred and special?
5. How do sacred forests or groves help protect nature?

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. How do sacred places in India connect different regions? How can this idea teach us to respect people and nature today?
2. How did the land of India become sacred? What does this show us about faith, unity, and caring for others?
3. Why is the Kumbh Mela special? What is the story behind this holy gathering?
4. Rivers like Ganga and Yamuna are sacred. How does this belief help people respect both religion and the environment?

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

Pilgrimage

"For more than 3,000 years, people in India have been going on tirthayatras or pilgrimages, to holy places called tirthas across the subcontinent. Because of this long tradition, almost every region of the subcontinent is seen as sacred today. Devotees often travel on foot for many days, crossing rivers, fields, forests and even high mountains. A pilgrimage is not just a simple visit to a place. It is a special journey taken to purify the mind and heart. During these journeys, pilgrims follow strict rules and self-discipline. They may fast, chant prayers, avoid comforts or walk barefoot as a sign of devotion and faith."

(a) According to the source, why is almost every region of India considered sacred?

(b) What are some ways pilgrims show devotion and follow self-discipline during their journeys?

(c) How do long and challenging journeys help in making the land sacred, as described in the text?

VI. PROJECT WORK

Make drawings, posters or digital art of sacred trees (peepal, banyan), rivers (Ganga, Yamuna) or mountains. Add short captions explaining why they are respected.

THEME–D

Governance and Democracy

This theme helps students understand how societies are organised and how decisions are made for the common good. It introduces different systems through which countries are governed and highlights the values that support a fair and responsible society. Learners explore the importance of participation, equality, justice, rights, and responsibilities in everyday life. They also develop an understanding of the guiding principles that shape the functioning of the nation and protect the interests of all citizens. Through discussions, activities, and real-life examples, students build awareness of democratic values, active citizenship, and the role each individual plays in strengthening a peaceful, inclusive, and responsible society.

9 From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

Let's Learn About

- What a government is and what it does for the country.
- Different kinds of democratic governments around the world.
- Identify other forms of government, their differences and how they work.
- Why democracy is important for people and society.

Let's Gear Up

Who will plan the Children's Day?

It was a sunny Saturday morning. Rhea was helping her younger brother Arjun with his homework.

Arjun sighed. "Rhea, our class has to plan a fun activity for Children's Day, but everyone wants something different. Some want a quiz, some a dance show and others want games. It's so confusing."

Rhea smiled. "That's like how a government works. People have many opinions, but we can't all decide at once. What do you think the class should do?"

Arjun thought. "Maybe we can vote?"

"Exactly!" said Rhea. "Voting is a way to make fair decisions. Everyone's voice is counted."

On Monday, the class held a small election. The games and fun stalls plan won. Arjun ran to Rhea. "It worked! Everyone is happy."

Rhea nodded. "See! Democracy means fairness, even in a classroom."

WHAT IS A GOVERNMENT ? WHAT ARE ITS FUNCTIONS?

A government is a group of people chosen to run and manage a country or state. It makes rules and decisions for the people and ensures that these rules are followed. Governments usually have different branches such as the legislative, executive and judicial, which perform different duties.

Governments have many important duties, such as:

- Keeping law, order and safety in the country.

Go Further

Observe your neighbourhood. List at least five activities carried out by the government. Share and discuss your answers in class.

- Providing basic public services (schools, hospitals, roads).
- Supporting economic growth and protecting people's rights.
- Making laws for the country.
- Settling conflicts through courts.
- Handling the country's money and spending responsibly.

Maintaining peace and security

Providing electricity

Building infrastructure

India is a democracy. Like India, many other countries also have democratic governments. However, some countries follow different forms of government. In this chapter, we will learn about various types of governments, understand how they are different and see how they work.

WHAT IS DEMOCRACY?

Democracy is a type of government in which people choose their representatives to make decisions, policies and laws according to the Constitution. The word democracy comes from the Greek word demokratia, where demos means 'people' and kratos means 'rule'. It literally means 'rule by the people'.

'Government' Mural by Elihu Vedder.

Abraham Lincoln, the former President of the United States, described democracy as "government of the people, by the people, for the people." This means the government is formed by the people, elected by the people and works for the welfare of everyone. This well-known idea is still used to explain democracy.

Analyze Thoughts

Choose any five countries that share borders with India and write the type of government each country follows.

In-Text Questions

1. In a democracy, citizens choose their _____ to make laws and decisions for the country.
2. The government provides public services such as schools, hospitals and _____ for the people.

FUNCTIONS OF GOVERNMENT

The main roles of a government can be divided into three parts: the legislative, the executive and the judicial. The legislature makes the laws, the executive carries out and enforces them and the judiciary explains the laws and settles disputes.

WHAT MAKES GOVERNMENTS DIFFERENT?

The government of a country develops and changes over time. Governments are different from each other in many ways, such as their structure, how power is shared, how they are formed and how they are answerable to the people. These differences come from different ideas about the role of government, the amount of power given to its branches and how much citizens take part in governing.

Key Areas of Differences

- **Who gives power and authority to the government?**

  One of the most important differences between types of governments is who gives them their power. In a democracy such as India, power comes from the people, who choose their leaders through elections. The government therefore gets its authority from the will of the citizens. In a theocracy, authority comes from religious leaders or religious laws. Thus, different systems of government depend on different sources of power and approval.

- **How is the government formed?**

  In a democracy, governments are usually formed through elections. During elections, people vote to select their representatives, who then form the government. In contrast, in a monarchy where a king or queen rules, the ruler normally belongs to a royal family and decides how the government will work. Apart from these, governments can be formed in other ways too. Even among democracies, the ways of conducting elections and forming governments may differ.

- **What are the different parts of the government and their roles?**

  Governments have different parts and systems, which change according to the type of government. The three main functions of government—the legislature, the executive and the judiciary—may be carried out by separate independent bodies or sometimes by the same authority. In most democracies, the working of the government is guided by a written set of basic rules called the Constitution. In monarchies, however, where a king or queen holds power, many key decisions are taken by the monarch.

- **Why are governments created?**

  Governments are formed to protect certain values and ideas. Some governments are organised to promote equality and the welfare of all citizens, while others may mainly serve the interests of certain families or groups. The goals of a government usually reflect the ideas and principles on which it is built.

Governments around the world differ in many ways. The most common differences depend on four main aspects: how leaders are chosen, how power is shared, how

In countries with the same type of government, the way people vote or the rules leaders follow can be very different. For example, elections in India use electronic voting machines, while in some countries, people still vote on paper or even by raising hands.

decisions are made and who holds authority. There are also many other ways in which governments may vary. These differences reflect the unique history, culture and values of each society. Let us now explore the different types or forms of government that exist.

DEMOCRATIC GOVERNMENTS AROUND THE WORLD

In today's world, democracy is the most widely followed form of government. However, there are many other forms of government that include democratic ideas or principles. Before understanding the differences, let us look at some basic principles of democracy.

- Freedom: Citizens have the right to express their views and make their own choices.
- Universal Adult Franchise (UAF): Every citizen above a certain age has the right to vote and choose their representatives.
- Equality: All people have the right to be treated fairly. It also means equal access to education, health care and justice.
- Fundamental Rights: Citizens are given basic rights such as the right to equality, the right to freedom of speech and expression and the right against exploitation. These rights are protected by law.
- Independent Judiciary: This ensures that the rights of all citizens are protected and that laws are followed by the people as well as by all parts of the government.
- Representative Participation: Every citizen has the right to take part in choosing their leaders. This happens through elections, where the elected representatives become members of the legislature.

In-Text Questions

1. How might a video game simulate the roles of the legislature, executive and judiciary?
2. If a country suddenly removed all elections, which principles of democracy would be most affected?
3. How could a smartphone app help citizens participate more actively in government decisions?

It is important to understand that the basic principles of democracy have developed and changed over time in different countries and cultures. For example, India gave the right to vote to all adults when it became a republic in 1950. In Switzerland, women received the right to vote only in 1971. In South Africa, racial discrimination under Apartheid denied democratic rights to most of the population until 1994.

These examples show that democratic principles have grown through long struggles and continuous efforts by the people.

Different Forms of Democratic Governments

There are many democratic countries in the world and each follows its own rules and ways of working. The two most common types of democracy are direct democracy and representative democracy.

Direct Democracy

Direct democracy is a type of government where people choose their leaders themselves, without using representatives. Citizens also vote directly on laws and policies. For example, Switzerland follows direct democracy. However, it can be hard to practise because it needs a large number of people to take part and stay involved.

Representative Democracy

Representative democracy is a type of government where people elect leaders to make decisions for them. Citizens vote for representatives, who then speak and act on behalf of the people in the government. For example, United States and India are representative democracies. People choose representatives to decide on laws, policies and important matters for the country.

Representative democracy is often more practical because it does not need everyone to take part all the time. It also allows knowledgeable leaders to be elected, who can make better decisions for the people. Most modern countries follow this system. However, each country runs its democracy differently. There are two main types of representative democracy: Parliamentary and Presidential.

- Parliamentary Democracy: In this system, the executive branch, usually led by a prime minister, is part of the legislature and must answer to it. For example, India has a Parliamentary democracy. The executive, headed by the Prime Minister, comes from the Parliament and stays in office as long as the legislature supports it. The Parliament has two houses: the Lok Sabha (House of the People) and the Rajya Sabha (Council of States). The Prime Minister and Council of Ministers are responsible to the legislature. In this system, citizens vote for representatives in Parliament. The party with the most seats forms the government, and its leader becomes the Prime Minister, who runs the government, while the President acts as the ceremonial head of the state. Countries like India, United Kingdom, and Canada use parliamentary democracy.
- Presidential Democracy: In this system, the executive works independently of the legislature. The President is both the head of the state and the executive. The President does not need the legislature's support to stay in office. United States, Brazil and South Korea are examples of presidential democracies.

  In some countries like India, individual states such as Rajasthan or Kerala have their own governments. However, these state governments are not fully independent and operate under the larger framework of the National or Union Government.

Analyze Thoughts

Representative democracy shows how people can share power without making every decision themselves. It balances public choice and expert leadership. But it also makes us think: what if elected leaders don't listen to the people? This is why citizens must stay aware, vote wisely and hold leaders accountable.

What Do These Terms Mean?

The new Indian Parliament building, Sansad Bhavan

In a democratic country like India, power is shared among three main parts or branches of government: the Legislature, the Executive, and the Judiciary. These branches work together to make laws, enforce them and ensure justice.

- Executive: The executive branch carries out the laws made by the legislature. It includes the head of state (the president) and the head of government (the prime minister), the cabinet and various government departments and agencies.
- Legislature: This branch makes the laws through a legislative body. In India, it is called the Parliament, and in the United States, it is called Congress. Most legislatures have two houses: an Upper House and a Lower House.
- Upper House and Lower House: The Parliament of India has two houses: the Lok Sabha (House of the People), which is the Lower House, and the Rajya Sabha (Council of States), which is the Upper House. Both houses work together to pass laws and govern the country.
- Judiciary: The judiciary explains and interprets laws, settles disputes and ensures laws are applied fairly. It includes all courts, from local courts to the highest court in the country.
- Separation of Powers: Separation of powers is an important rule in a democracy. It divides government power among the legislative, executive and judicial branches. This prevents any one branch from becoming too strong and keeps a balance of power.

A PEEK INTO HISTORY

Early Republics

A republic is a type of government where the head of state is elected and not a king or queen who inherits the position. In a republic, power belongs to the people, usually through elected representatives. This means people have a direct say in choosing their leaders and deciding how they are governed.

In ancient India, early republics existed in some states, especially in the mahajanapadas. For example, the Vajji (or Vriji) mahajanapada was run by the Lichchhavi clan, who made decisions together and elected leaders based on merit. These states were called early republics because important positions were filled through elections and representatives from different clans met to solve problems and take care of the people's welfare.

Another example is the Uttaramerur inscription from the 10th century CE in Tamil Nadu. It shows a system of local self-governance where the village assembly (sabha) had real power. The inscription explains how committees were formed, members were chosen through a lottery and the duties and limits of those in charge. It shows how strong and decentralized the Chola

administration was, allowing people's voices to be heard without the king controlling everything directly.

Early republics also existed in other parts of the world. In the 5th and 4th centuries BCE, both Rome and Greece had forms of republican government. In some Greek regions, only free men could vote, while women, labourers and slaves were excluded. In other areas, decision-making was done by a small, elite group of people.

Uttaramerur Inscription

In-Text Questions

1. If you were designing a school council, how could you use the idea of separation of powers to make it fair?
2. How might an ancient village assembly like the one in Tamil Nadu decide who gets to lead today?
3. Why do you think early republics like Rome or Vajji avoided giving everyone the right to vote?

OTHER FORMS OF GOVERNMENT

Monarchy

The mahajanapadas were mostly ruled by kings, who often took advice from the Sabha or Samiti whose guidance was important for decisions. As empires grew in India, kings gained more power. Still, they relied on councils of ministers and networks of officials to run the administration. Kings also consulted learned scholars for guidance on matters of dharma. However, some rulers misused their power and treated the people unfairly.

Early monarchies, where one ruler—a king, queen or emperor—had supreme power, were common in many civilizations. In some cultures, monarchs claimed they had divine powers given by God.

In many parts of ancient India, though kings held power, their authority was limited by dharma. Dharma, which included moral and ethical duties, was seen as the base of a just and prosperous kingdom. Kings were expected to follow dharma and act as stewards of the people, not simply rule with complete power. They had moral and ethical responsibilities toward their citizens.

In the Shanti Parva of the Mahabharata, Bhishma, on his deathbed, taught Yudhishthira lessons about ruling, dharma and the importance of compassion and protection for the people. He said a king's main duty is to safeguard his citizens and ensure their well-being while keeping order and righteousness. Bhishma also highlighted that sometimes a ruler might need to act with adharma (wrong) to uphold dharma (right).

Monarchies Today

A monarchy is a type of government where the head of state, the monarch—usually a king or queen—has supreme power, often for life, and the position is normally inherited.

Monarchies are of two main types:

- Absolute Monarchy: In an absolute monarchy, the monarch has full control over making laws, enforcing them and deciding punishments. For example, Saudi Arabia follows this system, where the king holds all authority and rules according to Islamic law. He may appoint a council to advise him, but he does not have to follow their suggestions.
- Constitutional Monarchy: In a constitutional monarchy, the king or queen is the head of state but has only limited or symbolic power. For example, the United Kingdom has a monarch, but real power belongs to the Parliament and the Prime Minister. Laws are made by the elected Parliament, and executive powers are exercised by the Council of Ministers led by the Prime Minister. This system is both a parliamentary democracy and a constitutional monarchy.

Theocracy

A theocracy is a form of government in which religious leaders rule the country and religious laws guide the system of governance. In such a system, political authority is closely connected with religion. Leaders are believed to rule according to the will or guidance of God, and laws are often based on sacred religious texts and traditions. Religious scholars or clerics may have an important role in interpreting these texts and advising the government.

In a theocracy, religion strongly influences public life, laws and decision-making. Citizens are usually expected to follow the religious rules that guide the state. The government may regulate social behaviour, education and justice according to religious principles.

Do you know?

The word 'theocracy' comes from the Greek words 'theos' (God) and 'kratos' (power or rule). It literally means 'rule by God.' In a theocratic system, leaders believe they govern according to divine guidance and many laws are based on religious teachings and sacred texts. This shows how closely religion and government can be connected in such systems.

Dictatorship

A dictatorship is a type of government where one person or a small group has complete control, without being limited by laws or a constitution. In the 20th century, many dictators came to power, creating harsh and unfair conditions for their people.

In 1933, shortly after Adolf Hitler became Chancellor of Germany, he passed laws giving himself total control and removing all opposition. This started his dictatorship. Believing his race was superior, Hitler wanted Germany to dominate the world and considered other races, especially Jews, to be inferior. He was

Adolf Hitler

Idi Amin

responsible for the deaths of at least six million Jews in the Holocaust, along with hundreds of thousands of Roma and other minority groups. His aggressive policies also caused World War II (1939–1945), bringing massive destruction and loss of life.

Idi Amin was a military officer who became the dictator of Uganda from 1971 to 1979. Thousands of people were killed under his rule, and many Indians, whose families had lived in Uganda for generations, were forced to leave the country.

The Roma, or Romani people, were originally a nomadic group. Scholars traced their origins to India based on language and culture. They first settled in eastern Europe and later moved to other countries worldwide.

Oligarchy

The word oligarchy comes from the Greek words oligos, meaning 'a few,' and archo, meaning 'to rule.' An oligarchy is a government where a small, powerful group makes the main decisions. This group usually includes rich or influential people. Even today, some democracies show signs of oligarchy, where a few politicians or business leaders have too much influence over the government.

WHY DEMOCRACY MATTERS

These examples show that democracy is not the only type of government, but it is often seen as the best. Democracy encourages equality, respects individual dignity and allows conflicts to be solved peacefully. It also makes leaders accountable, which is why many countries follow it. However, democracy faces challenges such as corruption, inequality and lack of education, which can reduce public trust and weaken its institutions. Citizens play an important role in solving these problems by voting, taking part in community activities, standing up for their rights and keeping the government responsible for its actions.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- Accountability: When a government answers to the people for its actions.
- Oppresion: To treat people unfairly, cruelly or without justice.
- Political Commentator: People who share their views and explain what is happening in politics and government.
- Representative: A person elected to make decisions and act for other people.
- Theocracy: A government run by religious leaders and religious laws.
- Apartheid: A system that treats people unfairly because of their race.

QUICK TAKE

- Governments keep law and order, offer public services, support the economy and safeguard people's rights.
- Democracy is a government system where citizens choose representatives to create laws and make decisions.
- The three main parts of government are: legislature (creates laws), executive (carries out laws) and judiciary (explains laws and settles disagreements).

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. What is a government's main role?
   (a) To cook food for citizens ☐ (b) To manage the country and make rules ☐
   (c) To entertain people with shows ☐ (d) To build only tall buildings ☐
2. Democracy means rule by whom?
   (a) By king or queen only ☐ (b) By religious leaders ☐
   (c) By the people ☐ (d) By military generals ☐
3. Theocracy is ruled by whom?
   (a) Elected representatives (b) ☐ Religious leaders ☐
   (c) Military generals ☐ (d) Business leaders ☐
4. Fundamental rights protect citizens' what?
   (a) Only money ☐ (b) Buildings ☐
   (c) Pets and property ☐ (d) Basic freedoms ☐
5. In a parliamentary democracy, the executive comes from where?
   (a) Judiciary ☐ (b) Parliament ☐
   (c) Monarch ☐ (d) Army ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. Constitutional monarchs have limited or symbolic power. ☐
2. Democracy encourages equality and individual dignity. ☐
3. Oligarchy is ruled by a single citizen. ☐
4. In parliamentary democracy, the Prime Minister answers to Parliament. ☐
5. Theocracy is guided by religious leaders and laws. ☐

C. Fill in the blanks.

1. In an oligarchy, power is held by a _____ group of people.
2. In a constitutional monarchy, the monarch has only _____ or symbolic power.

3. In a parliamentary democracy, the executive is led by the _____ who comes from the legislature.
4. An absolute monarchy gives the ruler _____ control over law-making, enforcement, and punishment.
5. The Greek word for democracy, 'demokratia,' literally means '_____ by the people.'

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. Assertion (A) : In a democracy, citizens have the right to vote and choose their representatives.
   Reason (R) : The government in a democracy gets its authority from the people.
2. Assertion (A) : Absolute monarchs have full control over laws and decisions.
   Reason (R) : Constitutional monarchs have limited power and the real government is run by elected representatives.
3. Assertion (A) : A dictatorship allows citizens to participate in decision-making freely.
   Reason (R) : Dictators or a small group has complete control without following laws or the constitution.
4. Assertion (A) : Direct democracy is difficult to practise in large countries.
   Reason (R) : In direct democracy, citizens vote directly on laws and policies.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the image and answer the questions that follow.
The scene of Bhishma's final teachings is often called the 'Shanti Parva.' What quality of a good ruler does this moment highlight?

(a) The need for strict punishment and control. ☐
(b) The importance of humility, fairness and responsibility. ☐
(c) The use of force to maintain obedience. ☐
(d) The belief that kings are above the law. ☐

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Name the three parts of a government and explain what each part does.
2. "Democracy is better than Monarchy or Dictatorship." Explain why this is true.
3. What does democracy mean? Write any two important features of democracy.
4. Explain the difference between direct democracy and representative democracy. Give one example of each.

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Explain any five important rules or principles that make a democracy work.
2. Describe monarchy and dictatorship in detail, and give examples of countries for each.
3. How is a parliamentary democracy different from a presidential democracy? Explain clearly.
4. Why are governments not the same in every country? Explain with five points of difference.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

A theocracy is a form of government in which religious leaders rule the country and religious laws guide the system of governance. In such a system, political authority is closely connected with religion. Leaders are believed to rule according to the will or guidance of God, and laws are often based on sacred religious texts and traditions. Religious scholars or clerics may have an important role in interpreting these texts and advising the government.

In a theocracy, religion strongly influences public life, laws, and decision-making. Citizens are usually expected to follow the religious rules that guide the state. The government may regulate social behaviour, education, and justice according to religious principles.

1. What is a theocracy?
2. Who plays an important role in interpreting religious texts in a theocracy?
3. How does religion influence the government and public life in a theocracy?
4. On what are the laws of theocratic government often based?

VI. PROJECT WORK

"Mini World Parliaments" - Experiencing Forms of Government

I. Objective:

- To understand how different forms of government work and how they affect decision-making and fairness.

II. Tasks:

- Divide the class into five groups; Democracy, Monarchy, Dictatorship, Theocracy and Oligarchy.
- Give each group a classroom issue to decide (for example, new class rules).
- Each group role-plays how decisions are made in its system.
- After the role-play, discuss which system felt most fair and which gave people the least voice.
- Compare and Discuss:
  - Which system felt the most fair and participatory?
  - In which system did decisions happen fastest?
  - Which system gave the least voice to ordinary people?
  - Why do you think democracy is preferred today?

III. Expected Learning Outcome:

By the end of this activity, you will:

- Understand how power and participation differ in each system.
- Recognise why democracy values equality and freedom.

10 The Constitution of India- An Introduction

Let's Learn About

- What a constitution means and why it is important for a country?
- How the Constitution of India was written and prepared?
- How the freedom struggle and India's rich heritage influenced the constitution?
- The main features of the Constitution of India.
- Why the Indian Constitution is still important in our lives today?

Let's Gear Up

The Glass Case in Parliament

During a family trip to Delhi, Aarav and Meera visited the Parliament Museum. In one hall, they stopped in awe at a large glass case glowing under soft lights.

Meera: "Wow... is that really the Constitution of India?"

Aarav: "Yes, it looks amazing. But why is it kept inside this special glass?"

Meera: "The guide said it is filled with helium gas so the ink and paper stay safe. It must be very important."

They leaned closer to see the delicate writing and colourful illustrations. The pages showed scenes from India's history, from ancient times to the struggle for independence.

Aarav: "It's like a treasure chest of our country. But it's not just for looking at. These words are the rules that guide how India is run."

Meera: "So it's more than history. It's alive, because leaders and judges still follow it every day."

As they moved on, Aarav and Meera realised that the Constitution was not just a book locked in glass. It is the living guide that keeps India's democracy strong, fair and just for everyone.

WHAT IS A CONSTITUTION?

A constitution is a set of basic rules that explains how a country or organisation is run. It describes:

- The structure of the three main parts of government—legislature, executive and judiciary—and their duties and responsibilities.
- How these three parts check and balance each other to ensure fairness, accountability and responsible governance.
- The rights and responsibilities that all citizens must follow.

★ A general plan of the nation's long-term goals and hopes for the future.

The original copies of the Constitution of India are kept in special helium-filled cases in the library of the Parliament of India

Go Further

Search the internet and find out who is called the "Father of the Indian Constitution". What role did he play in framing the Constitution of India?

Why Do We Need a Constitution?

A constitution is like a guidebook for a country. It has the basic rules and ideas that explain what type of government a nation will have, how it is formed and how it works. It shows how the legislature, executive and judiciary are organised and how they perform their duties.

The constitution also explains how laws are made and followed, how leaders in the executive are chosen, how the judiciary works, and what rights and responsibilities citizens have. Many constitutions, including India's, reflect the country's values and ideals, such as equality, justice, brotherhood, diversity and freedom. These values are the foundation on which all laws and rules of the Constitution are built.

Some of the important elements commonly included in most constitutions are:

THE CONSTITUTION

Framework of Government

- **Legislature :** Makes laws.
- **Executive :** Implements laws.
- **Judiciary :** Interprets laws.

Checks and Balances

- Ensures fairness.
- Promotes responsibility.
- Maintains accountability (Each organ of the government keeps a check on the others.)

Rights and Duties of Citizens

- Fundamental Rights (e.g. Right to Equality, Right to Freedom, etc.).
- Fundamental Duties (e.g. Respect the Constitution, national symbols, etc.).

National Vision

- Long-term goals and aspirations.
- Guiding principles for the nation's development and unity.

Analyze Thoughts

Work with a partner to make a 'Value Tree' collage that shows why a constitution is needed. Draw or cut out a big tree on a poster board. Together, add paper leaves to the tree, with each leaf showing a different value, rule or reason why the Indian Constitution is important.

WRITING THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

A few Drafting Committe members with Dr. B.R. Ambedkar in the center

When India was about to gain independence in 1947, the country faced the big task of creating a system to govern a population with many religions, languages, and cultures. The leaders knew that a strong constitution was needed to unite the nation under common rules and to protect the rights of all citizens.

In 1938, Jawaharlal Nehru said that the Constitution of free India must be written by Indians themselves, without outside influence. Later, an elected Constituent Assembly was given the job of drafting the Constitution. In 1946, this Constituent Assembly was formed to prepare India's Constitution. It first had 389 members, but after Partition, the number reduced to 299. Among them, 15 were women. The members came from different regions jobs and communities, showing the diversity of India.

Go Further

Find out about five members of India's Constituent Assembly and explain the roles they played in preparing and shaping the Constitution.

How Was Our Constitution Developed?

A tableau celebrating 75 years of the Indian Constitution

The Constitution of India was made by the Constituent Assembly, whose members were chosen by provincial assemblies. The Assembly met for the first time on 9 December 1946. It had 299 members who held 11 sessions over almost three years to discuss and write the constitution. The constitution was finally adopted on 26 November 1949 and came into effect on 26 January 1950. That is why we celebrate Republic Day every year.

The Indian Constitution was prepared over 165 days, spread across 11 sessions of the Constituent Assembley

The first draft of the Constitution was prepared by the Drafting Committee, headed by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, a great social reformer and the first Minister of Law and Justice of independent India.

The Original Constitution was handwritten in a flowing italic style by calligrapher Prem Behari Narain Raizada.

In-Text Questions

1. The Constitution of India came into effect on _____, which is celebrated as Republic Day every year.
2. The three main parts of the government mentioned in the Constitution are _____, _____ and _____.

WHAT SHAPED AND INFLUENCED THE INDIAN CONSTITUTION?

The Constitution of India was shaped by a mix of Indian traditions, the freedom movement, colonial experiences and ideas from other countries. Important influences came from the Government of India Act of 1935, the British parliamentary system and the constitutions of France, the United States and Ireland.

Indian Freedom Movement and Indigenous Traditions

The struggle for India's freedom played a big role in shaping the Constitution. Many ideals from the freedom movement, like justice, equality and liberty, were included in the final document. Leaders of the movement, who were also members of the Constituent Assembly, brought their experiences, hopes and ideas for a fair and inclusive nation. This ensured the Constitution reflected the spirit of India's long fight for independence.

Key values like equality, justice, liberty, fraternity and protection of India's culture were included to help build a strong and united nation. The experiences of the freedom movement also guided leaders to answer important questions: How can all adults get the right to vote? How should the three parts of government share power? How should the Constitution be changed if needed? And how should the Central and State governments work together?

India's Civilisational Heritage and History

The idea of India as one united country is strongly reflected in the Constitution. Indian culture also inspired many values in the document, such as respecting different views, caring for nature, valuing education, honouring women and following ideas like vasudhaiva kutumbakam (the world is one family) and sarve bhavantu sukhinah (may all beings be happy). These ideas appear in different forms but are present throughout the Constitution. For example, the Fundamental Duties remind every citizen of their responsibilities to build a peaceful and strong nation.

Learnings from Across the World

The makers also studied the constitutions of countries like France, the USA, the UK, Ireland and Australia. They wanted to see which ideas could work well in India. Some features of our Constitution were inspired by these documents. The ideals of liberty, equality and fraternity actually originated from the French Revolution of 1789 and were formalised in the Declaration of the Rights of Man and the citizen in August 1789. The Directive Principles of State Policy came from Ireland. The Constitution of the USA helped design an independent judiciary that could work without outside influence.

Do you know?

The Constitution of India is one of the longest written constitutions in the world. The Constitution of India was officeally adopted on November 26, 1949. It came into effect on January 26, 1950. It contained 395 Articles and 8 Schedules. The makers of the Constitution carefully studied many other constitutions and India's own traditions to create a system that would suit such a large, diverse and democratic country.

Decoration with Mohenjo-daro seals

Portraits of Shivaji and Guru Gobind Singh

Scene from Ramayana
(Conquest of Lanka and Recovery of Sita by Rama)

Scene of the Himalayas

Illustrations in the Constitution of India, by Nandalal Bose and his team, depict scenes from Indian history, from Mohenjo-daro to the freedom movement

KEY FEATURES OF THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

Before learning about the main features of the Constitution, it is helpful to remember a few ideas studied in Class 6. There are three main organs of government: the legislature the executive, and the judiciary. Keeping their powers separate is important for the smooth and fair functioning of the government. The legislature makes laws. The executive, led by the prime minister, carries out these laws. The judiciary checks that laws follow the Constitution and decides if someone has broken a law and what punishment should be given.

India follows a three-level system of government. These levels are the Central government, the State governments and the Local governments that work through the Panchayati Raj system. Some duties are handled by the Central government, while others belong to the State governments. Each level has its own clear roles and responsibilities.

The Constitution explains all these matters in detail. It clearly defines the roles, duties and limits of each organ of government. It also sets the rules for elections so that every eligible citizen can vote

and take part in democracy.

Some of the most important parts of the Constitution are the Fundamental Rights, the Fundamental Duties and the Directive Principles of State Policy. The Directive Principles describe the social and economic goals that the makers of the Constitution hoped India would achieve.

A Glimpse of important Features		
Fundamental Rights	**Fundamental Duties**	**Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)**
Right to Equality (Article 14, Equality before law and equal protection of laws)	To abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag and the National Anthem;	Article 41: Right to work, to education, and to public assistance in certain cases.
Right to Freedom (Article 21, Protection of life and personal liberty, Article 21A Right to Education)	To defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so;	Article 44: Uniform Civil Code.
Right against Exploitation (Article 24, Prohibition of employment of children in factories, mines or any hazardous work etc.)	To value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture;	Article 38: Social, Political and Economic Justice.
Right to Freedom of Religion (Article 25, Grants every Indian citizen the freedom of conscience and the right to freely profess, practise and propagate their religion)	To protect and improve the natural environment, including forests, lakes, rivers and wildlife, and to have compassion for living creatures;	Article 48-A: Environment and Wildlife Protection.
Cultural and Educational (Rights, Articles 29 and 30).	To strive towards excellence in all spheres of individual and collective activity so that the nation constantly rises to higher levels of endeavour and achievement;	Article 49: Protection of monuments, places and objects of national importance.
Right to Constitutional Remedies, (Article 32).	As a parent or guardian, to provide an opportunity for education to your child/ward between six to fourteen years of age;	Article 47: Nutrition, standard of living, and public health.

The Directive Principles are aims that the government should try to achieve. They show the path the makers of the Constitution wanted the country to follow in order to improve the lives of all people. For example, they hoped that every citizen in India would enjoy a good standard of living. However, if the government is unable to fully achieve these goals, a citizen cannot go to court to complain. The Directive Principles guide the government in making policies and plans, but they are not strict laws.Fundamental Rights, on the other hand, are guarantees that every citizen must receive. These rights protect people from unfair treatment. If someone is treated badly because of their identity, religion, caste or background, they can approach a court for help. The judge can then take action to protect the person's rights and make sure that justice is given.

The makers of our Constitution created this system with a clear idea in mind. They knew that some rights must be given to citizens immediately. These were called Fundamental Rights, which every citizen can claim and protect at once. At the same time, they also wanted the country to work towards bigger goals that would need time, careful planning and development. These were included as the Directive Principles, which guide the Government of India to move forward and achieve greater growth and progress for the nation.

THE CONSTITUTION IS A LIVING DOCUMENT

The makers of the Constitution knew that the needs of the country would change over time. So, they allowed the Constitution to be updated when required. For example, Part IV-A, which includes the Fundamental Duties of citizens, was added in 1976. Any change made to the Constitution is called an amendment. Such changes are discussed carefully in the Parliament before they are accepted. Some amendments also need approval from the state legislative assemblies. In many situations, the opinions of the people are also considered. Sometimes, changes begin through public movements that express the ideas and wishes of citizens.

The government also provides chances for citizens to share their opinions on new laws or suggested changes to existing rules. This allows people to participate in the law-making process and makes sure that their views and ideas are heard and considered.

Go Further

1. The Constitution of India allows amendments so that laws can change with the needs of society and keep the Constitution relevant.
2. Without Fundamental Rights, citizens could face unfair treatment and loss of freedom.
3. The Parliament of India discusses laws carefully to ensure they are fair and beneficial for the people.

UNDERSTANDING THE PREAMBLE: THE GUIDING VALUES OF THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

The Preamble to the Constitution of India is a short introduction that explains the main ideas and goals of the Constitution. It gives a clear summary of the values and dreams on which the Indian

nation is built. The Preamble declares India to be a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic. It also highlights the aims of ensuring justice, liberty, equality and promoting fraternity among all citizens. Because it expresses the spirit and purpose of the Constitution, it is often called the 'soul of the Constitution' and helps people understand its meaning.

Key Elements of the Preamble:

We, the People of India: This phrase shows that the real power of the Constitution comes from the people of India.

- **Sovereign:** India is a free and independent country that is not controlled by any other nation.
- **Socialist:** The wealth of the country should be shared fairly. The government works to reduce economic and social differences.
- **Secular:** India does not have an official religion, and all religions are respected and treated equally.
- **Democratic:** The people choose their government through free and fair elections, and every citizen has equal political rights.
- **Republic:** The head of the country is elected by the people's representatives, not a king or queen by birth.
- **Justice:** It means fairness and equal treatment in social, economic and political life.
- **Liberty:** It gives people the freedom to think, speak, believe and practise their faith.
- **Equality:** All citizens have equal status and equal opportunities in the country.
- **Fraternity:** It encourages a feeling of brotherhood, unity and respect for the dignity of every person.

Go Further

The Preamble to the Constitution of India was adopted on 26 November 1949 and reflects the vision of the leaders who framed the Constitution of India. Interestingly, the words 'Socialist' and 'Secular' were added later in 1976 through the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act.

Analyze Thoughts

How do the values of justice, liberty, equality and fraternity help build a peaceful and united society? Can you think of examples from daily life where these values are important?

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Draft:** An early or rough version of a document that is written before the final version is completed.
- **Amendment:** An official change or addition made to a law or an important document like the Constitution.
- **Constituent Assembly:** A group of elected representatives who were given the responsibility of writing and preparing the Constitution of India.

QUICK TAKE

- A constitution is a written document that lays down the basic principles, laws and rules that guide how a country is governed.
- The Constitution of India is a detailed document that explains the structure of the government and how it works with the citizens of the country.
- The Indian Constitution was written by the Constituent Assembly, a group of representatives chosen by the provincial assemblies.
- The Constitution of India is called a 'living document' because it can change and grow to meet the needs of society over time.
- The Preamble is the opening part of the Constitution that explains the main values, aims and ideals of the country.

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Who prepared the Constitution of India?
   (a) British Parliament ☐ (b) Constituent Assembly ☐
   (c) State Governments ☐ (d) Supreme Court ☐
2. When did the Constitution of India come into force?
   (a) 26 January 1950 ☐ (b) 15 August 1947 ☐
   (c) 26 November 1949 ☐ (d) 9 December 1946 ☐
3. The original Constitution of India was handwritten by _____.
   (a) Rafi Ahmed Kidwai ☐ (b) Kailash Nath Katju ☐
   (c) Prem Bihari Narain Raizada ☐ (d) Kanaiyalal Maneklal Munshi ☐
4. Which organ of government makes laws?
   (a) The Legislature ☐ (b) The Executive ☐
   (c) Local Government ☐ (d) The Judiciary ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. The Constituent Assembly included members from different regions and communities of India. ☐
2. The Preamble explains the main ideas and values of the Constitution. ☐
3. Directive Principles act as guidelines for the government while making policies. ☐
4. A constitution can never be changed once it is written. ☐
5. In a democratic country, the government is chosen by the people through elections. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Amendment	A. The supreme law of the country
2. Rule of Law	B. The introductory part of the Constitution
3. Constitution	C. The process of changing the Constitution
4. Preamble	D. Guiding principles for the government to follow
5. Directive Principles	E. The idea that everyone is equal before the law

(a) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-E, 5-D
(b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C, 5-E
(c) 1-C,2-E, 3-A, 4-B, 5-D
(d) 1-C, 2-E, 3-D, 4-B, 5-A

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : The Constitution of India is called a "living document."
   Reason (R) : Because it can be amended to meet the changing needs of the country.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Fundamental Rights can be immediately claimed by every citizen.
   Reason (R) : Directive Principles are the goals for which the government works over time.
3. **Assertion (A)** : The Preamble is often called the "soul of the Constitution."
   Reason (R) : It summarizes the main values, aims and ideals of the nation.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the image and answer the questions that follow.

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar sits with the Drafting Committee. What was their main responsibility?

(a) To design the national flag. ☐
(b) To write and finalise the Constitution of India. ☐
(c) To prepare economic plans for five years. ☐
(d) To form the first government after independence. ☐

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why is the Constitution important for a country with democracy?
2. Name any three main features of a Constitution.
3. Explain three factors that influenced the making of the Indian Constitution.
4. "Fundamental Rights protect every citizen and give freedom to live with dignity." Explain the meaning.

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why is the Indian Constitution called a living document? Give examples.
2. Describe any five main ideas of the Preamble of the Indian Constitution.
3. Why is a Constitution important for a country? Give reasons.
4. Explain any five important features of the Indian Constitution.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

Borrowing Ideas, Building India

While drafting the Constitution, India's leaders studied constitutions from other countries. From France they borrowed liberty, equality and fraternity; from Ireland, Directive Principles of State Policy; from the USA, the idea of an independent judiciary; and from the UK, parliamentary democracy. Yet, they blended these ideas with Indian traditions such as tolerance, collective duty and unity in diversity.

(a) Why did Indian leaders study other constitutions?

(b) Did borrowing ideas make India's Constitution a copy?

(c) What does this approach show about the mindset of the Constitution-makers?

VI. PROJECT WORK

Create a rangoli pattern that symbolises India's diversity and constitutional values like unity in diversity, equality and peace.

THEME–E

Economic Life Around Us

Economic life is a part of our daily lives, as people produce, buy, sell, and exchange goods and services to meet their needs. In ancient times, people used the barter system, where goods were exchanged for other goods. As trade increased, money became a common and convenient medium of exchange. Today, markets connect producers, sellers, and consumers, helping people buy and sell products and services. Prices are influenced by demand, supply, and quality. Banks and digital payments have made transactions faster and safer. Understanding economic activities helps students make informed choices, appreciate the value of resources, and recognise the importance of responsible spending, saving, and fair trade.

11 From Barter to Money

Let's Learn About

- What the barter system is and how it worked?
- Why people started using money instead of trading goods directly?
- The journey of money from ancient coins to modern digital payments.

Let's Gear Up

Akshay & Saloni's Market Day

It was a lively evening at the bazaar. Saloni noticed a colourful sign: "Book Swap – Bring 1, Take 1."

"Barter!" she exclaimed with a smile. "I'll trade my comic for Akshay's adventure book."

Nearby, a vendor shouted, "Old toys for baskets!"

"Another barter," Akshay said, watching the trade carefully.

At the fruit stall, the seller pointed to a black-and-white square on the counter. "Scan this to pay."

"So that's digital money!" whispered Saloni, amazed at the new way to pay.

They walked past a snack cart where coins clinked in a jar.

"Barter, coins and digital money, all in one market," Akshay observed.

Dadaji explained, "In the past, barter was used, but it was hard to match needs. Money came later. Everyone accepts it, and you can earn, save and spend anytime. Money connects today with the future."

THE BARTER SYSTEM

Long before money was used, people met their needs by swapping things they had for things they wanted. If a farmer grew extra wheat, he could trade it for clothes from a tailor or pots from a potter. A family in Kochi might want dried fish and exchange it for clay pots made by a potter in a neighbouring village. This way of trading goods directly without using money is called the Barter System.

Barter System

Stone Money

Huge round stones, called Rai stones, were used as money on Yap Island, in the Pacific country of Micronesia.

Aztec Money

The Aztec copper Tajadero (Spanish word for chopping knife) was used as money in Central Mexico and some parts of Central America.

Tevau Money

Tevau (red feather coils made from birds' feathers) were used as money on the Solomon Islands.

Stone Money

Aztec Money

Tevau Money

In different regions, people also used things like cattle (cows, goats), salt, tea, tobacco, and even pretty cowrie shells for trade. Commodities are products that peoplAe can trade, buy, or sell.

Why Do We Need Money?

People used the barter system long ago, but it had many problems. Let us see this through Meera, a skilled toymaker in a village famous for wooden crafts. She makes beautiful, colourful wooden parrots and goes to the market to get vegetables, salt, and rice in exchange for her parrots.

At the market, she finds a farmer who has rice, but he does not need a toy parrot. He wants a new pair of sandals. Meera now has to search for a sandal-maker who wants a parrot. This search could take hours or even days. For barter to work, she must find someone who has what she wants and also wants what she has. This is called the double coincidence of wants.

After some time, Meera finds a vegetable seller interested in a parrot. But how do they decide a fair trade? How many parrots for one kilogram of vegetables? This is difficult because there is no common way to measure value. This problem is called the lack of a common standard of value.

Next, Meera needs some salt. The seller agrees to trade, but says one whole parrot is too much. Can she give half a parrot? That would ruin the toy. Some goods cannot be divided without losing value. This is the problem of divisibility.

Finally, Meera wants to save for later. She cannot store hundreds of parrots—they take too much space and could get damaged. Carrying fragile toys to different markets is also hard. This is the problem of portability and durability.

Thus, in a barter system, problems include double coincidence of wants, no common measure of value and issues with divisibility, portability and durability.

In-Text Questions

1. Before money was invented, people exchanged goods directly with each other. This system is called the _____.
2. A major problem in the barter system is that people must find someone who has what they want and also wants what they have. This is called the _____ of wants.
3. Rai stones, Tajaderos and Tevau are examples of _____ used by different cultures instead of money.

BASIC FUNCTIONS OF MONEY

As villages, towns and societies grew, trade increased and people needed money. As the saying goes, "necessity is the mother of invention." Problems with barter led to an important invention in history: money. People needed something that everyone would accept, that was easy to carry, divisible and long-lasting. And so, money was created.

Money is a common tool that everyone accepts to pay for goods and services. When money came into use, it performed some basic functions:

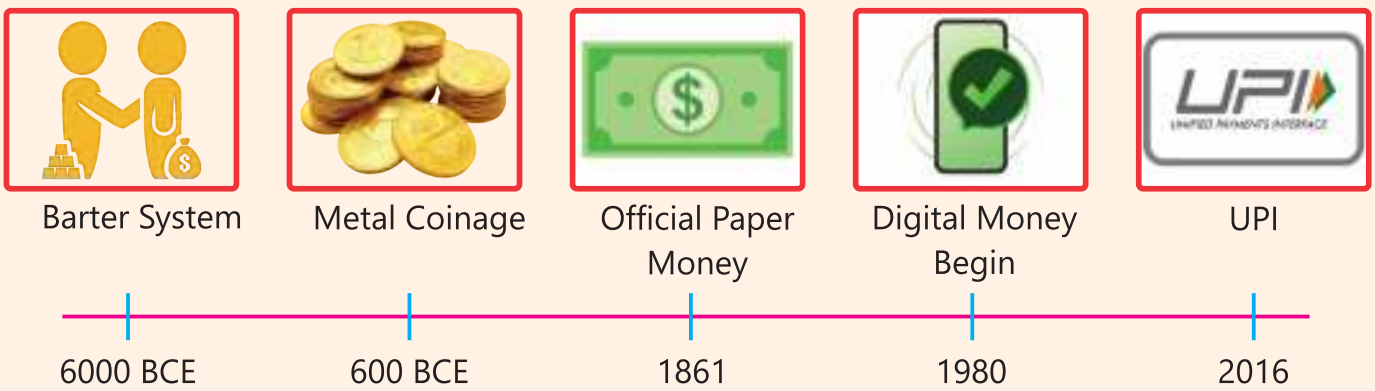
- **A Common Medium of Exchange:** Money works like a middleman. A farmer can sell his cow for money and then use it to buy shoes, medicines or anything else from anyone. Meera, the toymaker, can sell her parrots to anyone for money. Buying and selling becomes faster and easier.
- **A Measure of Value:** Money gives a common way to measure the value of things. A pencil may cost 25, a notebook 30, a parrot 200, and a kilogram of rice 250. This helps compare the value of different items. So, money gives a standard value to goods and services.
- **A Store of Value:** Unlike perishable items, money can be saved. Meera can keep her money in a piggy bank or in a bank. It will not spoil or get damaged. This allows her to save wealth and use it later whenever she needs it.

✶ **A Standard for Deferred Payment:** Money allows us to buy now and pay later. This is the basis of lending and borrowing. Parents can take a loan to buy a house and pay back in instalments over time. Money makes it possible to buy today and pay later, based on trust.

THE JOURNEY OF MONEY

The money we use today did not appear suddenly. Over thousands of years, it has changed its form with new technologies and the needs of people, becoming what we use now.

Timeline : Journey of Money Since Barter System



Coinage

Coins were one of the earliest forms of money. Long ago, rulers made coins for people in their kingdoms to use for trade and payments. Each kingdom had its own coins and rulers controlled their making and use. Over time, coins from strong rulers were accepted in many kingdoms, not just their own. This helped trade grow across larger areas.

Coinage from Chalukyas of Kalyana featuring Varaha (avatar of Vishnu) and a Royal Parasol

Silver coin showing tiger emblem of Cholas (850-1279 CE)

These coins were made from precious metals like gold, silver and copper, or from mixtures of these metals. They were called karshapanas or pannas, and the punched marks on them were known as rupas.

In ancient times, coins had two sides: the head (obverse) and the tail (reverse). Each side had different designs, such as animals, trees, hills, kings, queens or gods. For example, Chalukya coins had Varaha (an avatar of Vishnu) on one side and a decorated three-tiered parasol on the other.

Coins also helped India trade by sea with other countries. Coins found in Kerala and Tamil Nadu show that southern India had trading links with faraway lands. Scholars say

Roman gold coins excavated in Pudukottai India

these discoveries prove that trade was good for India. While barter used non-metallic items as money, coins—metallic money—later became common and eventually led to other types of currency. Today, coins come in values of ₹1, ₹2, ₹5, ₹10, and ₹20. They have writing in both Hindi and English so everyone can read and use them. These different values are called denominations.

Coin with symbol making India's 75 years of independence in 2021

Coinage today

The Rupee symbol was adopted by the Government of India in 2010. It was designed by Udaya Kumar from the Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay. The design combines the Devanagari letter "Ra" for Indian Rupee and the Roman letter "R," with two horizontal lines at the top that represent both the Indian national flag and the 'equal to' sign.

Indian Rupee Symbol

Do you know?

1 anna was equal to 1/16 of a rupee. Back in 1947, just one anna could buy a dozen bananas! Coins from that time, like the half anna (1942), quarter anna (1918), one anna (1943), and one paisa (1945), were made of different metals and sizes.

1 half anna, 1942

1 quarter anna, 1918

1 anna, 1943

1 paisa, 1945

Sometimes, India also makes special coins to mark important national events. For example, coins were issued to celebrate Mahatma Gandhi's 150th birth anniversary and to honour India's successes in science and sports. These coins help us remember important people and events in our country's history.

In-Text Questions

1. Why is money used as a common medium of exchange instead of the barter system in today's world?
2. How does money act as a store of value for people like Meera?
3. Why do coins have two sides with different designs, and how did this help trade in ancient times?

Paper Money

As trade grew and people's needs increased, carrying heavy metal coins became difficult. Could anyone buy a piece of land with thousands of coins? Clearly, no. To solve this problem, paper money was invented.

Paper money was first used in China. In India, it was introduced in the late eighteenth century. Today, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the only authority allowed to print and issue banknotes, except for the one-rupee note, which is issued by the Government of India.

Paper currency today

Analyze Thoughts

"Imagine a new 50 rupee note for India. What pictures, symbols, or colours would you use to show India's culture, achievements or values? Draw your design and tell the class why you chose each symbol."

New Kinds of Money

Money today is not only coins and paper notes. Some money is digital, which means we cannot touch it. You may have seen people paying without cash. This happens through digital payments like debit cards, credit cards, internet banking and UPI (Unified Payments Interface). These methods move money directly from one person's bank account to another.

Here's an example:

Ravi runs a small tea stall near a busy office. He sells tea, coffee and snacks to office workers during their breaks. Like many small shop owners today, Ravi shows a QR code (Quick Response Code) at his stall. Customers scan the code using apps like Google Pay or PhonePe on their phones. With just a tap, the payment is done. There's no need to carry cash or wait for change. The money goes straight into Ravi's bank account.

Even though Ravi does not have a big shop or cash register, he uses digital money every day. It helps him run his business fast, safely and smoothly.

In-Text Questions

1. Paper money was first used in _____ and later introduced in India in the late eighteenth century.
2. The _____ is the only authority allowed to print and issue most banknotes in India.
3. The one-rupee note is issued by the _____, not the RBI.
4. Payments using debit cards, credit cards, UPI or internet banking are called _____ payments.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Barter System:** Swapping goods or services directly without using money.
- **Medium of Exchange:** Anything everyone agrees to use to buy or sell things.
- **Store of Value:** Money that can be kept safely and used later.
- **Currency:** The official notes and coins of a country.
- **Double Coincidence of Wants:** Both people must want what the other has to trade.
- **Digital Money:** Money we use online through banks, cards or apps.
- **Reserve Bank of India:** India's main bank that looks after the rupee.

QUICK TAKE

- The barter system was when people traded goods and services directly without money.
- It had problems like double coincidence of wants (both must want each other's goods), no common value and issues with dividing, carrying or keeping goods.
- Money has four main jobs: to be a medium of exchange, a measure of value, a store of value and a way to pay later.
- Money changed over time: from commodities (like salt or shells), to metal coins, to paper notes, and now cards and digital money (like UPI).
- The Reserve Bank of India is the only authority that can print currency notes in India.

EXERCISES

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. What is the barter system?
   (a) Using coins to buy goods ☐ (b) Swapping goods without using money ☐
   (c) Digital payments via mobile apps ☐ (d) Saving money in a bank ☐
2. What problem did Meera face trading parrots?
   (a) Coins were heavy ☐ (b) Dividing, carrying or finding buyers ☐
   (c) Digital money missing ☐ (d) Too many farmers ☐
3. Which country used Rai stones as money?
   (a) India ☐ (b) Micronesia ☐
   (c) Mexico ☐ (d) Solomon Islands ☐
4. What is an example of digital money?
   (a) Coins ☐ (b) UPI payments ☐
   (c) Paper notes ☐ (d) Salt ☐

5. Why was paper money invented?

(a) Coins were heavy to carry ☐ (b) People liked new colours ☐

(c) Sandals were expensive ☐ (d) Parrots needed trading ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' for False.

1. Rai stones were used as money in Micronesia. ☐
2. The Tajadero was a type of Aztec feather money. ☐
3. Commodities are goods people can trade, buy or sell. ☐
4. Divisibility was not a problem in the barter system. ☐
5. Money allows people to buy now and pay later. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Barter	A. Only body to issue currency notes in India.
2. UPI	B. When two people have what the other wants.
3. Double Coincidence of Wants	C. Direct trading of goods without money.
4. Reserve Bank of India	D. Digital payment method using QR codes.

(a) 1 - C, 2 - D, 3 - B, 4 - A (b) 1 - B, 2 - A, 3 - D, 4 - C

(c) 1 - C, 2 - B, 3 - A, 4 - D (d) 1 - D, 2 - C, 3 - B, 4 – A

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : Barter system was difficult because people could not find exact trade partners.
   Reason (R) : Double coincidence of wants means both parties must want each other's goods.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Coins helped trade across many kingdoms.
   Reason (R) : Coins had designs of rulers or symbols.
3. **Assertion (A)** : Paper money was introduced in India in the 18th century.
   Reason (R) : Carrying many coins was difficult for trade.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Digital money is becoming popular today.
   Reason (R) : Digital payments can be made safely without carrying cash.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the given image and answer the question:

1. What advantage of modern money is shown in the picture given alongside?

(a) It is used only in rural areas.

(b) It works without any technology.

(c) It allows fast and contactless transactions.

(d) It requires both parties to exchange goods.

2 What do the two horizontal lines in the symbol of ₹ represent?

(a) Equality and the tricolour stripes.

(c) Two old coins.

(d) Mountains and rivers.

(d) Lines of prosperity.

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. List the good and bad points of the barter system and money.
2. How does money work as a 'medium of exchange'? Explain.
3. Why was keeping wealth in the barter system hard? Give two reasons.
4. Money can do good or bad. Give one example of how it helps society.

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Explain why barter needed a double coincidence of wants. Give an example.
2. Tell the story of money from old coins to paper notes in India.
3. Will digital money replace cash completely in the future? Give reasons.
4. What were the main features of India's old coins?

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

Trust in Paper

Anika's grandfather shows her an old 10 rupee note and asks, "Do you think this piece of paper has value?" Anika laughs, "Only because people believe in it!" He nods and explains that the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) guarantees its value. "Long ago," he adds, "money was gold and silver, but now trust and government backing make paper notes valuable." Anika realises that money's worth depends not on what it's made of, but on people's confidence that everyone will accept it.

(a) Why do people accept paper money even though it's just paper?

(b) Which institution in India guarantees the value of notes?

(c) What type of money did societies use before paper notes?

(d) What idea does this story teach about money's value?

VI. PROJECT WORK

"Money Matters" - Designing the Future of Currency

I. Objective:

- To think creatively about what money could look like 50 years from now and what values it should represent.

II. Tasks:

- Groups brainstorm: What if paper money disappears? What could replace it?
- Design your own "Future Money" prototype (digital card, eco-coin, Al token, energy-based credit, etc.).
- Each design must answer:
  - What material or technology is it made of?
  - How is it used?
  - How does it stay safe and fair for everyone?
- Present your design in a short "Money Expo" pitch.

III. Expected Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this activity, you will:

- Connect economic concepts with innovation and ethics.
- Explore how trust, sustainability and equality can guide future money systems.

12 Understanding Markets

Let's Learn About

- What is a market and how does it function?
- The different types of markets that exist.
- How markets affect the daily lives of people.
- The role of the government in regulating and supporting markets.

Let's Gear Up

The Busy Bazaar

One evening, Aarav and Maya visited the weekly bazaar, eyes wide with excitement. Colourful lights shone from every stall and sellers' voices called out prices loudly.

Maya: "Look! This man wants ₹60 for mangoes, but the buyer offers only ₹40."

Aarav: "That's called bargaining. They'll talk until they agree on a fair price. That's how markets work."

As they walked, they saw bright clothes and toys, and smelled fresh snacks from a cart.

Maya: "Markets are so full of life. And now, we can even shop using phones."

Aarav: "Yes! Markets can be on streets or online. They connect buyers and sellers and give people what they need."

By the end of their walk, Aarav and Maya understood that markets are not just about buying and selling—they bring people, ideas and daily life together.

WHAT IS A MARKET ?

A market is a place where buyers and sellers meet to trade goods and services. In India, markets are called a bazaar, a haat (Hindi) or a marukatte (Kannada).

Markets can be set up in a fixed place, like streets, squares or shopping malls. Today, many markets also work online through websites and mobile apps, making it easier for people to buy and sell from anywhere.

Markets are very important in daily life because they help goods and services reach individuals, families and businesses. They make sure people get what they need, from fruits and clothes to tools and toys.

Beyond buying and selling, markets are lively social spaces. They bring people together, allow sharing of ideas and let communities enjoy traditions while learning new things. Over time, markets have been central to meeting people's needs and connecting communities across towns and villages.

Street Market

Shopping Malls

Online Marketplace

HOW MARKETS WORK

For any market to function, whether it is a busy Hampi Bazaar or a small vegetable stall near your home, three things are very important: a buyer, a seller and a price they both agree on.

The buyer is the person who wants to purchase a product or service like fruits, clothes or toys. The seller is the person who wants to sell these items to earn money. The price is the amount of money both agree on for exchanging the product.

Buyer and Seller

In markets, bargaining often happens. Buyers and sellers talk and negotiate until they find a fair price that satisfies both. This way, goods move from sellers to buyers, and money flows in the opposite direction.

Markets are not only about buying and selling. They help people understand the value of things, encourage fair trade and connect communities by bringing people together in lively spaces.

Who Decides the Price?

Prices in a market are usually decided through bargaining between buyers and sellers. Bargaining is when both sides negotiate and discuss to find a price that feels fair to everyone.

Let's look at Ramesh, who sells sweet, juicy lychees at the weekly market.

- **Day 1 (Price Too High):** Ramesh set the price at ₹150 per kg. The lychees looked fresh, but buyers walked away. By evening, most lychees remained unsold and risked spoiling.
- **Day 2 (Price Too Low):** He lowered the price to ₹50 per kg. Everything sold quickly, but after paying his costs, Ramesh earned very little.
- **Day 3 (Right Price):** Ramesh fixed the price at ₹90 per kg. Buyers were happy, and Ramesh made a good profit.

This shows that market prices depend on supply and demand. A good price is fair for both buyers and sellers, covering costs and providing profit.

Go Further

Big brand shops in malls set fixed prices. They don't let you bargain. Street vendors on the road often do. Why? Big shops spend more on rent, staff and brand name. They want all customers to pay the same, keeping the brand special. Street sellers have lower costs and want to sell fast, so they let you bargain. Customers expect clear prices in malls but fun haggling on streets.

In-Text Questions

1. A market is a place where _____ and _____ meet to trade goods and services.
2. In a market, the price of an item is usually decided by _____ between the buyer and the seller.
3. Street vendors often allow _____, while big brand shops usually have fixed prices.
4. Markets are not only for buying and selling but also help people connect and share _____.

MARKETS ALL AROUND US

Markets are everywhere and come in many forms. We can group them by location, what they sell or how they work.

Physical and Online Markets

A physical market is a place where people meet in person to buy and sell. Shoppers pay money to get goods or services they need.

Physical Market

This is the most common type of market. It includes weekly markets and haats, where sellers offer vegetables, daily needs and handicrafts from small stalls or carts. Local neighbourhood shops are also part of physical markets. These places are often busy with vendors selling street food, household items and other everyday things. In towns and cities, physical markets also include big multi-storey shopping centres, called malls, which have many shops inside.

Online Market

Today, buyers and sellers do not always have to meet in person. They can trade from far away, even thousands of kilometres apart. People use shopping apps or websites on phones or computers. This kind of market is called an online market. Businesses run these platforms and sell many different goods and services.

For example, people can order books, clothes, furniture, groceries and electronic items like TVs, mobile phones and laptops. Items are delivered to their homes. Manufacturers can also buy parts or materials online to make products. Besides goods, online services like classes or workshops can also be taken from home. Payments are made digitally too.

Some markets do not sell regular goods. The share or stock market is one example. Here, people buy and sell shares, which are small parts of a company. Owning a share makes a person a shareholder.

Domestic and International Markets

Markets can also be grouped by location. Trade inside one country is called a domestic market.

Trade across countries is called an international market. It has two main types:

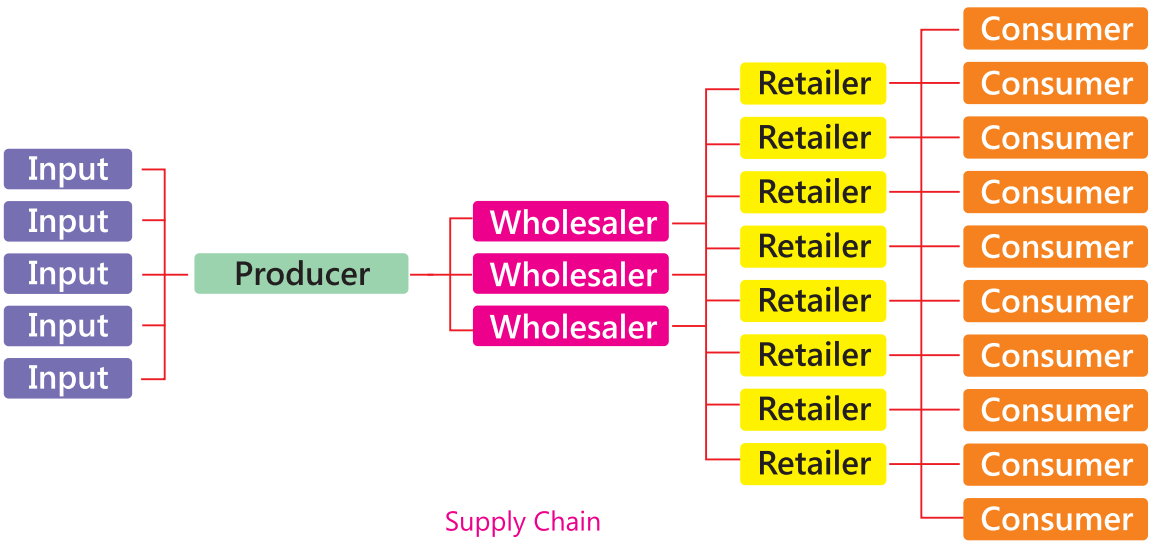
- **Exports:** Selling goods or services made in our country to buyers abroad. For example, Indian farmers export tasty Basmati rice and artisans sell handicrafts and textiles showing our culture.
- **Imports:** Buying goods or services from other countries. We import items we cannot make enough of, such as petrol from Saudi Arabia, Russia and other nations.

Wholesale and Retail Markets

Have you ever wondered where a simple cotton T-shirt comes from? The one in a bright, air-conditioned shop in your city may have travelled hundreds or even thousands of kilometres to reach you. On its way, it passes through many people and different types of markets. This full journey from the cotton farm to your wardrobe is called the supply chain.

Let's see the main stages in this supply chain:

- **The Producer / Manufacturer:** This is a person or company that makes the product. A producer could be a farmer growing cotton or a big modern factory that uses machines to make thousands of T-shirts every day.
- **The Wholesaler:** A wholesaler is a big trader who buys goods in large quantities. They buy directly from producers or manufacturers. Wholesalers do not sell to customers but sell to retailers. They help move large amounts of goods efficiently to different shops.



Supply Chain

3. **The Retailer:** Retailers buy goods in small quantities from wholesalers and sell them directly to customers like us. A retailer can be the nearby kirana shop, a vegetable vendor in the market, supermarkets like DMart or Reliance Fresh or even stores in a shopping mall.
4. **Consumer:** The consumer is the final user of a product. That means you. When you go to a shop or market and buy something you need, you are acting as a consumer.

   The movement of goods from the producer to the buyer can be shown like this:

   Manufacturer → Wholesaler → Retailer → Consumer
5. **The Distributor:** A distributor connects big producers or wholesalers with many small shops

in different areas. They purchase goods from manufacturers and deliver them to stores and sellers. For example, the dairy brand Amul uses distributors to supply milk, butter, curd and ice cream to nearby shops.

6. **Aggregator:** An aggregator is a company or person that gathers products or services from many sellers and shows them together in one place. They usually do not make the products themselves but organise multiple options for buyers on a simple platform. For example, online shopping apps like Amazon and Flipkart list items from many brands and sellers so customers can easily choose what they want.

THE ROLE OF MARKETS IN PEOPLE'S LIVES

Markets are very important in people's daily lives. They help producers sell their goods and allow consumers to buy the things they need. Through markets, families and businesses can get products and services that they cannot make on their own. Markets also create work and income for millions of people across the country.

How Markets Benefit Society

Markets also show producers what people like to buy. For example, if many consumers want refrigerators that use less electricity, companies understand this demand. They start making refrigerators that save energy. This helps society because it encourages the use of products that use less power and protect resources.

Buying and selling in markets involves money, but market activities are not only about price and products. People often talk, ask questions and sometimes bargain before buying something. Over time, buyers and sellers may build friendly and trusting relationships. Some families visit the same tailor, jeweller or doctor for many years.

In many places in India, families also keep a monthly account with the local grocery shop. They buy items during the month and pay the total amount later. Thus, markets serve not only as places for trade but also as spaces where people build trust and long-lasting connections.

THE GOVERNMENT'S ROLE IN THE MARKET

Markets usually work when buyers demand goods and sellers supply them. This interaction often decides what products are made and how much they cost. But sometimes the market does not work properly or fairly for everyone.

At such times, the government plays an important role. It keeps an eye on the activities of producers and consumers in the market. The government makes rules and takes steps to make sure that prices remain fair and that no group is treated unfairly.

Controlling Prices to Protect Everyone

Sometimes the government needs to control prices to protect people. This helps buyers avoid paying very high prices and also supports sellers when prices become too low. The government does this mainly through two methods:

- **Price Ceiling:** To prevent sellers from charging very high prices for necessary goods, the government fixes a Maximum Retail Price (MRP). This price is printed on most packaged products, so that customers know the highest price they should pay.
- **Price Floor:** To help farmers when crop prices suddenly fall, the government declares a Minimum Support Price (MSP) for important crops such as wheat and paddy. This means the government promises to buy the crops at this minimum price if the market price becomes too

low. This support protects farmers from big losses and gives them some financial security.

Ensuring Quality and Safety for Consumers

The government has an important duty to protect consumers from unfair practices in the market. It makes sure that companies and service providers follow proper rules about quality and safety.

For example, medicines are made to treat different illnesses. Before these medicines can be sold in the market, the government sets strict rules and testing procedures. Samples of the medicines are carefully checked to see if they meet the required standards.

These rules help make sure that the medicines people buy are safe and work properly. In this way, the government helps protect the health and well-being of consumers.

Mitigating the External Effects of Markets

Sometimes markets create effects that go beyond simple buying and selling. For example, factories that produce certain goods may cause air, water or land pollution. These side effects can harm people as well as the environment. Because of this, the government has an important role in finding these problems and controlling them.

Take the example of single-use plastics. Making and using these plastics can pollute the environment and may also create health problems for people. In such cases, the government introduces strict rules to reduce or stop these harmful effects.

The government also sets up systems to check that packaged goods follow the correct standards of weight and measure. This makes sure that consumers get the exact quantity written on the label.

Overall, the government makes rules so that markets work in a fair way and people are not cheated. At the same time, too many rules can slow down business and make it harder for markets to run smoothly.

Providing Public Goods

Most producers make and sell goods or services mainly to earn profit. However, some facilities are very important for society but do not bring direct profit to businesses. Examples include public parks, roads, street lighting, policing and other common services.

As you learned in an earlier chapter, citizens also have certain rights to welfare services. Because of this, the government provides many of these public goods and services so that everyone in society can benefit from them.

How Can a Consumer Check the Quality of Products and Services?

Imagine your parent asks you to buy a packet of potato chips from a nearby shop. When you look at the shelf, you find many different brands. The packets look bright and colourful because companies design them to attract buyers.

But the most useful information is usually printed on the back of the packet. Learning how to read this label is like having a special power. It helps you understand what you are buying and choose a safe and smart product.

Let us now look at the important details you should check on a typical food packet:

In-Text Questions

1. If all physical markets suddenly closed for one month, how might people depend on online markets to meet their daily needs?
2. When choosing between two similar food products in a shop, how can reading the label help a consumer make a better decision?

1. **MRP (Maximum Retail Price):**
   This shows the highest price a shopkeeper can legally charge for the product. Always check the MRP so that you are not asked to pay more than the allowed price.
2. **Net Quantity/Weight:**
   This tells you how much product is inside the packet, such as 200 g or 500 ml. It helps you compare different packets and choose the one that gives better value.
3. **Date of Manufacture & Best Before Date:**
   These dates tell you when the product was made and the period during which it is safe and fresh to eat. Never buy or consume a product after its Best Before date.
4. **Ingredients List:**
   This section lists all the items used to make the product. The ingredient used the most is usually written first. It is useful for people who may be allergic to things like nuts, milk or gluten.
5. **Nutrition Facts Panel:**
   This table shows the food's nutritional value. It tells you the amount of energy (calories),

protein, sugar, fat and other nutrients in each serving. This information helps families make healthier food choices.

6. **FSSAI Mark & Licence Number:**

The mark of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) shows that the food has been prepared in safe and hygienic conditions and is approved for consumption.

7. **Name and Address of the Manufacturer:**

This section tells you which company made the product and where it is located. These details are useful if you want to ask questions or make a complaint about the product.

Different products carry special certification symbols that assure their quality and safety. For example, food packets show the FSSAI mark, while electrical goods may carry the ISI mark. Let us understand what these marks mean so that you become an alert and informed consumer.

- **FSSAI:**

The mark of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India appears on food packets and cartons. It shows that the product has been tested according to government food safety rules and is safe to eat.

- **ISI:**

The ISI mark is given by the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS). It is seen on products such as electrical appliances, building materials, tyres, paper and similar items. This mark confirms that the product follows the required quality standards.

- **AGMARK:**

AGMARK is mainly used for agricultural goods such as fruits, vegetables, cereals, pulses, spices and honey. It shows that these products meet approved quality standards.

- **BEE STAR:**

BEE stands for the Bureau of Energy Efficiency. Electronic items like televisions, laptops, refrigerators, and air conditioners carry a star rating label on the product or its box.

- **HALLMARK:**

Hallmark is a certification used for gold and silver jewellery. It is issued by the Bureau of Indian Standards and assures buyers about the purity and quality of the metal used.

A higher number of stars on the BEE label means that the appliance uses less electricity and saves more energy. This helps consumers reduce electricity bills and also protects the environment. Often, people's buying choices are also influenced by a product's reputation. This reputation usually spreads through word of mouth. Similarly, when we shop online using apps like Amazon or Flipkart, reviews and ratings from other buyers help us decide whether a product or service is good and worth buying.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Export:** Selling things made in our country to other countries.
- **Import:** Bringing goods from other countries to use or sell here.
- **MRP (Maximum Retail Price):** The maximum price a shop can charge for a product.
- **Public Goods:** Useful things like streets and parks that the government provides for everyone to use.
- **Demand:** How much people want to buy at a certain price.
- **Supply:** How much sellers are ready to sell at a certain price.
- **Supply Chain:** All the steps and people that bring a product from the maker to you.
- **Mandi:** A big market where farmers bring and sell crops in large quantities.

QUICK TAKE

- Markets help people buy and sell goods and services at prices decided by demand and supply.
- They include makers, wholesalers, distributors and shopkeepers who bring products to buyers.
- Markets are also places to meet, talk and share ideas, culture and traditions.
- The government watches markets to keep products safe and sellers fair.
- Shoppers can check product quality by looking for official marks from government agencies.

I. OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTIONS

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. What is a market mainly used for?
   (a) Buying and selling goods ☐ (b) Planting crops only ☐
   (c) Government office meetings ☐ (d) School classrooms learning ☐
2. Which type of market works online?
   (a) Local vegetable market ☐ (b) Haat or weekly market ☐
   (c) E-market or online market ☐ (d) Big mall only ☐
3. What does the FSSAI mark ensure?
   (a) Clothes are of good quality ☐ (b) Food is safe to eat ☐
   (c) Jewellery is pure gold ☐ (d) Electronics save electricity ☐
4. What does the BEE star label indicate?
   (a) Energy efficiency of appliances ☐ (b) Product safety for food ☐
   (c) Jewellery metal purity ☐ (d) Agricultural quality standard ☐
5. Which is an export example from India?
   (a) Street food in bazaar ☐ (b) Petrol from Saudi Arabia ☐
   (c) Local vegetables sold nearby ☐ (d) Basmati rice to other countries ☐

B. Write 'T' for True or 'F' or False.

1. A market can be both physical and online. ☐
2. Consumers always buy directly from producers. ☐
3. Bargaining helps buyers and sellers agree on price. ☐
4. An aggregator makes the products they sell. ☐
5. Export means selling goods to other countries. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A and Column B.

Column A (Market Player/Concept)	Column B (Description)
1. Retailer	A. The person who uses the final product.
2. Producer	B. Buys huge amounts of goods from the maker.
3. Consumer	C. Sells things in small amounts to people like us.
4. Wholesaler	D. The farmer or factory that makes the product.

(a) 1-C, 2-D, 3-A, 4-B (b) 1-B, 2-A, 3-D, 4-C (c) 1-C, 2-B, 3-A, 4-D (d) 1-D, 2-C, 3-B, 4-A

D. Assertion-Reason

The following questions consist of two statements - Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Answer these questions by selecting the correct option:

1. **Assertion (A)** : Hallmark assures buyers about the purity of gold and silver jewellery.
   Reason (R) : Bureau of Indian Standards tests and certifies the metal used in jewellery.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Exporting goods helps a country earn money from other nations.
   Reason (R) : Exports mean selling products made in our country to buyers abroad.
3. **Assertion (A)** : Distributors are unnecessary if manufacturers deliver directly to shops.
   Reason (R) : Distributors connect producers or wholesalers to small shops in different areas.
4. **Assertion (A)** : Bargaining in markets helps find a fair price.
   Reason (R) : Buyers and sellers discuss to reach a price both agree on.

(a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false and (R) is true.

II. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the given image and answer the question:
Johari Bazaar is shown as a bright, busy market. What is this market best known for?

(a) Furniture and machinery. ☐
(b) Gems and jewellery. ☐
(c) Electronic goods. ☐
(d) Fruits and vegetables. ☐

III. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Imagine there were no shops to sell things. How would this make life hard for buyers and makers of products?
2. What does the BEE STAR label on home appliances tell us?
3. What is the difference between a market inside the country and a market between countries? Give one example of each.

4. Name and explain the government marks on products that show they are safe and good to use.

IV. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Describe how products travel from the maker to the buyer. Explain all the steps in this journey, called the supply chain.
2. "The government checks how sellers and buyers trade and makes sure prices are fair." Explain this in your own words. Also, describe three ways the government helps keep our markets safe and fair.
3. Imagine a world where we only shop online and no real shops exist. What would be the good and bad things about this? Think about it from the view of both shoppers and society.
4. Explain how the price of a product is connected to the way a market works.

V. SOURCE BASED QUESTIONS

Read the given paragraph and answer the following questions.

The Government Fair Price Shop

In Mehak's village, there is a government shop that sells rice, sugar and wheat at fixed low prices. People with ration cards buy their monthly supplies there. Mehak's mother explains that these are called fair price shops. The government controls the prices of essential goods so that everyone can afford them. If private sellers were allowed to decide freely, poor families might not be able to buy food. Mehak learns that sometimes markets need government rules to protect both sellers and buyers and to make sure goods are available at reasonable rates for all.

(a) What does the Fair Price Shop provide?
(b) Why does the government fix prices for such goods?
(c) What lesson does Mehak learn?

VI. PROJECT WORK

'Mini Market Makers' - Experiencing How Markets Work

I. Objective:

- To learn how customers and traders connect, how costs are set and how availability and desire influence buying and selling.

II. Tasks:

- Divide Groups: Split students into buyers and sellers.
- Arrange Stalls: Sellers show products (cards or drawings) with initial prices.
- Buying Session: Buyers use play money to negotiate and purchase items.
- Track Sales: Write down the final prices after negotiation.
- Compare and Discuss:
  - What occurs when many want a product but few are available?
  - Which factors increased certain items' prices? How did bargaining benefit both parties?
  - Did any seller reduce rates to draw customers?
  - In what ways do actual markets behave the same?

III. Expected Learning Outcomes:

By the end of this activity, you will:

- Explore how buyer's interest and seller's stock decide market prices.
- Explore why fairness and discussion help balance trade effectively.

Test Paper-I

Based on chapters 1 to 6

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which region is known as India's cold desert?
   (a) Thar desert region ☐ (b) Ladakh cold desert region ☐
   (c) Rajasthan sandy desert ☐ (d) Kutch dry desert region ☐
2. Humidity is measured by?
   (a) Barometer ☐ (b) Hygrometer ☐
   (c) Rain gauge ☐ (d) Thermometer ☐
3. Cyclones form when low air pressure exists over_____.
   (a) Mountains ☐ (b) Sea ☐ (c) Desert ☐ (d) Plains ☐
4. Important trade route connecting North and East India?
   (a) Dakshinapatha ☐ (b) Uttarapatha ☐
   (c) Ganges path ☐ (d) Shishupalgarh road ☐
5. Which feature of Mauryan houses showed urban planning?
   (a) Multi-storey wooden structures. ☐ (b) Dome-shaped ceilings. ☐
   (c) Brick towers like Mesopotamia. ☐ (d) Underground air-cooling systems. ☐
6. Which dynasty ruled the Deccan region?
   (a) Satavahana dynasty powerful southern rulers ☐
   (b) Shunga dynasty central Indian rulers ☐
   (c) Chera dynasty western coastal rulers ☐
   (d) Kushan dynasty north-western empire ☐

B. Write 'T' for True and 'F' for False.

1. India is located in South Asia and is the seventh largest country in the world. ☐
2. The troposphere is thinner at the equator. ☐
3. Forest fires in India happen only naturally, never by humans. ☐
4. Janapadas were ruled only by elected assemblies. ☐
5. Alexander's soldiers refused to move further toward the Ganga River. ☐
6. The Satavahana dynasty encouraged sea trade with distant regions. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A with Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Thar Desert	(i) Retreating Monsoon
2. Chennai	(ii) Increased agricultural surplus
3. Vajji and Malla	(iii) Sand Dunes
4. Fertile plains	(iv) Known for Ganas or Sanghas (early republics)

D. Assertion-Reason

For question numbers 1 to 6, two statements are given—one labelled Assertion (A) and the other labelled Reason (R). Select the correct answer from the codes:

1. **Assertion (A)** : The Himalayas are called the water tower of Asia.
   Reason (R) : Many major rivers originate from the Himalayas.
2. **Assertion (A)** : Atmospheric pressure is the weight of the air pressing down on Earth.
   Reason (R) : Air pressure decreases with altitude, making it harder to breathe at high places.
3. **Assertion (A)** : Weather changes quickly every day.
   Reason (R) : Climate shows long-term weather patterns.
4. **Assertion (A)** : The Harappan cities were abandoned after 2000 BCE.
   Reason (R) : Large public buildings and streets were no longer used.
5. **Assertion (A)** : The Mauryan rulers built roads and rest houses.
   Reason (R) : These helped travellers, traders, and officials move easily across the empire.
6. **Assertion (A)** : The Kushan Empire helped cultural exchange between different regions.
   Reason (R) : They controlled important sections of the Silk Route.

(a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and the Reason correctly explains the Assertion.
(b) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but the Reason does not correctly explain the Assertion.
(c) Assertion (A) is correct but Reason (R) is incorrect.
(d) Assertion (A) is incorrect but Reason (R) is correct.

E. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. How do people in the Thar Desert manage their daily life in such a hot and dry climate?
2. How did people in ancient times connect the sun with the timing of rain and monsoon?
3. How do the summer and winter winds change the weather and rainfall in different parts of India?
4. Why do we call this time in India the Second Urbanisation?
5. Who was Kautilya, and how did he help build the Maurya Empire?
6. How did the Kushan Empire gain advantages by controlling parts of the Silk Route?

F. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Describe how India's different physical features influence transport routes, communication systems, and where people choose to live.
2. Explain why different weather instruments, like thermometers, barometers, and rain gauges, are all important for forecasting weather.
3. Compare how cyclones, floods, and forest fires affect people, nature, and the economy.
4. Discuss the features of gana-sanghas like Vajji and Malla.
5. What were the main reasons for the fall of big empires, such as the Maurya Empire? Explain.

G. PICTURE STUDY

Observe the images and answer the questions that follow.

(a) Label: Mark anda (dome) and pradakşiṇā path.

(b) Explain why the stūpa's circular plan supports Buddhist practice.

Test Paper-2

Based on chapters 7 to 12

A. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which scholar wrote Aryabhatiya?
   (a) Kalidasa ☐ (b) Aryabhata ☐ (c) Varahamihira ☐ (d) Harisena ☐
2. Which is an Indian sacred site?
   (a) Ajmer Sharif Dargah ☐ (b) Eiffel Tower ☐
   (c) Sydney Opera House ☐ (d) London Bridge ☐
3. Parliamentary democracy executive comes from where?
   (a) Judiciary ☐ (b) Parliament ☐ (c) Monarch ☐ (d) Army ☐
4. When did the Constitution of India come into force?
   (a) 15 August 1947 ☐ (b) 26 January 1950 ☐
   (c) 26 November 1949 ☐ (d) 9 December 1946 ☐
5. What is an example of digital money ?
   (a) Coins ☐ (b) UPI payments ☐ (c) Paper notes ☐ (d) Salt ☐
6. What is a market mainly used for?
   (a) Buying and selling goods ☐ (b) Planting crops only ☐
   (c) Government offices meeting ☐ (d) School classrooms learning ☐

B. Write 'T' for True and 'F' for False.

1. The Gupta Empire first started near present-day Uttar Pradesh. ☐
2. Pilgrimages are only short trips to nearby holy places. ☐
3. In parliamentary democracy, the Prime Minister answers to Parliament. ☐
4. The Preamble explains the main ideas and values of the Constitution. ☐
5. Divisibility was not a problem in the barter system. ☐
6. A market can be both physical and online. ☐

C. Choose the option that matches items from Column A with Column B.

Column A	Column B
1. Kalidasa	(i) devoted to God Ayyappa
2. Sabarimala	(ii) The supreme law of the country
3. Constitution	(iii) Known for lyrical poems like Meghadutam.
4. UPI	(iv) The person who uses the final product.
5. Consumer	(v) Digital payment method using QR codes.

D. Assertion-Reason

For question numbers 1 to 6, two statements are given—one labelled Assertion (A) and the other labelled Reason (R). Select the correct answer from the codes:

1. **Assertion (A)** : The Guptas used copper plates to record land grants.
   Reason (R) : Copper plates helped in tax collection and local governance.
2. **Assertion (A)** : People walk long distances on pilgrimages to purify their mind and heart.
   Reason (R) : Pilgrimages involve strict rules, fasting, and devotion as part of the journey.
3. **Assertion (A)** : Direct democracy is difficult to practice in large countries.
   Reason (R) : In direct democracy, citizens vote directly on laws and policies.
4. **Assertion (A)** : The Preamble is often called the "soul of the Constitution."
   Reason (R) : It summarizes the main values, aims, and ideals of the nation.
5. **Assertion (A)** : Coins helped trade across many kingdoms.
   Reason (R) : Coins had designs of rulers or symbols.
6. **Assertion (A)** : Bargaining in markets helps find a fair price.
   Reason (R) : Buyers and sellers discuss to reach a price both agree on.

(a) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and the Reason correctly explains the Assertion.
(b) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but the Reason does not correctly explain the Assertion.
(c) Assertion (A) is correct but Reason (R) is incorrect.
(d) Assertion (A) is incorrect but Reason (R) is correct.

E. SHORT ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why is the Iron Pillar in Delhi important for learning about the Gupta rulers?
2. How can a place or thing be sacred even if it is not about religion?
3. "Democracy is better than Monarchy or Dictatorship." Explain why this is true.
4. Money can do good or bad. Give one example of how it helps society.
5. What does the BEE STAR label on home appliances tell us?

F. LONG ANSWER TYPE QUESTIONS

1. Why must historians be careful when using traveler stories like Faxian's? Give one reason.
2. Why is the Kumbh Mela special? What is the story behind this holy gathering?
3. Describe monarchy and dictatorship in detail, and give examples of countries for each.
4. Why is a Constitution important for a country? Give reasons.
5. What were the main features of India's old coins?
6. Explain how the price of a product is connected to the way a market works.

G. PICTURE STUDY

(a) Name the king and queen.
(b) Explain the queen's depiction with a chauri.
(c) Identify the ruler and the unusual feature.